ACADEMIC VOCABULARY IN USE

Name: _____

Class: _____

Teacher: _____

Table of Contents

1. Environment & Nature **1-6**
2. Education & Learning **7-12**
3. Technology & Innovation **13-18**
4. Information Technology **19-24**
5. Health & Wellbeing **25-30**
6. Work & Careers **31-36**
7. Business & Management **37-42**
8. Crime & Justice **43-48**
9. Jurisprudence **49-54**
10. Media & Communication **55-60**
11. Arts & Culture **61-66**
12. Design **67-72**
13. Travel & Tourism **73-78**
14. Society & Relationships **79-84**
15. Psychology **85-90**
16. Government & Public Life **91-97**
17. International Relations **98-104**
18. Business & Commerce **105-110**
19. Economics **111-117**
20. Science & Discovery **118-123**
21. Food & Lifestyle **124-129**
22. Change & Progress **130-135**

Appendices

Word Index **136-148**
Basic - Academic Word Swap Sheet **149-157**
Commonly Confused Words **158**
Prefix & Suffix Reference **159**
Academic Linking Words for Writing **160**
Master Debate Phrasebank **161**
Sources **162**

UNIT 1

Environment & Nature

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**biodiversity** *n.*	The variety of plant and animal life in a habitat or the world	The rainforest's biodiversity makes it one of the richest ecosystems on Earth.
2	**conservation** *n.*	The protection of natural resources, wildlife, or environment from damage	The conservation project brought the wolf population back from near extinction.
3	**contaminate** *v.*	To make something impure or harmful by adding a polluting substance	A chemical spill contaminated the local water supply for weeks.
4	**degradation** *n.*	The process of land or environmental quality being made worse	Years of intensive farming led to the degradation of the soil.
5	**deplete** *v.*	To gradually reduce something until little or none is left	Overfishing has depleted cod stocks in parts of the North Atlantic.
6	**ecosystem** *n.*	A community of living things together with the environment they interact with	Removing one species can throw an entire ecosystem out of balance.
7	**emission** *n.*	A substance, especially gas, released into the air	New regulations require cars to cut their emissions by 30%.
8	**habitat** *n.*	The natural home or environment of an animal or plant	Deforestation is destroying the orangutan's habitat at an alarming rate.
9	**mitigate** *v.*	To make something less severe, harmful, or serious	Planting trees can help mitigate the effects of flooding.
10	**pollution** *n.*	Harmful substances released into the air, water, or soil	Pollution from the factory turned the river a strange grey colour.
11	**renewable** *adj.*	An energy source that naturally replaces itself and won't run out	Her family installed solar panels to rely more on renewable energy.
12	**resilient** *adj.*	Able to recover quickly after difficulty, damage, or change	Coral reefs are surprisingly resilient, but only up to a certain temperature.
13	**scarcity** *n.*	A situation where there is not enough of something	Water scarcity is becoming a serious problem in several regions.
14	**sustainable** *adj.*	Able to continue at the same level long-term without running out of resources or causing lasting damage	The city switched to a sustainable water system so future generations wouldn't face shortages.
15	**unprecedented** *adj.*	Never having happened or existed before	Scientists recorded unprecedented ice loss in the Arctic this year.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
degradation	deterioration	Deterioration is used more in everyday language; degradation is more common in scientific, technical, or environmental writing (e.g. “land degradation”)
deplete	diminish	Softer, more general — doesn't imply the cause is overuse
deplete	exhaust	Stronger — implies almost nothing is left
mitigate	offset	Implies balancing a negative with a positive — common in climate contexts
pollution	contamination	More clinical/scientific, often used for water or food specifically
resilient	adaptable	Focuses on flexibility rather than recovery
scarcity	shortage	Shortage implies a temporary, resolvable gap (a shop running out of stock); scarcity implies a deeper, more structural lack of a resource
sustainable	eco-friendly	Informal, consumer-facing — used for products, not systems
sustainable	viable	Focuses on whether something can work long-term — not specifically environmental
unprecedented	unparalleled	Formal, often used for achievement, not only crisis

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
contaminate	purify	Direct
deplete	replenish	Direct — to refill or restore
renewable	finite	Not exact — finite means limited in supply, doesn't specify why
resilient	fragile	Direct
scarcity	abundance	Direct
sustainable	unsustainable	Direct — same word family

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
contaminate	contamination	contaminated	—
degrade	degradation	degraded	—
deplete	depletion	depleted	—
pollute	pollution / polluter	polluted	—
—	resilience	resilient	resiliently
—	sustainability	sustainable	sustainably

DID YOU KNOW? — “Resilient” comes from Latin resilire — “to jump back” — from re- (“back”) and salire (“to leap”), the same root behind “salient” and “somersault.”

5 Collocations

• to clear the air (idiom)	• rich in biodiversity
• to mitigate the effects of (something)	• a fragile / resilient ecosystem
• to contaminate a water supply	• severe water scarcity
• natural habitat	• greenhouse gas emissions
• to deplete natural resources	• strict conservation measures
• renewable energy	• irreversible degradation
• a drop in the ocean (idiom)	• an unprecedented rate/scale

FUN FACT — Certain bamboo species have been recorded growing over a metre in a single day — the official Guinness World Record for the fastest-growing plant on Earth.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
clean up	to remove pollution or mess from a place	Volunteers spent the weekend cleaning up the beach.
cut down (on)	to reduce the amount of something	The government is asking factories to cut down on emissions.
die out	to gradually disappear/become extinct	Several bird species have died out on the island since rats were introduced.
run out (of)	to have no more of something left	If we don't act now, we'll run out of clean water within a decade.
wipe out	to destroy something completely	The oil spill wiped out most of the local fish population.

7 Vocabulary Chain

HOW TO PLAY

In a circle or line, the first student says one sentence using a word from this unit. The next student must use a different unit word in a new sentence that connects logically to the one before it. Keep going around the group. You're out if you repeat a word already used, hesitate too long, or say a sentence that doesn't connect. Last student standing wins. Example chain: “Pollution is a serious problem in many cities.” → “That pollution often leads to biodiversity loss in nearby rivers.” → “Biodiversity loss can trigger long-term ecosystem degradation.” → “Degradation like that is often difficult to mitigate.”

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Adding weight	*What's more…*	What's more, the degradation is often irreversible.
Challenging a claim	*I'm not convinced that…*	I'm not convinced individual action alone can mitigate large-scale pollution.
Conceding a point	*That's fair, but…*	That's fair, but individual recycling still adds up over time.
Giving evidence	*This is evident in…*	This is evident in the collapse of fish stocks after decades of overfishing.
Hedging a claim	*It could be argued that…*	It could be argued that renewable energy still needs government subsidy to compete.
Opening a viewpoint	*I'd argue that…*	I'd argue that renewable energy is no longer just a supplement.
Softening disagreement	*I see your point, but consider…*	I see your point, but consider who actually causes the most emissions.
Summarising a position	*Overall, the point stands that…*	Overall, the point stands that unchecked degradation is hard to reverse.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Individual actions — recycling, cutting down on plastic — make a real difference in reducing pollution.
   B) Individual effort is largely symbolic; only large-scale corporate and government policy can meaningfully mitigate pollution.

2. **A)** Protecting biodiversity should take priority over short-term economic growth.
   B) Communities facing poverty cannot reasonably be expected to prioritise conservation over economic survival.

3. **A)** Renewable energy is now a viable replacement for fossil fuels, not just a supplement.
   B) Renewable energy remains inconsistent and cannot yet fully replace the reliability of traditional sources.

4. **A)** Environmental degradation in one country is everyone's problem, not just a local issue.
   B) Holding one country responsible for another's environmental degradation is unrealistic without international enforcement.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Should wealthier countries be more responsible for mitigating climate change than developing ones? Why?

2. Is it fair to ask individuals to change their habits when large industries cause far more pollution?

3. Can a growing economy ever be truly sustainable, or is that a contradiction?

4. What's more urgent: protecting biodiversity or solving water scarcity?

10 Context Passage

Ten years ago, the lake behind our village was barely recognisable. Decades of industrial waste had contaminated the water, and the surrounding wetland — once home to an impressive range of biodiversity — had degraded into little more than mud and rubbish. Fish stocks had been depleted almost entirely; locals said the herons had died out years before anyone thought to intervene.

What followed was, by local standards, unprecedented. A conservation group persuaded the regional government to fund a clean-up, and within two years the ecosystem began to show signs of resilience nobody expected. Emissions from the nearby factory were cut sharply, a new filtration system prevented further contamination, and slowly the herons came back. It wasn't a permanent fix — scarcity of funding still threatens the project every year — but it proved that degradation isn't always irreversible, provided people act before it's too late.

> **TRIVIA** — Herons and other wading birds are used by conservationists worldwide as indicator species — a healthy heron population is often taken as a sign that a wetland or waterway is recovering.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Matching — match each word to its definition.

1. habitat	a. never having happened before
2. mitigate	b. the natural home of a plant or animal
3. unprecedented	c. to make something less severe
4. scarcity	d. a situation of not having enough
5. resilient	e. to gradually reduce something
6. deplete	f. able to recover quickly
7. contaminate	g. to make impure with a harmful substance
8. emission	h. a gas or substance released into the air

B. Gap-fill — complete with a word from this unit (correct form).

1. The factory was fined for releasing toxic _____ into the river.

2. Without stronger _____ efforts, this species could disappear within a decade.

3. Scientists are calling the heatwave _____ — nothing like it has been recorded before.

4. Years of overfishing have _____ the region's fish stocks.

5. The reforestation project aims to restore the area's natural _____ .

6. Despite the drought, the ancient forest proved remarkably _____ .

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **biodiversity**, **degradation**, **mitigate**, **resilient**, **sustainable**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 2

Education & Learning

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**aptitude** *n.*	A natural ability or skill to do something well	The placement test is designed to reveal each student's aptitude for languages, not just their current level.
2	**assessment** *n.*	The act of judging or evaluating someone's ability, progress, or performance	The department is moving from a single final exam towards continuous assessment across the term.
3	**cognitive** *adj.*	Relating to the mental processes involved in thinking, understanding, and learning	Solving unfamiliar problems under time pressure places a heavy cognitive load on students.
4	**comprehension** *n.*	The ability to understand something completely	Her reading comprehension improved sharply once she started summarising each paragraph in her own words.
5	**curriculum** *n.*	The subjects and courses that make up a programme of study	The new curriculum leaves more room for debate and discussion than the old one did.
6	**diligent** *adj.*	Showing steady, careful effort in one's work	Even the most diligent students can burn out if they never take a break from revision.
7	**engage** *v.*	To attract and hold someone's attention or interest	A single well-chosen question can engage a whole class that a lecture would have lost in minutes.
8	**grasp** *v.*	To understand something, especially something difficult	It took him a week to grasp the logic behind the grammar rule, but after that it clicked.
9	**literacy** *n.*	The ability to read and write	Digital literacy is now considered as essential as traditional reading and writing skills.
10	**proficient** *adj.*	Skilled and experienced at doing something	By the end of the course, most students were proficient enough to hold a full debate in English.
11	**retain** *v.*	To keep something in the mind; to remember	Information taught through discussion tends to be retained longer than information copied from the board.
12	**rigorous** *adj.*	Thorough, strict, and demanding in method or standard	The scholarship applicants go through a rigorous set of interviews and written tests.
13	**rote** *adj.*	Learned or done by mechanical repetition rather than through understanding	Rote memorisation of dates can get you through a quiz, but it won't help you argue a position.
14	**syllabus** *n.*	A document listing the topics, texts, and assessments covered in a course	The teacher revised the syllabus to include more debate practice this year.
15	**underachieve** *v.*	To perform below what is expected of one's ability	Bright students sometimes underachieve simply because the material never challenges them.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
aptitude	knack	Knack is a natural ease at one specific skill; aptitude is a broader capacity to learn or improve
comprehension	understanding	Understanding is everyday; comprehension is more formal, often used in testing (e.g. “reading comprehension”)
diligent	conscientious	Conscientious implies a sense of duty; diligent simply means steady, sustained hard work
grasp	comprehend	Comprehend is more formal, often negative (“hard to comprehend”); grasp is everyday, paired with “of”
proficient	competent	Competent is the neutral baseline; proficient suggests a higher level of skill
retain	remember	Remember is everyday; retain is more formal, often used for facts or skills held over time
rigorous	demanding	Demanding focuses on effort; rigorous adds a sense of strict, thorough method
underachieve	underperform	Underperform fits professional/financial contexts; underachieve is specific to education and potential

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
diligent	negligent	Direct — negligent means failing to give proper care or attention
literacy	illiteracy	Direct — same root, opposite meaning
proficient	incompetent	Direct — incompetent means lacking the necessary skill
retain	forget	Direct
rigorous	lax	Direct — lax means not strict or careful enough
underachieve	excel	Not exact — excel means to do extremely well, not merely to meet expectations

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
assess	assessment	—	—
comprehend	comprehension	comprehensible	comprehensibly
—	diligence	diligent	diligently
engage	engagement	engaging	—
—	proficiency	proficient	proficiently
retain	retention	retentive	—

DID YOU KNOW? — The word “curriculum” comes from the Latin currere, meaning “to run” — the same root behind corridor, courier, and currency.

5 Collocations

• academic rigour	• cognitive development
• a firm grasp of (a subject)	• reading comprehension
• to assess student progress	• to cover the syllabus
• to hit the books (idiom)	• rote learning
• basic literacy skills	• to engage students' interest
• a natural aptitude for (something)	• to underachieve academically

FUN FACT — Cognitive scientists estimate that most new information falls out of working memory within about 20–30 seconds unless it is actively rehearsed or connected to something already known.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
brush up (on)	to improve a skill or knowledge you haven't used in a while	She spent the summer brushing up on her grammar before the new term.
catch up (on)	to do something you didn't have time for earlier, or reach the same level as others	He missed two weeks of class and spent the weekend catching up on the material.
cram (for)	to study intensively in a short time, usually right before a test	Cramming for a test the night before rarely helps you retain the material.
drop out (of)	to leave school or a course before finishing	She nearly dropped out of university in her first year, but a mentor convinced her to stay.
keep up (with)	to stay at the same pace or level as others	Extra revision sessions helped weaker students keep up with the rest of the class.

7 60-Second Challenge

HOW TO PLAY

Challenge 1: a student has 60 seconds to argue a position on the unit's topic, using at least 4 unit words correctly. Challenge 2: the same student then has 60 seconds to argue the opposite position, using at least 4 different unit words. No long pauses and no repeating a sentence structure. Stall for more than ten seconds and you're out — pass to the next student.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*There are several sides to this…*	There are several sides to this, since students' aptitude and motivation both affect outcomes.
Asking for clarification	*Could you explain what you mean by…?*	Could you explain what you mean by a 'proficient' student exactly?
Challenging a claim	*I'd push back on that, because…*	I'd push back on that, because rote learning alone rarely builds real comprehension.
Closing an argument	*This is exactly why…*	This is exactly why assessment should measure understanding, not memory.
Conceding a point	*Fair enough, however…*	Fair enough, however, some rote memorisation is still necessary for exam basics.
Drawing a comparison	*Unlike…*	Unlike a rigid syllabus, project-based learning lets students follow their own curiosity.
Giving evidence	*You can see this in…*	You can see this in schools that replaced pure lecture with more discussion-based teaching.
Opening a viewpoint	*From my point of view…*	From my point of view, a rigorous curriculum matters more than a comfortable one.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Standardised testing is the fairest way to measure a student's knowledge and progress.
   B) Standardised tests mainly measure how well a student can take a test, not genuine comprehension.

2. **A)** Rote learning is an outdated method that should be replaced entirely by critical thinking exercises.
   B) Some rote learning is still necessary — you cannot debate literature or solve equations without first retaining basic facts and formulas.

3. **A)** A rigorous, structured curriculum helps students learn more effectively than a flexible one.
   B) An overly rigid curriculum can stifle curiosity and discourage independent thinking.

4. **A)** Schools should prioritise practical, job-related skills over broad academic subjects.
   B) A broad education builds the cognitive flexibility that makes people adaptable to any career, not just one.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Should schools focus more on practical skills or academic knowledge?

2. Is it fair to judge a student's ability based on a single exam?

3. Does rote learning still have a place in modern education?

4. How much responsibility should a teacher take for a student who underachieves?

10 Context Passage

When the school introduced a new assessment system three years ago, many teachers were sceptical. The old curriculum had relied heavily on rote memorisation, and results showed that while students could recall facts under exam conditions, their comprehension of the material rarely went deeper. The new approach was more rigorous in a different sense: instead of testing recall alone, it required students to apply what they had learned to unfamiliar problems.

At first, engagement dropped. Students who were diligent under the old system found the change unsettling, and some appeared to underachieve simply because they were not used to thinking on their feet. The department responded by revising the syllabus itself, cutting weaker topics so there was more time to practise the skills the new exams actually rewarded.

Two years on, average literacy and problem-solving scores across the school have improved. Teachers say students now grasp concepts rather than simply retaining them long enough to pass a test. The aptitude was arguably always there; what changed was how it was measured.

> **FYI** — A syllabus and a curriculum are not the same thing: a syllabus outlines the content of one course, while a curriculum is the broader programme — spanning subjects and years — that the syllabus sits inside.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Odd One Out — circle the word that doesn't belong, and be ready to explain why.

1. aptitude knack talent rote
2. grasp comprehend understand underachieve
3. diligent conscientious hardworking negligent
4. retain remember keep in mind forget
5. rigorous strict thorough lax

B. Transformation — rewrite each sentence using the word in capitals in a different form, keeping the same meaning.

1. The exam will test how well students understand the material. (COMPREHENSION)

_____

2. She works hard and always finishes her assignments carefully. (DILIGENT)

_____

3. He can now speak French very well after years of practice. (PROFICIENCY)

_____

4. The new teacher tried hard to hold the students' attention during the lesson. (ENGAGING)

_____

5. The school checks students' progress at the end of every term. (ASSESSMENT)

_____

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **comprehension**, **diligent**, **engage**, **proficient**, **rigorous**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 3

Technology & Innovation

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**adapt** *v.*	To change or adjust in order to deal with new conditions	Teachers had to adapt quickly when classes moved online during the pandemic.
2	**algorithm** *n.*	A set of step-by-step instructions for solving a problem or completing a task, especially by a computer	The app uses an algorithm to recommend videos based on what you've already watched.
3	**automate** *v.*	To make a process work by machine or computer instead of by people	The factory automated its packaging line, cutting production time in half.
4	**breakthrough** *n.*	An important discovery or achievement that helps solve a problem or improve a situation	The breakthrough in battery technology could make electric cars far cheaper.
5	**cutting-edge** *adj.*	The most advanced stage of development in a particular field	The lab is working with cutting-edge equipment that most universities can't afford.
6	**disrupt** *v.*	To change an established industry or process fundamentally, often through new technology	Ride-sharing apps disrupted the taxi industry within a few years.
7	**glitch** *n.*	A small, usually temporary problem or fault, especially in a computer or system	A glitch in the booking system meant hundreds of tickets were sold twice.
8	**innovate** *v.*	To introduce new ideas, methods, or products	Companies that fail to innovate eventually lose ground to newer competitors.
9	**integrate** *v.*	To combine two or more things so that they work together as one	The school integrated tablets into every classroom this year.
10	**obsolete** *adj.*	No longer used because something newer has replaced it	Fax machines became obsolete once email became widespread.
11	**prototype** *n.*	An early, original model of something, built to test an idea before it is produced in full	Engineers tested three prototypes before settling on a final design.
12	**redundant** *adj.*	No longer needed because something else performs the same function	New translation software made his old job as an interpreter almost redundant.
13	**revolutionise** *v.*	To change something so completely and fundamentally that it becomes something new	Smartphones revolutionised the way people access information.
14	**scalable** *adj.*	Able to grow or be made larger without losing effectiveness	Investors were drawn to the business because its model was highly scalable.
15	**seamless** *adj.*	Smooth and continuous, with no awkward gaps, interruptions, or problems	The update was designed to give users a seamless transition between devices.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
adapt	adjust	Adjust suggests exact correspondence, like parts of a mechanism; adapt implies broader modification to changing circumstances
breakthrough	advance	Advance is any forward progress; breakthrough specifically implies overcoming a barrier or stalemate
cutting-edge	state-of-the-art	State-of-the-art usually describes technology specifically; cutting-edge is broader, covering ideas and design too
glitch	flaw	Flaw implies a fault built into the design; glitch implies a usually minor, often temporary malfunction
integrate	combine	Combine is the everyday word; integrate specifically implies making separate parts work as one system
obsolete	outdated	Outdated is everyday for anything no longer current; obsolete more strongly implies total replacement
redundant	superfluous	Superfluous is the general word for unnecessary excess; redundant implies duplicated function

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
cutting-edge	traditional	Direct
obsolete	current	Not exact — current just means still in use, not necessarily newest
redundant	essential	Not exact — essential means necessary, the opposite of no longer needed
revolutionise	preserve	Not exact — preserve means to keep something as it is
scalable	fixed	Not exact — fixed means unable to grow in size
seamless	disjointed	Direct — disjointed means having awkward breaks

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
adapt	adaptation	adaptable	—
automate	automation	automated	automatically
disrupt	disruption	disruptive	disruptively
innovate	innovation	innovative	innovatively
—	obsolescence	obsolete	—
revolutionise	revolution	revolutionary	—

DID YOU KNOW? — The idiom “back to the drawing board” comes from a 1941 New Yorker cartoon by Peter Arno, captioned: “Well, back to the old drawing board.”

5 Collocations

• to adapt to change	• to disrupt an industry
• to integrate new technology	• an obsolete system
• to automate a process	• a glitch in the system
• a major breakthrough	• a scalable solution
• a cutting-edge solution	• to go back to the drawing board (idiom)
• to make something redundant	• a seamless experience

FUN FACT — The word “algorithm” comes from the name of the 9th-century mathematician Muhammad ibn Musa al-Khwarizmi, who was born in Khwarazm — the region around modern-day Khiva, Uzbekistan.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
back up	to make a copy of a file or data as a precaution against loss	Always back up your work before installing a major update.
log in (to)	to enter a password or code to gain access to a computer system or account	Students log in to the portal every morning to check their assignments.
plug in	to connect a device to a power source or to another device	Once you plug in the router, it takes about a minute to start working.
roll out	to officially introduce a new product, service, or system, often gradually	The company plans to roll out the update to all users by the end of the month.
shut down	to switch off a computer, machine, or system so it stops operating	IT shut down the whole network for an hour to install the security patch.

7 Word Auction

HOW TO PLAY

Split the class into 2–3 teams, each starting with 20 points. Read a unit word aloud; teams privately bid points to claim it. The highest bidder must use the word correctly in a sentence within 10 seconds. Correct, and they keep the word; wrong, and the points are lost anyway — the word returns to auction. The team with the most correctly-used words wins, not the team with the most points left.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*It's more complicated than it seems, since…*	It's more complicated than it seems, since not every industry can integrate new technology at the same pace.
Adding weight	*Not only that, but…*	Not only that, but scalable technology means small startups can now compete with huge corporations.
Challenging a claim	*That doesn't quite hold up, since…*	That doesn't quite hold up, since most 'revolutionary' apps are really just incremental improvements.
Closing an argument	*That's precisely the reason…*	That's precisely the reason schools need to teach algorithmic thinking, not just how to use apps.
Giving evidence	*A clear example of this is…*	A clear example of this is how ride-sharing apps disrupted the taxi industry within a few years.
Hedging a claim	*It's possible that…*	It's possible that today's cutting-edge AI tools will look primitive within a decade.
Opening a viewpoint	*My take on this is…*	My take on this is that automation will create more jobs than it destroys, just different ones.
Quantifying / citing scale	*The vast majority of…*	The vast majority of factory jobs lost to automation are never replaced with equivalent pay.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Automation will destroy more jobs than it creates.
   B) Automation has always created new kinds of jobs even as it eliminates old ones.

2. **A)** Schools should integrate AI tools into every subject as early as possible.
   B) Relying on AI tools too early can stop students from developing skills they need to think for themselves.

3. **A)** Social media has revolutionised how people connect, mostly for the better.
   B) Social media has disrupted real relationships more than it has improved them.

4. **A)** Cutting-edge technology should be regulated closely before it's released to the public.
   B) Heavy regulation slows innovation and lets less careful countries take the lead instead.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Should schools teach coding and algorithms as a core subject, like maths or English?

2. Is it realistic to expect workers whose jobs become automated to simply retrain?

3. Does cutting-edge technology always make life better, or just more complicated?

4. Should there be limits on how quickly new technology can be released to the public?

10 Context Passage

Three years ago, the delivery company still processed every order by hand. A small team checked stock, printed labels, and phoned customers when something went wrong. It worked, but it was slow, and mistakes were common.

Then the company decided to automate the whole system. A new algorithm matched orders to the nearest available driver, and a scalable platform meant the same software could handle ten deliveries a day or ten thousand. At first, several staff worried the change would make their jobs redundant, and a few genuinely were. But most were retrained to manage the technology instead of doing the manual work themselves.

The transition was far from seamless. Early glitches sent drivers to the wrong addresses more than once, and the team had to go back to the drawing board twice before the system worked reliably. Still, within a year, delivery times had dropped by half. What began as a minor upgrade ended up revolutionising how the whole company operated — proof that even a cutting-edge idea usually starts out a little rough around the edges.

> **TRIVIA** — In 1947, a real moth was found jammed in a relay of the Harvard Mark II computer and taped into the logbook as the "first actual case of bug being found" — though engineers had already used "bug" for technical faults since at least the 1870s.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Matching — match each word to its definition.

1. algorithm	a. no longer used because something newer has replaced it
2. cutting-edge	b. the most advanced stage of development
3. glitch	c. a small, usually temporary problem or fault
4. obsolete	d. no longer needed because something else performs the same
5. prototype	e. able to grow larger without losing effectiveness
6. redundant	f. a set of step-by-step instructions for solving a problem
7. scalable	g. smooth and continuous, with no interruptions
8. seamless	h. an early model built to test an idea

B. Gap-fill — complete with a word from this unit (correct form).

1. Doctors are hoping for a major _____ in cancer treatment within the next decade.

2. The company had to _____ quickly when its main supplier went out of business.

3. Ride-sharing apps completely _____ the taxi industry.

4. The team built a working _____ before pitching the idea to investors.

5. Streaming services _____ the way people watch television.

6. The new software needs to _____ smoothly with the systems we already use.

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **adapt**, **disrupt**, **innovate**, **integrate**, **obsolete**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 4

Information Technology

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**authenticate** *v.*	To prove that someone is who they claim to be, especially using a password or other electronic method	The app asks you to authenticate with a fingerprint before opening.
2	**bandwidth** *n.*	The amount of data that can be sent between computers or over a network in a given time	Video calls use far more bandwidth than sending a text message.
3	**breach** *n.*	A failure in a security system that allows unauthorised access to data or a network	The company had to notify millions of customers after the breach.
4	**bug** *n.*	An error in a computer program that causes it to work incorrectly	The update was delayed because testers found a serious bug.
5	**compatible** *adj.*	Able to work with a particular type of computer, device, or system without problems	Make sure the printer is compatible with your laptop before you buy it.
6	**configure** *v.*	To set up a device or system so that it works in a particular way	It took an hour to configure the new server correctly.
7	**database** *n.*	A large amount of information stored on a computer so that it can be easily searched or changed	Customer details are stored in a central database.
8	**deploy** *v.*	To put a system, program, or update into active use	The team plans to deploy the new software company-wide next month.
9	**encrypt** *v.*	To protect information by putting it into a code that only authorised people can read	All messages sent through the app are encrypted.
10	**firewall** *n.*	A program or device that prevents unauthorised access to a computer or network	The office network is protected by a firewall.
11	**interface** *n.*	The point where a user interacts with a computer, or where two systems connect	The app's interface is simple enough for young children to use.
12	**malware** *n.*	Software specifically designed to damage a computer system or gain unauthorised access to it	Clicking the link installed malware on her laptop.
13	**outage** *n.*	A period during which a system or service is unavailable	The website was down for two hours during the outage.
14	**protocol** *n.*	A set of technical rules that control how data is exchanged between computers or devices	Every device on the network follows the same communication protocol.
15	**vulnerability** *n.*	A weakness in a system that could be exploited by an attacker	Security researchers found a vulnerability in the app's login page.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
authenticate	verify	Verify is the everyday word for confirming truth; authenticate implies formally confirming identity
breach	violation	Violation is the general word for breaking a rule; breach implies a security system was broken into
compatible	interoperable	Interoperable is the technical IT term; compatible is the everyday word
configure	set up	Set up is the everyday phrasal-verb equivalent; configure is more formal
database	repository	Repository is broader, for any storage location; database implies structured, searchable data
deploy	launch	Launch implies the public release moment; deploy is the technical process of activation
malware	virus	A virus is one type of malware that replicates itself; malware is the umbrella term
vulnerability	weakness	Weakness is general; vulnerability implies a flaw an attacker could exploit

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
authenticate	spoof	Not exact — to spoof means to fake an identity or disguise a source
compatible	incompatible	Direct — same word family
deploy	decommission	Direct — to take a system out of service
encrypt	decrypt	Direct — same root, reverses the process
outage	uptime	Direct — the period a system runs normally
vulnerability	security	Not exact — security means active protection, not just absence of weakness

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
authenticate	authentication	authenticated	—
configure	configuration	configured	—
deploy	deployment	deployed	—
encrypt	encryption	encrypted	—
—	vulnerability	vulnerable	—
—	compatibility	compatible	compatibly

DID YOU KNOW? — “Bandwidth” now also describes a person's mental capacity, not just data speed — Cambridge Dictionary records “I don't have the bandwidth for this” as standard usage.

5 Collocations

• to authenticate a user	• to configure a server
• to encrypt data	• network protocol
• to breach a firewall	• a database of records
• a fix for the bug	• to patch a vulnerability
• a compatible device	• to deploy an update
• to install malware	• a power outage

FUN FACT — A 2002 US government study estimated that software bugs cost the American economy around $59 billion a year — roughly 0.6% of GDP — in wasted testing time and lost productivity.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
back out (of)	to withdraw from or cancel something you had agreed to do	The IT team backed out of the update after users reported problems.
lock out	to prevent someone from accessing a system or account, often for security reasons	Three failed password attempts will lock you out of the account.
log out (of)	to end a session and disconnect from a computer system or account	Remember to log out of the shared computer when you're done.
patch up	to apply a fix to a piece of software, usually a temporary or partial one	The developers patched up the vulnerability within hours of it being reported.
set up	to install and prepare a system, device, or account for use	It only takes a few minutes to set up the new printer.

7 Definition Sprint

HOW TO PLAY

Read a definition aloud without saying the word it matches. The first student to correctly call out the matching unit word scores a point. First student to 5 points wins.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*This depends on a number of factors…*	This depends on a number of factors, like how quickly a patch is deployed after a bug is found.
Asking for clarification	*I'm not sure I follow — could you clarify…?*	I'm not sure I follow — could you clarify what you mean by a 'secure' system?
Challenging a claim	*I have to disagree, because…*	I have to disagree, because no firewall can fully protect a system if the passwords are weak.
Closing an argument	*Which brings me to…*	Which brings me to why every account should require proper authentication, not just a password.
Giving evidence	*This is backed up by…*	This is backed up by how many major breaches started with a single phished password.
Hedging a claim	*Arguably…*	Arguably, most companies only take security seriously after a breach, not before one.
Opening a viewpoint	*I tend to think that…*	I tend to think that most data breaches come down to human error, not weak technology.
Quantifying / citing scale	*Only a small fraction of…*	Only a small fraction of vulnerabilities are ever actually exploited by attackers.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Companies should be legally required to disclose every data breach within 24 hours.
   B) Forcing immediate disclosure can cause panic before a company even understands the scale of the breach.

2. **A)** Two-factor authentication should be mandatory for every online account.
   B) Mandatory authentication steps for every account make everyday tasks slower without stopping determined attackers.

3. **A)** Open-source software is more secure because anyone can inspect the code for bugs.
   B) Open-source software is riskier because attackers can study the same code looking for vulnerabilities to exploit.

4. **A)** IT departments should block employees from using personal devices to protect the network.
   B) Banning personal devices just pushes employees towards less secure workarounds instead of solving the problem.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Should companies be fined heavily for failing to protect customer data from a breach?

2. Is it realistic to expect ordinary users to understand basic cybersecurity, or should the responsibility sit with IT professionals?

3. Does convenience or security matter more when designing a login system?

4. Should governments be allowed to access encrypted data during criminal investigations?

10 Context Passage

The company's IT department had always treated security as a formality. Passwords were rarely updated, and the firewall configuration hadn't changed in years. Then, one Monday morning, the database went offline without warning.

At first, the outage looked like a routine server problem. But within hours, the team traced it to a breach: an attacker had exploited a vulnerability in outdated software to gain access, then deployed malware that encrypted every file on the network and demanded payment to unlock it.

The response was chaotic. Nobody could authenticate their identity to restore backups because the authentication system itself was compromised. It took three days to configure a new, compatible system from scratch, working from a database backup that was almost a week old.

The company survived, but only barely. Afterwards, the IT team rebuilt everything around a simple principle: assume a breach will happen, and design the system so that one bug or one bad password can't bring the whole network down.

> **TRIVIA** — “Firewall” originally meant a fireproof wall built between buildings, or between a car's engine and its passenger compartment, to stop fire from spreading — the computing sense borrows that same idea of a protective barrier.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Odd One Out — circle the word that doesn't belong, and be ready to explain why.

1. compatible interoperable suitable vulnerable
2. verify confirm authenticate breach
3. decrypt decode unlock encrypt
4. launch release deploy withdraw
5. virus worm malware firewall

B. Transformation — rewrite each sentence using the word in capitals in a different form, keeping the same meaning.

1. The app checks who you are before letting you log in. (AUTHENTICATION)

_____

2. It took the technician an hour to set up the new server's settings. (CONFIGURE)

_____

3. The company put the new software into use across every branch. (DEPLOYMENT)

_____

4. The app protects your messages by putting them into a secret code. (ENCRYPTION)

_____

5. Researchers found a weakness that attackers could exploit. (VULNERABLE)

_____

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **authenticate**, **breach**, **encrypt**, **firewall**, **vulnerability**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 5

Health & Wellbeing

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**ailment** *n.*	An illness, especially a minor one	A cold is a common ailment that rarely needs a doctor's visit.
2	**chronic** *adj.*	Describes an illness or condition that lasts for a long time	Chronic back pain affects nearly a third of adults at some point in their lives.
3	**deficiency** *n.*	A lack of something necessary, especially a vitamin or nutrient	Her fatigue turned out to be caused by an iron deficiency.
4	**diagnose** *v.*	To identify an illness by examining its signs and symptoms	It took three visits before doctors could diagnose the problem correctly.
5	**exhaustion** *n.*	A state of extreme physical or mental tiredness	He collapsed from exhaustion after the marathon.
6	**holistic** *adj.*	Treating the whole person, not just the specific illness or symptom	The clinic takes a holistic approach, looking at diet, sleep, and stress together.
7	**immune** *adj.*	Protected against a particular disease	Most adults are immune to chickenpox after having it as a child.
8	**malnutrition** *n.*	Poor health caused by not eating enough, or not eating the right kinds of food	Malnutrition remains a serious problem in parts of the world despite global food surpluses.
9	**prescribe** *v.*	To officially recommend a medicine or treatment	The doctor prescribed antibiotics for the infection.
10	**prevalent** *adj.*	Existing very commonly in a particular place or at a particular time	Obesity is becoming more prevalent among teenagers.
11	**rehabilitate** *v.*	To help someone return to a normal, healthy life after an illness or injury	The physiotherapist helped rehabilitate his knee after surgery.
12	**remedy** *n.*	Something that treats or cures an illness or problem	Honey and lemon is a popular home remedy for a sore throat.
13	**sedentary** *adj.*	Involving sitting down a lot and getting little physical exercise	A sedentary lifestyle increases the risk of heart disease.
14	**stamina** *n.*	The physical or mental strength to keep doing something difficult over a long time	Marathon runners need serious stamina to finish the race.
15	**symptom** *n.*	A sign in the body that shows the presence of an illness	A persistent cough can be a symptom of several different conditions.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
ailment	affliction	Affliction implies more serious or prolonged suffering; ailment implies something minor
chronic	persistent	Persistent is general for anything ongoing; chronic describes long-lasting medical conditions
diagnose	identify	Identify is general; diagnose implies a medical judgement about an illness
exhaustion	fatigue	Fatigue is the everyday clinical term for tiredness; exhaustion implies a more extreme state
prescribe	recommend	Recommend is a general suggestion; prescribe implies official medical authority
prevalent	widespread	Widespread describes anything spread over a large area; prevalent implies commonness in a group
rehabilitate	restore	Restore is general, for anything back to its original condition; rehabilitate means restoring health
sedentary	inactive	Inactive is general; sedentary describes a lifestyle or occupation involving a lot of sitting

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
chronic	acute	Not exact — acute means sudden and severe, opposite in onset and duration
exhaustion	energy	Not exact — energy is general capacity for activity
immune	susceptible	Direct — susceptible means likely to be affected by a disease
malnutrition	nourishment	Not exact — nourishment is the state of being well fed
prevalent	rare	Direct
sedentary	active	Direct

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
diagnose	diagnosis	diagnostic	—
exhaust	exhaustion	exhausted	—
prescribe	prescription	prescribed	—
rehabilitate	rehabilitation	rehabilitated	—
—	deficiency	deficient	—
—	prevalence	prevalent	—

DID YOU KNOW? — “Ailment” comes from Old English eglan (“to trouble, afflict”) plus the Latin suffix -mentum — literally, the result of being troubled.

5 Collocations

• a chronic condition	• great stamina
• a minor ailment	• to prescribe medication
• to diagnose an illness	• highly prevalent
• a natural remedy	• to rehabilitate a patient
• an early symptom	• a holistic approach
• nutrient deficiency	• a sedentary lifestyle

FUN FACT — Malnutrition — in either its undernourished or overnourished forms — is estimated to affect close to two billion people worldwide, according to clinical nutrition research.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
build up	to increase gradually in strength or amount	It takes weeks of training to build up the stamina for a marathon.
come down with	to become ill with a disease, usually a minor one	Half the class came down with the flu last week.
fight off	to successfully resist or overcome an illness or infection	A healthy immune system helps the body fight off infections.
get over	to recover fully from an illness or difficult experience	It took him almost a month to get over the flu.
pass out	to suddenly lose consciousness	She passed out from exhaustion after the long shift.

7 Word Tennis

HOW TO PLAY

Two students face off. One states a sentence using a unit word on the unit's topic; the other must respond within 10 seconds with a new sentence using a different unit word that logically continues it. Repeat a word, pause too long, or break the topic — you're out, and the next challenger steps in.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*There's no easy answer here, but…*	There's no easy answer here, but genetics, environment, and lifestyle all play a part.
Challenging a claim	*That's debatable, given that…*	That's debatable, given that many chronic conditions have no single, fixable cause.
Closing an argument	*This is why it matters that…*	This is why it matters that doctors treat the whole patient, not just the symptom.
Conceding a point	*Granted, that's true, but…*	Granted, that's true, but access to healthy food isn't equal for everyone.
Giving evidence	*Just look at…*	Just look at how quickly obesity rates rose once sedentary jobs became the norm.
Opening a viewpoint	*As I see it…*	As I see it, prevention should get more funding than treatment.
Quantifying / citing scale	*This affects a significant number of…*	This affects a significant number of people, since most adults will develop at least one chronic condition.
Softening disagreement	*I get where you're coming from, but…*	I get where you're coming from, but a holistic approach still needs real medicine behind it.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Governments should tax unhealthy food to reduce obesity and chronic disease.
   B) Taxing food unfairly punishes people who can't afford healthier alternatives in the first place.

2. **A)** A sedentary lifestyle is a personal choice, not a public health issue.
   B) When most jobs and daily life are built around sitting, it stops being purely a personal choice.

3. **A)** Alternative and holistic remedies deserve the same respect as conventional medicine.
   B) Remedies that haven't been properly tested can delay people from getting treatment that actually works.

4. **A)** Doctors prescribe medication too quickly instead of addressing the root cause of a problem.
   B) Doctors can't always wait for lifestyle changes to work when a patient needs relief now.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Should schools be responsible for teaching students about nutrition and a healthy lifestyle?

2. Is it fair to blame individuals for chronic illnesses linked to lifestyle, like a sedentary routine?

3. Do you trust holistic or alternative remedies as much as conventional medicine?

4. Should healthcare focus more on prevention or on treating illness after it appears?

10 Context Passage

For years, the clinic treated patients the same way most clinics do: a patient described their symptoms, received a diagnosis, and left with a prescription. It worked well enough for ailments like infections, but chronic conditions kept returning no matter how many times they were treated.

Eventually, the staff switched to a more holistic model. Instead of only asking what was wrong, they started asking how patients lived: how much they slept, how sedentary their jobs were, whether stress or poor diet might explain a stubborn symptom that medication alone couldn't fix.

The results surprised everyone. One patient's unexplained exhaustion turned out to be linked to an undiagnosed nutrient deficiency, not stress as everyone assumed. Another, recovering from surgery, rehabilitated far faster once the team addressed her sedentary recovery routine rather than just prescribing painkillers.

None of this replaced conventional medicine — antibiotics still cured infections, and dangerous conditions still needed urgent treatment. But for prevalent, everyday complaints, treating the whole person, not just the symptom, often worked better than a quick remedy ever could.

> **TRIVIA** — The term “holism” was coined in 1926 by Jan Smuts, a South African statesman and philosopher, in his book Holism and Evolution — decades before “holistic” entered everyday medical language.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Matching — match each word to its definition.

1. ailment	a. protected against a disease
2. chronic	b. involving sitting down a lot and little exercise
3. holistic	c. an illness, especially a minor one
4. immune	d. lasting for a long time
5. prevalent	e. the physical or mental strength to keep going
6. rehabilitate	f. existing very commonly
7. sedentary	g. treating the whole person, not just the illness
8. stamina	h. to help someone return to health or normal life

B. Gap-fill — complete with a word from this unit (correct form).

1. The doctor could not _____ the illness without further tests.

2. A cold is usually a minor _____ that clears up on its own.

3. Years of a _____ lifestyle finally caught up with him.

4. Her fatigue was traced back to an iron _____ .

5. The clinic _____ a two-week course of antibiotics.

6. Athletes need real _____ to finish a marathon.

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **chronic**, **diagnose**, **immune**, **prescribe**, **symptom**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 6

Work & Careers

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**applicant** *n.*	A person who formally applies for a job	Over two hundred applicants applied for the position.
2	**burnout** *n.*	Extreme tiredness or mental exhaustion caused by working too hard for too long	Long hours with no break eventually led to burnout.
3	**commute** *v.*	To travel regularly between home and work	She commutes an hour each way by train.
4	**credentials** *n.*	The qualifications and experience that make someone suitable for a job	His academic credentials made him the strongest candidate.
5	**delegate** *v.*	To give part of your job or a task to someone else to do	A good manager knows when to delegate rather than doing everything alone.
6	**dismiss** *v.*	To officially remove someone from their job	He was dismissed after repeated lateness.
7	**entrepreneur** *n.*	A person who starts and runs their own business, especially one involving financial risk	She left her job to become an entrepreneur.
8	**incentive** *n.*	Something that encourages a person to work harder or behave in a particular way	The bonus scheme is a strong incentive to hit targets.
9	**lucrative** *adj.*	Producing a lot of money; profitable	He turned down a lucrative offer to stay with a company he believed in.
10	**negotiate** *v.*	To discuss something formally in order to reach an agreement	The union negotiated a better contract for its members.
11	**nepotism** *n.*	Unfairly giving jobs or advantages to relatives or friends	Employees complained about nepotism after the manager's nephew was promoted.
12	**outsource** *v.*	To pay another company to do work rather than using your own employees	The firm decided to outsource its customer service department.
13	**probation** *n.*	A trial period at the start of a job during which performance is closely watched	New staff are on probation for the first three months.
14	**resign** *v.*	To formally announce that you are leaving your job	She resigned after fifteen years with the company.
15	**vacancy** *n.*	A job that is available and not yet filled	The company has a vacancy for a marketing assistant.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
applicant	candidate	Candidate is broader, used for elections or awards too; applicant specifically means someone who applied
delegate	assign	Assign is general, for giving any task; delegate specifically means passing on authority or responsibility
dismiss	fire	Fire is informal; dismiss is the more formal, official term
entrepreneur	founder	Founder emphasises starting an organisation; entrepreneur emphasises risk-taking and profit
lucrative	profitable	Profitable is the general business term; lucrative implies a notably high level of profit
negotiate	bargain	Bargain is informal, often about price; negotiate is formal, covering any terms of agreement
outsource	subcontract	Subcontract implies passing on part of a specific contract; outsource is broader
resign	quit	Quit is informal; resign is the formal, official term

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
dismiss	hire	Direct
lucrative	unprofitable	Direct
nepotism	meritocracy	Not exact — meritocracy means advancement based on ability, not favouritism
probation	permanent	Not exact — permanent means the position is no longer under trial
resign	remain	Not exact — remain simply means to stay in a post
vacancy	occupied	Direct — a filled, not empty, position

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
delegate	delegation	delegated	—
dismiss	dismissal	dismissed	—
negotiate	negotiation	negotiable	—
resign	resignation	resigned	—
—	entrepreneurship	entrepreneurial	—
—	probation	probationary	—

DID YOU KNOW? — The WHO officially recognised “burnout” as an occupational phenomenon in its International Classification of Diseases in May 2019 — though it stressed burnout is not itself a medical condition.

5 Collocations

• burnout risk	• to delegate a task
• job applicant	• to negotiate a deal
• a case of nepotism	• to dismiss an employee
• job vacancy	• to outsource production
• daily commute	• impressive credentials
• a lucrative contract	• a probation period

FUN FACT — “Negotiate” comes from Latin negotium (“business”), itself built from nec (“not”) and otium (“leisure”) — business was, quite literally, the opposite of leisure.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
branch out (into)	to expand into a new area of business or activity	The bakery decided to branch out into catering.
fill in (for)	to do someone else's job temporarily while they are away	She filled in for her manager while he was on leave.
lay off	to dismiss employees, usually because there isn't enough work	The factory laid off two hundred workers last year.
step down	to resign from an important position	The CEO stepped down after the scandal.
take on	to hire someone, or to accept a new responsibility	The company is taking on ten new graduates this year.

7 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*This isn't a simple issue, because…*	This isn't a simple issue, because what counts as nepotism versus normal networking isn't always clear.
Challenging a claim	*I'm not convinced that…*	I'm not convinced that outsourcing always saves a company money in the long run.
Closing an argument	*Which is why…*	Which is why companies that delegate real responsibility tend to keep their best staff longer.
Conceding a point	*That's fair, but…*	That's fair, but a lucrative offer doesn't mean much if the job causes constant burnout.
Drawing a comparison	*Compared to…*	Compared to a long commute, remote work can save employees hours every single week.
Giving evidence	*This is evident in…*	This is evident in how many skilled workers leave jobs that offer no incentive to stay.
Opening a viewpoint	*I'd argue that…*	I'd argue that job security matters more to most workers than a slightly higher salary.
Quantifying / citing scale	*The scale of this is significant because…*	The scale of this is significant because most people will change careers several times in their life.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Companies should be required to advertise every vacancy publicly rather than hiring through personal connections.
   B) Hiring people you already know and trust isn't nepotism — it's simply reducing risk.

2. **A)** Employers have no right to expect employees to answer messages outside working hours.
   B) In some lucrative, fast-moving industries, being reachable outside hours is simply part of the job.

3. **A)** A long commute is a bigger drain on wellbeing than most people admit.
   B) Remote work has its own hidden costs, like isolation and blurred boundaries between work and home.

4. **A)** Companies should be able to dismiss underperforming staff quickly and without lengthy procedures.
   B) Fast dismissal without due process just makes it easier for managers to fire people unfairly.

8 Debate Roulette

HOW TO PLAY

Number the Argument & Counter statements above. Randomly assign a number to a student — they must argue that position for 30 seconds, even if it isn't their real opinion. Optional: a second student instantly argues the counter.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Would you rather have a stable, average-paying job or take the risk of becoming an entrepreneur?

2. Is it fair for a company to dismiss an employee during a probation period without giving a reason?

3. Should employees be paid more to compensate for a long commute?

4. How much should salary and incentives matter compared to job satisfaction?

10 Context Passage

The company had always hired the same way: post a vacancy, review the applicants, negotiate a salary, and hope the new hire worked out. It was slow, but it was fair.

That changed when the new director took over. Within months, several key roles had been filled by his relatives, and staff who had worked there for years began quietly resigning. Nobody used the word nepotism out loud, but everyone was thinking it.

The turning point came when the company tried to outsource part of its production to cut costs. Without enough skilled staff left to delegate the work to, quality slipped, and a major client walked away. The board finally stepped in.

New credentials requirements were introduced for every vacancy, along with a proper probation period and a clear incentive structure tied to performance, not connections. It wasn't a lucrative fix overnight, and morale took time to recover from the burnout of the previous year. But within a year, the company had rebuilt something closer to what it used to be: a place where an applicant's ability, not their last name, decided whether they got the job.

> **TRIVIA** — “Entrepreneur” comes from the French entreprendre, meaning “to undertake” — the word entered English business vocabulary in the mid-18th century, long before it took on its modern go-getter connotation.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Odd One Out — circle the word that doesn't belong, and be ready to explain why.

1. applicant candidate nominee vacancy
2. dismiss fire sack hire
3. lucrative profitable rewarding worthless
4. negotiate bargain discuss dictate
5. probation trial permanent provisional

B. Transformation — rewrite each sentence using the word in capitals in a different form, keeping the same meaning.

1. The manager gave the task to her assistant to handle. (DELEGATED)

_____

2. The company officially removed him from his position. (DISMISSAL)

_____

3. The two sides finally reached an agreement after weeks of talks. (NEGOTIATED)

_____

4. She officially told her employer she was leaving the company. (RESIGNATION)

_____

5. He is a very skilled business founder and risk-taker. (ENTREPRENEURIAL)

_____

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **dismiss**, **entrepreneur**, **negotiate**, **probation**, **vacancy**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 7

Business & Management

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**acquisition** *n.*	The act of buying another company, or the company bought	The acquisition of its biggest competitor doubled the company's market share overnight.
2	**asset** *n.*	Something valuable that a company owns and can use to generate income	Property and equipment are the company's biggest assets.
3	**bankrupt** *adj.*	Legally unable to pay what you owe	The airline went bankrupt after years of rising fuel costs.
4	**conglomerate** *n.*	A large corporation made up of several smaller, often unrelated companies	The conglomerate owns businesses ranging from insurance to electronics.
5	**dividend** *n.*	A portion of a company's profit paid to shareholders	Shareholders received a higher dividend after a record year of sales.
6	**franchise** *n.*	The right to sell a company's products or services under its name in a particular area	She opened a coffee shop franchise instead of starting her own brand from scratch.
7	**liability** *n.*	A debt or financial obligation a company owes	The company's liabilities now exceed the value of everything it owns.
8	**liquidate** *v.*	To close a business and sell its assets in order to pay off debts	The court ordered the company to liquidate after it failed to repay its creditors.
9	**margin** *n.*	The difference between what something costs to produce and the price it sells for	Rising fuel costs squeezed the airline's profit margin.
10	**merger** *n.*	The joining of two companies to form one	The merger created the largest telecoms company in the country.
11	**monopoly** *n.*	Complete control of a market by a single company, leaving no real competition	The government broke up the monopoly to encourage competition.
12	**overhead** *n.*	The regular ongoing costs of running a business, such as rent and utilities	Working from home let the startup keep its overhead extremely low.
13	**revenue** *n.*	The total income a business generates, before costs are subtracted	The company's revenue grew by 20% last year, though profit barely changed.
14	**stakeholder** *n.*	A person or group with an interest in a company's success, such as an employee, investor, or customer	Any major decision has to consider the interests of every stakeholder, not just shareholders.
15	**subsidiary** *n.*	A company that is owned or controlled by a larger company	The car brand is a subsidiary of a much bigger automotive group.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
acquisition	takeover	Takeover is informal, often implies the target resisted; acquisition is the neutral formal term
asset	resource	Resource is broader, covering anything useful; asset implies recorded financial value
bankrupt	insolvent	Insolvent is the formal/legal term used before a company is officially declared bankrupt
liability	debt	Debt specifically means money owed; liability is broader, covering any financial obligation
liquidate	dissolve	Dissolve means legally ending a company's existence; liquidate means converting its assets to cash first
merger	amalgamation	Amalgamation is formal, used in legal documents; merger is the everyday business term
subsidiary	affiliate	Affiliate implies a looser connection; subsidiary implies clear ownership by a parent company

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
asset	liability	Direct — the standard business opposite pair
bankrupt	solvent	Direct — able to pay one's debts
liquidate	establish	Not exact — establish means to set up a business, not close one
merger	demerger	Direct — same word family, splitting a company apart
monopoly	competition	Not exact — a monopoly is defined by the absence of real competition
revenue	expenditure	Direct — money coming in versus money going out

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
acquire	acquisition	acquired	—
liquidate	liquidation	liquidated	—
merge	merger	merged	—
monopolise	monopoly	monopolistic	—
—	bankruptcy	bankrupt	—
—	liability	liable	—

DID YOU KNOW? — According to the US Bureau of Labor Statistics, close to half of new businesses close within their first five years — not the often-cited 90%, but sobering all the same.

5 Collocations

• to accept liability	• to go bankrupt
• a merger deal	• profit margin
• to acquire a company	• to liquidate assets
• to open a franchise	• to reduce overhead
• a global conglomerate	• market monopoly
• to pay a dividend	• a valuable asset

FUN FACT — The board game Monopoly began life in 1904 as “The Landlord's Game,” designed by Elizabeth Magie specifically to demonstrate the dangers of unchecked monopolies — not to celebrate them.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
buy out	to purchase all of someone's shares or interest in a business	The founders were bought out by a much larger competitor.
cash in (on)	to take financial advantage of a popular trend or situation	Several small brands tried to cash in on the sudden demand for reusable bottles.
pay off	to fully repay a debt	It took the company five years to pay off its original loan.
wind up	to close down a company and settle its affairs	Shareholders voted to wind up the company rather than keep it running at a loss.
write off	to officially accept that a debt or loss will not be recovered	The bank had to write off millions in unpaid loans.

7 Synonym Swap

HOW TO PLAY

Read a sentence containing a basic or weak word aloud. Students race to replace it with the best-fitting synonym from the unit's Synonym Sets table. Whoever answers first must justify why their word fits the register or context better than the basic word.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*There are several sides to this…*	There are several sides to this, since a monopoly can sometimes mean lower prices through efficiency, not just higher ones through control.
Adding weight	*On top of that…*	On top of that, a merger rarely delivers the savings it promises on paper.
Challenging a claim	*I'd push back on that, because…*	I'd push back on that, because a high revenue figure means nothing if the margin keeps shrinking.
Closing an argument	*This is exactly why…*	This is exactly why every stakeholder, not just investors, deserves a say in a major acquisition.
Drawing a comparison	*Unlike…*	Unlike a franchise, building your own brand from nothing takes far longer to turn a profit.
Giving evidence	*You can see this in…*	You can see this in how many conglomerates eventually sell off unrelated subsidiaries to refocus.
Opening a viewpoint	*From my point of view…*	From my point of view, a company's first duty is to its shareholders, not its stakeholders.
Quantifying / citing scale	*A large proportion of…*	A large proportion of small businesses go bankrupt within their first five years.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** A company's only real responsibility is to maximise profit for its shareholders.
   B) A company that ignores its other stakeholders eventually damages its own long-term profits too.

2. **A)** Governments should break up any company that becomes a monopoly in its market.
   B) Some monopolies exist because a company is simply more efficient, not because it broke the rules.

3. **A)** Buying a franchise is a safer way to start a business than building an independent brand.
   B) A franchise limits how much control and creativity an owner actually has over their own business.

4. **A)** A company on the edge of bankruptcy should be allowed to fail rather than be rescued with public money.
   B) Letting a large employer go bankrupt can damage an entire local economy, not just the company itself.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Should shareholders' interests always come before those of employees and customers?

2. Are monopolies always bad for consumers, or can they sometimes bring benefits?

3. Would you rather work for a small, independent company or a large conglomerate?

4. Should governments ever use public money to prevent a large company from going bankrupt?

10 Context Passage

Three years ago, the company was a single, modestly profitable shop. Then came an acquisition offer: a large conglomerate wanted to buy it and fold it into a national chain as a subsidiary.

The owners nearly refused. Independence mattered more to them than revenue. But the offer was hard to ignore — investment, lower overhead through shared suppliers, and protection from ever again losing a bankrupt supplier overnight. In exchange, some control would go, and a share of future profit would leave as dividend payments to shareholders who had never set foot in the store.

They negotiated instead of accepting outright: a franchise-style deal that kept the original name and most daily decisions local, while the parent company absorbed the financial risk. It wasn't a merger of equals. But margins improved almost immediately once shared purchasing began, and the shop avoided the fate of two competitors forced to liquidate that same year.

Not every stakeholder got everything they wanted. But three years on, the shop was still open — in an industry with a brutal failure rate, that counted as a genuine win.

TRIVIA — “Bankrupt” comes from the Italian banca rotta — “broken bench”. Medieval Italian moneylenders worked from a bench in the marketplace, and when one became insolvent, the bench was physically broken to show they were no longer in business.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Matching — match each word to its definition.

1. acquisition	a. legally unable to pay what you owe
2. bankrupt	b. a debt or financial obligation
3. conglomerate	c. the act of buying another company
4. dividend	d. a large corporation made of several smaller companies
5. liability	e. complete control of a market by one company
6. margin	f. a portion of profit paid to shareholders
7. monopoly	g. a company owned by a larger company
8. subsidiary	h. the difference between cost and selling price

B. Gap-fill — complete with a word from this unit (correct form).

1. The two companies announced a _____ that will create the country's largest retailer.

2. Investors were pleased when the company increased its annual _____ .

3. The startup kept its _____ low by letting employees work from home.

4. The business had to _____ its assets after failing to repay its loans.

5. Rising costs squeezed the company's profit _____ this year.

6. She opened a _____ of the popular coffee chain in her hometown.

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **acquisition**, **bankrupt**, **liability**, **merger**, **revenue**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 8

Crime & Justice

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**accomplice** *n.*	A person who helps another commit a crime	The getaway driver was charged as an accomplice to the robbery.
2	**acquit** *v.*	To formally declare someone not guilty of a crime	The jury acquitted her after just two hours of deliberation.
3	**allege** *v.*	To claim that someone has done something illegal or wrong, without yet proving it	Prosecutors allege that he forged the documents himself.
4	**convict** *v.*	To formally declare someone guilty of a crime in a court of law	He was convicted of fraud and sentenced to three years.
5	**culprit** *n.*	A person who has committed a crime or done something wrong	Police eventually identified the culprit through fingerprint evidence.
6	**custody** *n.*	The state of being detained by the police, usually before a trial	The suspect was taken into custody shortly after midnight.
7	**deter** *v.*	To discourage someone from doing something by making them afraid of the consequences	Better street lighting is thought to deter petty crime.
8	**felony** *n.*	A serious crime, usually punishable by a year or more in prison	Armed robbery is treated as a felony in almost every jurisdiction.
9	**forensic** *adj.*	Relating to the scientific methods used to investigate crime	Forensic evidence linked the suspect directly to the scene.
10	**incarcerate** *v.*	To put someone in prison	The country incarcerates a higher proportion of its population than almost any other.
11	**interrogate** *v.*	To question someone closely and often forcefully, especially a suspect	Detectives interrogated the suspect for nearly six hours.
12	**offender** *n.*	A person who has committed a crime	First-time offenders are sometimes offered community service instead of prison.
13	**parole** *n.*	The early release of a prisoner on condition of good behaviour	He was released on parole after serving two-thirds of his sentence.
14	**testimony** *n.*	A formal statement, especially one given in court, about what someone knows or has witnessed	Her testimony was the strongest piece of evidence in the trial.
15	**vandalism** *n.*	The deliberate destruction of property	The bus shelter was covered in graffiti, a clear case of vandalism.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
accomplice	associate	Associate is neutral, for any connection; accomplice implies specific involvement in wrongdoing
allege	claim	Claim is general; allege specifically means an unproven accusation of wrongdoing
culprit	perpetrator	Perpetrator is formal, common in legal writing; culprit is everyday, sometimes used for minor issues
deter	discourage	Discourage is general; deter specifically means preventing action through fear
forensic	scientific	Scientific is general; forensic means applied specifically to legal or criminal investigation
incarcerate	imprison	Imprison is everyday; incarcerate is more formal, common in official writing
interrogate	question	Question is neutral; interrogate implies a forceful, formal, often adversarial process
offender	lawbreaker	Lawbreaker is a general everyday term; offender is the official term used in courts

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
acquit	convict	Direct — the standard legal opposite pair
custody	freedom	Not exact — freedom is the general absence of restraint
deter	encourage	Direct
incarcerate	release	Direct
offender	victim	Not exact — contrasts who commits a crime with who it happens to
vandalism	preservation	Not exact — preservation means actively protecting property, not just not damaging it

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
allege	allegation	alleged	allegedly
convict	conviction	convicted	—
deter	deterrence	deterrent	—
incarcerate	incarceration	incarcerated	—
interrogate	interrogation	interrogated	—
vandalise	vandalism	vandalised	—

DID YOU KNOW? — “Parole” comes from French parole (“word, spoken promise”) — medieval prisoners were released on their word of honour to behave.

5 Collocations

• an accomplice to the crime	• to convict someone of a crime
• to identify the culprit	• released on parole
• to allege wrongdoing	• eyewitness testimony
• to incarcerate an offender	• a strong deterrent
• to commit a felony	• forensic evidence
• to interrogate a suspect	• to take into custody

FUN FACT — Eyewitness misidentification has played a role in around 69% of DNA exonerations in the US, according to the Innocence Project — making it the leading known cause of wrongful conviction.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
break into	to enter a building illegally, usually by force	Someone broke into the pharmacy overnight and stole prescription drugs.
carry out	to commit or execute a crime or plan	The gang carried out three robberies in the same week.
get away with	to do something wrong without being caught or punished	He nearly got away with the fraud before an audit exposed it.
let off	to not punish someone, or to punish them only lightly	The judge let him off with a warning for his first offence.
track down	to find someone or something after a search	It took detectives almost a year to track down the culprit.

7 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*It's more complicated than it seems, since…*	It's more complicated than it seems, since custody, parole, and rehabilitation all have different goals.
Challenging a claim	*That doesn't quite hold up, since…*	That doesn't quite hold up, since harsher sentences don't clearly deter crime in most studies.
Closing an argument	*That's precisely the reason…*	That's precisely the reason eyewitness testimony alone should never be enough to convict someone.
Conceding a point	*I'll admit that's true, but…*	I'll admit that's true, but a criminal record can still follow someone long after they've served their time.
Drawing a comparison	*In contrast to…*	In contrast to a felony conviction, a minor offence rarely follows someone for life.
Giving evidence	*A clear example of this is…*	A clear example of this is how forensic evidence has overturned convictions decades after the fact.
Opening a viewpoint	*My take on this is…*	My take on this is that prisons should focus on rehabilitation, not just punishment.
Quantifying / citing scale	*The vast majority of…*	The vast majority of offenders who reoffend do so within the first few years of release.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Courts should rely more heavily on forensic evidence than on eyewitness testimony.
   B) Forensic evidence can be mishandled or misinterpreted just as easily as a witness can be mistaken.

2. **A)** Releasing offenders on parole makes communities less safe.
   B) Parole gives offenders a real incentive to behave well, which prison alone does not.

3. **A)** Harsh punishment is the most effective way to deter crime.
   B) Rehabilitation programmes reduce reoffending more effectively than punishment alone.

4. **A)** A person's criminal record should follow them for life, even after they've served their sentence.
   B) Permanently labelling someone by a past conviction makes it harder for them to ever stop offending.

8 Flip the Statement

HOW TO PLAY

Pick any Argument (A) from the Argument & Counter section above. The student must argue the Counter (B) position convincingly, on the spot, without reading the printed counter.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Should prisons focus more on punishment or rehabilitation?

2. Is it fair to convict someone based on eyewitness testimony alone?

3. Does a criminal record deserve to follow someone for the rest of their life?

4. Are harsher sentences an effective deterrent, or do they simply fill prisons?

10 Context Passage

For years, the case had gone cold. Police believed the culprit was long gone, and without new evidence, no one could be charged, let alone convicted.

Everything changed when a forensic team reopened the file using DNA testing that hadn't existed at the time of the original investigation. The evidence pointed to a man already in custody for an unrelated offence. Detectives brought him in and interrogated him for hours before he finally admitted his role, naming an accomplice who had never been identified.

The trial that followed relied almost entirely on forensic testimony rather than eyewitness accounts, which had proven unreliable the first time around. The jury convicted both men; one was sentenced to serve his term in full, while the other, already older and in poor health, was later granted parole.

Critics questioned whether the sentence still served as a deterrent decades after the crime, or whether it mainly offered the victim's family a sense that justice, however delayed, had finally caught up with the offenders.

> **TRIVIA** — Harry Jackson became the first person convicted in the UK using fingerprint evidence, in 1902 — for stealing a set of billiard balls. He left a single thumbprint on a freshly painted windowsill.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Odd One Out — circle the word that doesn't belong, and be ready to explain why.

1. allege claim assert prove
2. acquit clear exonerate convict
3. incarcerate imprison jail release
4. offender culprit perpetrator victim
5. deter discourage prevent encourage

B. Transformation — rewrite each sentence using the word in capitals in a different form, keeping the same meaning.

1. Investigators say he stole the funds, though this hasn't been proven. (ALLEGATION)

_____

2. The court's decision to find him guilty surprised no one. (CONVICTION)

_____

3. Harsher sentences are supposed to stop people committing crimes. (DETERRENT)

_____

4. The government decided to keep him in prison for another five years. (INCARCERATION)

_____

5. Police questioned the suspect for six hours straight. (INTERROGATION)

_____

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **acquit**, **convict**, **custody**, **forensic**, **testimony**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 9

Jurisprudence

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**amend** *v.*	To make small changes to a law or legal document	The committee voted to amend the clause before the final reading.
2	**appeal** *v.*	To ask a higher court to reconsider a legal decision	Her lawyers immediately said they would appeal the verdict.
3	**arbitration** *n.*	A way of settling a dispute outside court, using an independent person to decide	The two companies agreed to arbitration rather than a lengthy court case.
4	**binding** *adj.*	Legally required to be obeyed	Once both parties sign, the contract becomes legally binding.
5	**clause** *n.*	A particular section of a legal document	A single clause in the contract caused most of the disagreement.
6	**defendant** *n.*	The person being sued or accused in a court case	The defendant maintained his innocence throughout the trial.
7	**injunction** *n.*	An official court order to do or stop doing something	The court granted an injunction preventing the sale from going ahead.
8	**jurisdiction** *n.*	The official power to make legal decisions	The case falls outside the court's jurisdiction.
9	**legislation** *n.*	A law or set of laws	New legislation requires companies to disclose their emissions.
10	**litigation** *n.*	The process of taking a dispute through the courts	Years of litigation left both companies financially exhausted.
11	**plaintiff** *n.*	The person who brings a case against someone else in court	The plaintiff claimed she had been unfairly dismissed.
12	**precedent** *n.*	An earlier legal case used as a guide for later decisions	The ruling set a precedent that lower courts would follow for decades.
13	**ratify** *v.*	To make an agreement officially valid through formal approval	Parliament still needs to ratify the treaty before it takes effect.
14	**statute** *n.*	A written law formally passed by a governing body	The statute has remained unchanged since it was first written.
15	**tribunal** *n.*	A special court or committee set up to deal with particular kinds of disputes	She took her case to an employment tribunal.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
amend	revise	Revise is general, for any change to a text; amend implies a formal, often minor, legal correction
appeal	contest	Contest is general; appeal specifically means asking a higher formal authority to reconsider
binding	obligatory	Obligatory is general, required by any rule; binding implies legal enforceability
litigation	lawsuit	Lawsuit is one specific case; litigation is the whole legal process, sometimes across cases
plaintiff	claimant	Claimant is the more common term in UK civil law today; plaintiff is more traditional usage
precedent	example	Example is general; precedent implies a past case with binding or persuasive legal authority
ratify	approve	Approve is general; ratify implies a formal act that makes something legally valid
tribunal	court	Court is the general everyday word; tribunal implies a more specialised, less formal panel

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
amend	preserve	Not exact — preserve means to keep something unchanged
binding	optional	Not exact — optional means there's no obligation to comply
litigation	settlement	Not exact — settlement means a dispute resolved without going to trial
plaintiff	defendant	Direct — the standard legal opposite pair
ratify	reject	Direct
statute	custom	Not exact — custom is unwritten, informal practice rather than formal law

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
amend	amendment	amended	—
arbitrate	arbitration	arbitrated	—
legislate	legislation	legislative	—
litigate	litigation	litigious	—
ratify	ratification	ratified	—
—	jurisdiction	jurisdictional	—

DID YOU KNOW? — Fewer than 3% of US civil lawsuits ever reach a full trial verdict — the rest are settled, dismissed, or resolved another way before it gets that far.

5 Collocations

• to amend legislation	• a court's jurisdiction
• an independent tribunal	• prolonged litigation
• to appeal a ruling	• the defendant's lawyer
• a legal precedent	• to ratify a treaty
• binding arbitration	• to file for an injunction
• the plaintiff's claim	• a written statute

FUN FACT — “Tribunal” comes from Latin tribunal, the raised judgment seat of a tribunus (tribune) — a magistrate of the Roman Republic.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
draw up	to prepare and write a formal document	Lawyers spent weeks drawing up the contract.
hand down	to officially deliver a court decision or ruling	The judge is expected to hand down her ruling next week.
rule on	to make an official decision about a legal matter	The tribunal is due to rule on the case by Friday.
sign off (on)	to give official approval to something	The board still needs to sign off on the settlement.
throw out	to officially reject or dismiss a case or claim	The judge threw out the case for lack of evidence.

7 Speed Interview

HOW TO PLAY

One student is the interviewee. Classmates take turns asking questions that must include a unit word; the interviewee must also answer using a unit word each time. Run for 2 minutes, then switch interviewee.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*This depends on a number of factors…*	This depends on a number of factors, since a tribunal and a full court don't always follow the same standard of proof.
Challenging a claim	*I have to disagree, because…*	I have to disagree, because a single precedent shouldn't automatically bind every future case.
Closing an argument	*Which brings me to…*	Which brings me to why every contract needs a clear, unambiguous clause covering what happens if either side breaks it.
Conceding a point	*You have a point there, though…*	You have a point there, though a binding contract still needs to be fair to both sides to be enforced properly.
Drawing a comparison	*Similarly…*	Similarly, an injunction can stop harm from happening, while damages can only pay for harm that's already occurred.
Giving evidence	*This is backed up by…*	This is backed up by how often appeals succeed simply because of a flawed original ruling.
Opening a viewpoint	*I tend to think that…*	I tend to think that arbitration is often a fairer option than a lengthy court case.
Quantifying / citing scale	*Only a small fraction of…*	Only a small fraction of civil disputes ever reach a full trial.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Arbitration should be used more often instead of going to court.
   B) Arbitration can favour whichever side has more experience with the process, which isn't always fair.

2. **A)** Courts should always follow precedent, even when the original ruling seems outdated.
   B) Blindly following precedent can lock in mistakes that should be corrected as understanding changes.

3. **A)** Every contract should be reviewed by a lawyer before it's signed.
   B) Requiring a lawyer for every contract makes simple agreements slower and more expensive than they need to be.

4. **A)** A tribunal is a faster, fairer way to resolve workplace disputes than a full court case.
   B) A tribunal's more relaxed procedure can mean weaker protection for the person bringing the complaint.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Should every legal dispute go through arbitration before it's allowed to reach a full court?

2. Is it fair for courts to be bound by precedent set decades or even centuries ago?

3. Should ordinary people be expected to fully understand every clause they sign?

4. What makes a tribunal different from a regular court, and should it be?

10 Context Passage

The dispute began over a single clause. A small manufacturer and one of its suppliers disagreed about who was responsible for a shipment damaged in transit, and neither side would back down.

Rather than go straight to litigation, both parties agreed to arbitration. An independent arbitrator reviewed the contract, listened to both sides, and issued a decision within six weeks — far faster than a court case would have taken. The ruling was binding: once delivered, neither side could simply ignore it.

The manufacturer, unhappy with the outcome, looked into whether they could appeal. Their lawyer explained that binding arbitration rarely allows for one, unlike a decision from a tribunal or a full court, where a losing party can usually ask a higher authority to reconsider.

In the end, the company decided against fighting the decision further. The cost of prolonged litigation, they concluded, would likely exceed whatever they might eventually recover — a calculation that shapes far more legal disputes than most people realise.

TRIVIA — The Code of Hammurabi (c. 1754 BC) is often called the oldest written law code, but the Sumerian Code of Ur-Nammu actually predates it by roughly 250 years.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Matching — match each word to its definition.

1. amend	a. legally required to be obeyed
2. appeal	b. the person who brings a case against someone else in court
3. arbitration	c. to make small changes to a law or document
4. binding	d. a way of settling a dispute outside court using an independent
5. litigation	e. an earlier legal case used as a guide for later decisions
6. plaintiff	f. a special court or committee for particular disputes
7. precedent	g. to ask a higher court to reconsider a decision
8. tribunal	h. the process of taking a dispute through the courts

B. Gap-fill — complete with a word from this unit (correct form).

1. The earlier case set a _____ that judges still follow today.

2. Parliament finally _____ the new law after months of debate.

3. Both companies agreed to settle the dispute through _____ rather than go to court.

4. The company had to _____ the contract after the original terms proved unworkable.

5. The judge issued an _____ ordering the factory to stop dumping waste immediately.

6. The _____ argued that she had been unfairly dismissed from her job.

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **binding**, **clause**, **jurisdiction**, **litigation**, **statute**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 10

Media & Communication

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**anonymous** *adj.*	Not named or identified	The tip came from an anonymous source inside the company.
2	**bias** *n.*	An unfair tendency to favour one side over another	Readers accused the newspaper of political bias in its election coverage.
3	**broadcast** *v.*	To transmit a programme on television or radio	The debate was broadcast live to millions of viewers.
4	**censorship** *n.*	The suppression of information or media considered objectionable	The film faced censorship in several countries over its violent scenes.
5	**correspondent** *n.*	A journalist who reports news from a particular place or on a particular subject	Our correspondent in the region sent this report just an hour ago.
6	**coverage** *n.*	The reporting of a news event by the media	The election received wall-to-wall coverage on every channel.
7	**credible** *adj.*	Able to be believed or trusted	The report cited several credible sources before publishing the claim.
8	**disseminate** *v.*	To spread information widely	The agency's job is to disseminate accurate public health information quickly.
9	**editorial** *n.*	An article expressing the opinion of a publication's editors	The newspaper's editorial criticised the new policy sharply.
10	**headline** *n.*	The title of a news story, printed in large type	The story made headlines around the world within hours.
11	**misinformation** *n.*	False information spread regardless of intent to deceive	Health officials struggled to correct the misinformation spreading online.
12	**outlet** *n.*	An organisation that publishes or broadcasts news	Several major outlets picked up the story by the following morning.
13	**propaganda** *n.*	Biased or misleading information spread to promote a particular cause	The posters were dismissed by critics as government propaganda.
14	**sensationalise** *v.*	To present information in an exaggerated or shocking way to attract attention	Critics accused the network of sensationalising the crime to boost ratings.
15	**tabloid** *n.*	A newspaper with small pages that focuses on sensational stories	The affair was front-page news in every tabloid by the weekend.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
bias	partiality	Partiality is formal, neutral register; bias is everyday, often implying unfairness
censorship	suppression	Suppression is broader, any act of preventing something being known; censorship means official media control
correspondent	reporter	Reporter is the general everyday term; correspondent implies reporting from a place or specialist subject
credible	plausible	Plausible means merely reasonable on the surface; credible implies genuine trustworthiness
disseminate	distribute	Distribute is neutral, for sharing anything; disseminate means spreading information widely
misinformation	inaccuracy	Inaccuracy is general, for any mistake; misinformation means false information being spread
outlet	publication	Publication implies print specifically; outlet is broader, covering broadcast and online too
sensationalise	exaggerate	Exaggerate is general; sensationalise means doing so to provoke a strong reaction

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
anonymous	named	Direct
bias	neutrality	Direct — the absence of an unfair leaning
censorship	openness	Not exact — openness means information flows freely, not restricted
credible	dubious	Direct
misinformation	fact	Not exact — fact means verified true information
sensationalise	downplay	Direct — to minimise significance rather than exaggerate it

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
censor	censorship	censored	—
disseminate	dissemination	disseminated	—
misinform	misinformation	misinformed	—
sensationalise	sensationalism	sensationalised	—
—	bias	biased	—
—	credibility	credible	credibly

DID YOU KNOW? — “Broadcast” was originally a farming term for scattering seed by hand across a field — radio stations borrowed the word in the 1920s for scattering a signal just as widely.

5 Collocations

• an anonymous source	• to disseminate information
• a front-page headline	• a newspaper editorial
• to broadcast live	• extensive coverage
• media bias	• to spread misinformation
• a credible source	• a foreign correspondent
• a news outlet	• strict censorship

FUN FACT — Research on newspaper reading shows that even experienced readers spend most of their time scanning headlines rather than reading the full story underneath.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
cover up	to hide information or wrongdoing from becoming public	The company was accused of trying to cover up the safety failure.
leak out	(of secret information) to become known despite efforts to keep it hidden	Details of the merger leaked out days before the official announcement.
pick up (on)	to notice something and report or comment on it	Several outlets picked up on the story within hours.
put out	to release or publish a statement, story, or piece of information	The network put out a correction the following morning.
speak out	to publicly express an opinion, especially about something controversial	More journalists are speaking out about pressure from editors.

7 Vocabulary Chain

HOW TO PLAY

In a circle or line, the first student says one sentence using a word from this unit. The next student must use a different unit word in a new sentence that connects logically to the one before it. Keep going around the group. You're out if you repeat a word already used, hesitate too long, or say a sentence that doesn't connect. Last student standing wins.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*There's no easy answer here, but…*	There's no easy answer here, but every outlet has some kind of bias, whether they admit it or not.
Challenging a claim	*That's debatable, given that…*	That's debatable, given that sensationalised headlines get shared regardless of whether the story underneath is accurate.
Closing an argument	*This is why it matters that…*	This is why it matters that censorship and simply refusing to publish false claims are not the same thing.
Conceding a point	*Granted, that's true, but…*	Granted, that's true, but a tabloid can still break a genuinely important story.
Drawing a comparison	*By comparison…*	By comparison, an anonymous source can be just as reliable as a named one, depending on the story.
Giving evidence	*Just look at…*	Just look at how quickly misinformation about a single story can spread before any outlet manages to verify it.
Opening a viewpoint	*As I see it…*	As I see it, a credible outlet should correct its mistakes as loudly as it made them.
Quantifying / citing scale	*This affects a significant number of…*	This affects a significant number of people, since most readers only ever see the headline, not the full article.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Anonymous sources should never be used in serious journalism.
   B) Some of the most important stories in history could only be reported because a source stayed anonymous.

2. **A)** Tabloids do more harm than good by prioritising sensational stories over serious news.
   B) Tabloids bring news to readers who would otherwise ignore it completely.

3. **A)** Governments should be allowed to censor information during a national emergency.
   B) Censorship during a crisis is exactly when the public needs accurate information the most.

4. **A)** Social media has made it easier to spread misinformation than ever before.
   B) Social media has also made it easier than ever to correct misinformation and hold outlets accountable.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Can a news outlet ever be completely free of bias?

2. Should social media platforms be responsible for the misinformation shared on them?

3. Is it ever justified for a government to censor the press?

4. Do headlines shape public opinion more than the articles they introduce?

10 Context Passage

The story broke just after midnight, credited to an anonymous source inside the company. Within an hour, it had been picked up by a dozen outlets, each one racing to publish before the others.

By morning, the coverage barely resembled the original report. One outlet's headline claimed the company was on the verge of collapse; another sensationalised a single internal memo into evidence of fraud. A tabloid ran the story under a headline built entirely around speculation, not fact.

The company's own correspondent contacts went quiet, unwilling to confirm or deny anything until an official statement was ready. In the silence, misinformation spread faster than any correction could catch up with it. Several commentators accused the press of bias; others argued the real problem was speed, not bias — nobody had waited long enough to verify anything credible before publishing.

When the company finally issued a statement, most outlets buried the correction on an inside page. The original, inaccurate headline had already been read by millions. Retractions, it turned out, never travelled nearly as fast as the story they were correcting.

> **TRIVIA** — “Propaganda” comes from the Congregatio de Propaganda Fide, a Vatican committee founded by Pope Gregory XV in 1622 to oversee the spread of the Catholic faith — a neutral religious term long before it took on its modern, manipulative sense.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Odd One Out — circle the word that doesn't belong, and be ready to explain why.

1. bias partiality favouritism neutrality
2. credible plausible believable dubious
3. disseminate distribute spread withhold
4. correspondent reporter journalist editor
5. sensationalise exaggerate dramatise downplay

B. Transformation — rewrite each sentence using the word in capitals in a different form, keeping the same meaning.

1. The government tried to stop the story from being published. (CENSORSHIP)

_____

2. The charity's goal is to spread accurate health information as widely as possible. (DISSEMINATE)

_____

3. Many people were given false information about the vaccine. (MISINFORMED)

_____

4. The network made the crime sound far more shocking than it really was. (SENSATIONALISED)

_____

5. Critics said the report clearly favoured one political party. (BIASED)

_____

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **bias**, **credible**, **disseminate**, **misinformation**, **propaganda**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 11

Arts & Culture

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**aesthetic** *adj.*	Relating to beauty or the appreciation of beauty	The renovation focused as much on aesthetic appeal as on function.
2	**authentic** *adj.*	Genuine; not a copy or imitation	Experts confirmed the painting was authentic, not a forgery.
3	**avant-garde** *adj.*	New and experimental in style, especially in art	Her avant-garde designs shocked the fashion world when they first appeared.
4	**canon** *n.*	The body of works widely accepted as the most important in a particular field	The novel eventually earned a place in the literary canon.
5	**contemporary** *adj.*	Belonging to the present time	The gallery specialises in contemporary art from the last two decades.
6	**critique** *n.*	A detailed analysis and assessment of something	The professor's critique of the exhibition was both fair and thorough.
7	**curator** *n.*	A person who selects and manages items for a museum or exhibition	The curator spent months arranging the pieces in chronological order.
8	**eclectic** *adj.*	Deriving ideas or style from a wide range of sources	The museum's eclectic collection ranges from ancient pottery to modern sculpture.
9	**exhibition** *n.*	A public display of works of art or items of interest	The gallery's new exhibition features work by local artists.
10	**heritage** *n.*	Traditions, buildings, and achievements passed down through generations	The old theatre is protected as part of the city's cultural heritage.
11	**masterpiece** *n.*	A work of outstanding skill or artistry	Critics consider the novel his finest masterpiece.
12	**motif** *n.*	A recurring image, idea, or theme in a work of art	A recurring motif of birds appears throughout the artist's later work.
13	**patron** *n.*	A person who financially supports an artist, writer, or institution	Without a wealthy patron, the young composer could never have afforded to work full-time.
14	**provocative** *adj.*	Intended to cause strong reaction or debate	The sculpture's provocative subject matter divided public opinion.
15	**symbolism** *n.*	The use of symbols to represent ideas or qualities	The heavy use of symbolism made the poem difficult for beginners to interpret.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
authentic	genuine	Genuine is everyday, for anything real; authentic implies it matches its claimed origin
contemporary	modern	Modern is general, for anything up to date; contemporary means belonging to the present
critique	review	Review is everyday, often for entertainment; critique implies a formal, analytical assessment
eclectic	diverse	Diverse is general, for any variety; eclectic implies deliberate mixing of styles or sources
exhibition	display	Display is general, for showing anything; exhibition implies an organised, curated event
heritage	legacy	Legacy is broader, for anything passed down; heritage implies cultural traditions and history
masterpiece	triumph	Triumph is general, for any great success; masterpiece implies an outstanding work of art
provocative	controversial	Controversial describes anything causing disagreement; provocative implies intent to cause it

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
authentic	fake	Direct
avant-garde	conventional	Direct — the standard opposite for this word
contemporary	outdated	Direct — no longer current
eclectic	uniform	Not exact — uniform means a single, consistent style
masterpiece	failure	Not exact — failure means a work that did not succeed
provocative	bland	Not exact — bland means unremarkable, causing no reaction at all

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
authenticate	authenticity	authentic	authentically
critique	critique	critical	critically
curate	curator	curatorial	—
exhibit	exhibition	—	—
symbolise	symbolism	symbolic	symbolically
provoke	provocation	provocative	provocatively

DID YOU KNOW? — “Avant-garde” is literally French for “advance guard” — the troops sent ahead of an army. 19th-century critics borrowed the military term for artists seen as being out ahead of everyone else.

5 Collocations

• an authentic experience	• cultural heritage
• the literary canon	• a recurring motif
• an avant-garde artist	• an eclectic mix
• a museum curator	• a true masterpiece
• a contemporary artist	• a harsh critique
• a public exhibition	• a wealthy patron

FUN FACT — A “masterpiece” originally meant the qualifying piece an apprentice had to produce to be accepted as a master craftsman by a medieval guild — the piece was often kept by the guild itself, not the maker.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
draw on	to use something, especially an experience or tradition, as a source or inspiration	The artist draws on her own childhood memories for much of her work.
hark back (to)	to remind people of or return to an earlier time, style, or idea	The building's design harks back to a much older architectural tradition.
live on	to continue to exist or be remembered after death or change	Her influence lives on in the work of a whole generation of painters.
pass down	to hand something such as a tradition, skill, or object to the next generation	The technique has been passed down from master to apprentice for centuries.
stand out	to be noticeably different from or better than the things around it	One painting in the exhibition really stood out from the rest.

7 60-Second Challenge

HOW TO PLAY

Challenge 1: a student has 60 seconds to argue a position on the unit's topic, using at least 4 unit words correctly. Challenge 2: the same student then has 60 seconds to argue the opposite position, using at least 4 different unit words. No long pauses and no repeating a sentence structure. Stall for more than ten seconds and you're out — pass to the next student.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*This isn't a simple issue, because…*	This isn't a simple issue, because heritage can be genuinely valuable and also used to justify keeping things unchanged for the wrong reasons.
Challenging a claim	*I'm not convinced that…*	I'm not convinced that provocative art is automatically more meaningful than art that isn't.
Closing an argument	*Which is why…*	Which is why an eclectic collection often tells a more honest story than one built around a single, narrow canon.
Conceding a point	*That's fair, but…*	That's fair, but a patron's money always comes with at least some influence over what gets made.
Drawing a comparison	*Compared to…*	Compared to a contemporary piece, a work from the canon often benefits from decades of critique that shaped how we read it.
Giving evidence	*This is evident in…*	This is evident in how many pieces now considered masterpieces were dismissed as avant-garde nonsense when they were first exhibited.
Opening a viewpoint	*I'd argue that…*	I'd argue that a work doesn't need to be authentic to an original tradition to have real artistic value.
Quantifying / citing scale	*The scale of this is significant because…*	The scale of this is significant because most working artists never get access to a curator or gallery at all.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Museums should return culturally significant artefacts to the countries they came from.
   B) Returning every artefact would break up collections that let people compare different cultures side by side.

2. **A)** Art doesn't need to be understood to be valuable.
   B) If nobody can understand a work, it's fair to question whether it's really communicating anything at all.

3. **A)** Government funding should support avant-garde and experimental art, even if the public finds it strange.
   B) Public money should go towards art that the public actually wants to see, not just what critics find interesting.

4. **A)** A copy of a masterpiece can never be as valuable as the authentic original, even if nobody can tell the difference.
   B) If an authentic original and a perfect copy are visually identical, the value of “authenticity” alone is mostly symbolic.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Should art be judged on its aesthetic beauty, its message, or both equally?

2. Is provocative art doing its job if most people don't understand what it's trying to say?

3. Should a country's cultural heritage belong to everyone, or specifically to the people who created it?

4. Can a completely eclectic style ever be as respected as a more traditional, focused one?

10 Context Passage

For years, the gallery displayed the same collection: a small, respected canon of works everyone agreed were masterpieces, arranged in careful chronological order. Visitors admired the collection's authentic pieces, but attendance had been falling for a decade.

The new curator proposed something different: an eclectic exhibition mixing contemporary, avant-garde pieces alongside the traditional canon, chosen specifically to provoke conversation rather than quiet admiration. The board worried the show would alienate the museum's usual patrons.

It didn't. The exhibition's provocative centrepiece, a sculpture built from recycled heritage building materials, became the most talked-about piece the gallery had shown in years. Critics were split. One published critique dismissed the whole show as style without substance; another called it the boldest curatorial choice the institution had made in a generation.

What surprised everyone was the audience. Visitors who had never engaged with the traditional canon spent hours studying the recurring motif of destruction and renewal running through the new pieces. The old masterpieces hadn't lost their aesthetic appeal — but for the first time in years, people were actually arguing about what they meant.

> **TRIVIA** — The Medici family of Renaissance Florence were among history's most famous art patrons, financing the early careers of Michelangelo, Botticelli, and Leonardo da Vinci.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Matching — match each word to its definition.

1. authentic	a. traditions and achievements passed down through generations
2. avant-garde	b. new and experimental in style
3. canon	c. a work of outstanding skill
4. critique	d. genuine; not a copy or imitation
5. eclectic	e. a person who financially supports an artist or institution
6. heritage	f. deriving from a wide range of sources
7. masterpiece	g. the body of works widely accepted as most important in a field
8. patron	h. a detailed analysis and assessment of something

B. Gap-fill — complete with a word from this unit (correct form).

1. Experts confirmed the vase was _____ , not a modern copy.

2. The exhibition's most _____ piece divided critics down the middle.

3. The museum's collection is wonderfully _____ , ranging from ancient pottery to modern sculpture.

4. A recurring _____ of birds appears throughout the artist's later paintings.

5. Without a wealthy _____ , the composer could never have worked full-time.

6. The old theatre is protected as part of the city's cultural _____ .

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **authentic**, **canon**, **critique**, **curator**, **exhibition**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 12

Design

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**asymmetrical** *adj.*	Not identical or balanced on both sides	The building's asymmetrical facade became its most recognisable feature.
2	**blueprint** *n.*	A detailed technical plan or drawing	The architect drew up a blueprint before construction began.
3	**composition** *n.*	The way parts are arranged to form a whole	The photograph's composition drew the eye straight to the subject.
4	**customise** *v.*	To make or change something according to a user's needs	Customers can customise the shoe's colour and material online.
5	**ergonomic** *adj.*	Designed to be comfortable and efficient to use	The company switched to ergonomic chairs after staff complained of back pain.
6	**functional** *adj.*	Designed to be practical and useful rather than attractive	The prototype was ugly but completely functional.
7	**gradient** *n.*	A gradual blending from one colour or tone to another	The app's background uses a soft gradient from blue to purple.
8	**iteration** *n.*	A new version of a design produced through repeated refinement	The final logo was the fifth iteration after months of feedback.
9	**minimalist** *adj.*	Using the smallest range of materials, colours, and detail possible	The website's minimalist layout put all the focus on the product photos.
10	**mockup** *n.*	A static, detailed visual model showing how a finished design will look	The team presented a mockup of the app before writing any code.
11	**palette** *n.*	The range of colours used in a design	The brand's palette sticks to just three shades of green.
12	**refine** *v.*	To improve something by making small changes	The designer spent another week refining the typography.
13	**silhouette** *n.*	The outline or shape of something seen against a background	The dress had a slim, tailored silhouette.
14	**usability** *n.*	The degree to which something is easy to use	Poor usability was the main complaint in early reviews of the app.
15	**wireframe** *n.*	A basic visual guide showing the structure of a design, without colour or styling	The wireframe laid out where every button would go before any visual design began.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
composition	arrangement	Arrangement is general, for placing anything; composition implies a deliberate artistic structure
customise	personalise	Personalise implies making something suited to one person; customise is any adjustment to spec
ergonomic	comfortable	Comfortable is general; ergonomic implies design built specifically around the body's efficient use
functional	practical	Practical is general, for any sensible choice; functional means designed to work well, over looks
iteration	version	Version is neutral, any instance; iteration implies it came from a repeated cycle of improvement
minimalist	simple	Simple is general; minimalist implies a deliberate design philosophy of using as little as possible
refine	polish	Polish is informal, for final small touches; refine implies a more deliberate, ongoing process

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
asymmetrical	symmetrical	Direct
customise	standardise	Direct — to make identical or uniform rather than individually adjusted
ergonomic	uncomfortable	Not exact — uncomfortable is the everyday word for poor physical fit
functional	decorative	Not exact — decorative means chosen for looks rather than use
minimalist	elaborate	Direct — the standard opposite for this style
usability	complexity	Not exact — complexity means difficult to understand or navigate

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
customise	customisation	customised	—
iterate	iteration	iterative	iteratively
refine	refinement	refined	—
—	asymmetry	asymmetrical	asymmetrically
—	functionality	functional	functionally
—	usability	usable	—

DID YOU KNOW? — “Ergonomic” was coined around 1950 from Greek ergon (“work”) and nomos (“law”) — literally, the laws of work.

5 Collocations

• an asymmetrical design	• a distinctive silhouette
• a functional prototype	• a minimalist aesthetic
• a colour gradient	• to draw up a blueprint
• the latest iteration	• a rough mockup
• to customise a product	• ergonomic furniture
• a limited palette	• a strong composition

FUN FACT — “Silhouette” is named after Étienne de Silhouette, an 18th-century French finance minister notorious for his austerity — his name became attached to cheap outline portraits as a jab at his penny-pinching policies.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
flesh out	to add more detail to a basic idea or plan	The team fleshed out the wireframe with real content before testing it.
mock up	to quickly build a rough model or version of a design	She mocked up three versions of the homepage overnight.
pare down	to reduce something to its simplest or most essential form	The final design pared down the original layout to just three colours.
scale up	to make something larger while keeping its proportions the same	The logo needed to scale up cleanly for the billboard version.
sketch out	to draw or describe something in a rough, basic form	He sketched out a few ideas before opening the computer.

7 Word Auction

HOW TO PLAY

Split the class into 2–3 teams, each starting with 20 points. Read a unit word aloud; teams privately bid points to claim it. The highest bidder must use the word correctly in a sentence within 10 seconds. Correct, and they keep the word; wrong, and the points are lost anyway — the word returns to auction. The team with the most correctly-used words wins, not the team with the most points left.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*There are several sides to this…*	There are several sides to this, since a bold asymmetrical composition can either look confident or just look like a mistake.
Challenging a claim	*I'd push back on that, because…*	I'd push back on that, because an ergonomic design that looks ugly still fails half its job.
Closing an argument	*This is exactly why…*	This is exactly why every blueprint should be tested with real users before anything gets built.
Conceding a point	*Fair enough, however…*	Fair enough, however, a customised product almost always costs more to produce at scale.
Drawing a comparison	*Unlike…*	Unlike a rough mockup, a wireframe says nothing about colour or style at all.
Giving evidence	*You can see this in…*	You can see this in how many products go through a dozen iterations before the shape finally feels right.
Opening a viewpoint	*From my point of view…*	From my point of view, usability should always come before minimalist style.
Quantifying / citing scale	*A large proportion of…*	A large proportion of products fail not because of function, but because nobody refined the details.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Good design should always prioritise function over appearance.
   B) A product that looks bad will fail commercially even if it works perfectly.

2. **A)** Minimalist design is simply better design.
   B) Minimalism can strip away detail that people actually needed or wanted.

3. **A)** Every product should be tested with a wireframe and mockup before any code is written.
   B) For very small or simple projects, skipping straight to a working prototype saves real time and money.

4. **A)** Ergonomic design should be a legal requirement for all workplace furniture.
   B) Making ergonomic design mandatory would push up costs for small businesses that can't absorb them.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Should form (how something looks) ever matter more than function (how well it works)?

2. Is minimalist design actually easier to use, or just easier to look at?

3. How many versions should a designer be willing to go through before settling on a final design?

4. Should ergonomics be considered a basic right in the design of everyday products?

10 Context Passage

The first blueprint looked perfect on paper: a sleek, asymmetrical chair with a minimalist silhouette that would stand out on any showroom floor. The prototype told a different story. Testers complained it was uncomfortable within minutes.

The design team went back to basics. They sketched out a rough wireframe of the seat's structure, ignoring colour and style completely, and focused only on how a body would actually sit in it. An ergonomic specialist joined the project, measuring pressure points and adjusting the curve of the backrest by millimetres at a time.

Six iterations later, the chair barely resembled the original mockup. The asymmetrical detail that had looked so striking in early renders was gone, replaced by a more functional, symmetrical frame. The colour palette had shrunk from twelve shades to three. Every change made the chair less remarkable to look at and more comfortable to use.

When it finally launched, reviewers praised its usability above everything else. The designer later admitted the finished chair barely resembled her original vision — but by then, she'd stopped minding.

> **TRIVIA** — Architect Louis Sullivan coined the phrase “form follows function” in 1896 — decades before it became the guiding principle of minimalist and modernist design.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Odd One Out — circle the word that doesn't belong, and be ready to explain why.

1. functional practical useful decorative
2. minimalist simple plain elaborate
3. refine improve polish worsen
4. ergonomic comfortable efficient awkward
5. customise personalise adapt standardise

B. Transformation — rewrite each sentence using the word in capitals in a different form, keeping the same meaning.

1. The company let buyers choose their own colour and features. (CUSTOMISATION)

_____

2. The designer went through the process five times before settling on a final version. (ITERATION)

_____

3. Small changes gradually made the product much better. (REFINEMENT)

_____

4. The two sides of the building's front don't match. (ASYMMETRICAL)

_____

5. The product works well, even if it isn't attractive. (FUNCTIONALITY)

_____

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **composition**, **ergonomic**, **iteration**, **refine**, **usability**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 13

Travel & Tourism

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**embark** *v.*	To begin a journey, especially by ship or plane, or to begin a significant undertaking	The explorers embarked on a six-month expedition across Antarctica.
2	**excursion** *n.*	A short journey or trip, usually taken for pleasure	The tour included a day excursion to a nearby fishing village.
3	**hospitality** *n.*	Friendly and generous treatment of guests or visitors	The family was known throughout the village for their warm hospitality.
4	**immersive** *adj.*	Providing deep involvement or absorption in an experience or environment	The homestay offered a fully immersive introduction to local customs.
5	**indigenous** *adj.*	Originating naturally in a particular place rather than having been brought there from elsewhere	The guide pointed out several plants indigenous to the rainforest.
6	**itinerary** *n.*	A detailed plan or route for a journey	She printed the itinerary before the flight so nothing would be left to chance.
7	**layover** *n.*	A short stay in one place during a longer journey, especially between connecting flights	Their layover in Istanbul lasted almost twelve hours.
8	**nomadic** *adj.*	Moving from place to place rather than settling permanently in one location	The tribe has followed a nomadic lifestyle for centuries, herding livestock across the plains.
9	**picturesque** *adj.*	Visually attractive, especially in a way that resembles a painting	The picturesque harbour appeared on almost every postcard in the shop.
10	**pilgrimage** *n.*	A journey made to a place of religious or personal significance	Thousands complete the pilgrimage to the shrine every spring.
11	**remote** *adj.*	Far away in distance; difficult to reach	The village was so remote that supplies arrived only once a month.
12	**sojourn** *n.*	A temporary stay in a place that is not one's permanent home	His brief sojourn in Lisbon turned into a two-year stay.
13	**trek** *n./v.*	A long, difficult journey, especially one made on foot	The trek to base camp took four days through steep terrain.
14	**uncharted** *adj.*	Not recorded on a map; unfamiliar or unexplored	The sailors pushed further into uncharted waters.
15	**wanderlust** *n.*	A strong desire to travel and explore new places	Her wanderlust only grew stronger after her first trip abroad.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
embark	set off	Set off is neutral for starting any trip; embark specifically implies boarding a ship or plane, or beginning a significant undertaking
excursion	outing	Outing is informal and general for any pleasant trip out; excursion implies a more organised short trip with a planned route
immersive	engrossing	Engrossing is general for anything that holds full attention; immersive specifically implies being surrounded by an experience or environment
picturesque	scenic	Scenic simply describes a pleasant view; picturesque implies a view striking enough to resemble a painting
remote	isolated	Isolated emphasises being cut off from others or support; remote emphasises physical distance from population centres
sojourn	stay	Stay is neutral and general; sojourn is more formal and literary, implying a deliberate, temporary residence away from home
trek	hike	Hike usually describes a walk in nature of any length; trek implies a longer, more physically demanding journey, often over several days

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
embark	disembark	Direct — to leave a ship, plane, or vehicle at the end of a journey
immersive	detached	Not exact — detached describes an experience that keeps the person at a distance rather than absorbed in it
nomadic	sedentary	Direct — settled in one place rather than moving between locations
picturesque	drab	Not exact — drab describes something dull or colourless rather than simply unattractive
remote	accessible	Direct — easy to reach or get to
uncharted	mapped	Direct — recorded and shown on a map

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
embark	embarkation	—	—
immerse	immersion	immersive	immersively
—	nomad	nomadic	nomadically
—	hospitality	hospitable	hospitably
—	—	picturesque	picturesquely

DID YOU KNOW? — “Itinerary” comes from the Latin iter, itiner- (“journey, road”), via Late Latin itinerarium — literally, something “of a journey.”

5 Collocations

• book an excursion	• go off the beaten track (idiom)
• a nomadic lifestyle	• a remote location
• draw up an itinerary	• an immersive experience
• an overnight layover	• a sojourn abroad
• embark on a journey	• indigenous wildlife
• a picturesque village	• uncharted territory

FUN FACT — More than 80% of the world's oceans remain unmapped and largely unexplored — genuinely uncharted territory, even today.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
check in	to register your arrival at an airport, hotel, or similar place	Passengers must check in at least two hours before an international flight.
head off	to leave a place and start travelling somewhere	They headed off towards the coast as soon as the rain stopped.
set off	to begin a journey	We set off at sunrise to reach the summit before noon.
stop over	to break a journey with a short stay in a place	The airline lets you stop over in Reykjavik at no extra cost.
take off	(of a plane) to leave the ground and begin flying	The flight took off two hours late because of the storm.

7 Definition Sprint

HOW TO PLAY

Read a definition aloud without saying the word itself. The first student to correctly call out the matching unit word scores a point. First student to 5 points wins.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Adding weight	*Not only that, but…*	Not only that, but a fully immersive homestay teaches far more about a culture than any guidebook.
Challenging a claim	*That doesn't quite hold up, since…*	That doesn't quite hold up, since even the most remote destinations now see thousands of visitors a year.
Conceding a point	*I'll admit that's true, but…*	I'll admit that's true, but a rigid itinerary still leaves less room for genuine discovery.
Drawing a comparison	*In contrast to…*	In contrast to a quick excursion, a proper trek forces travellers to slow down completely.
Giving evidence	*A clear example of this is…*	A clear example of this is how indigenous communities are increasingly running their own tourism ventures.
Hedging a claim	*It's possible that…*	It's possible that uncharted destinations lose their appeal the moment they become popular.
Opening a viewpoint	*My take on this is…*	My take on this is that wanderlust says more about restlessness than curiosity.
Softening disagreement	*That's a fair concern, but think about…*	That's a fair concern, but think about how a single layover rarely ruins an entire trip.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Tourists should stick to well-planned itineraries rather than travelling without a fixed plan.
   B) A rigid itinerary can prevent travellers from having the spontaneous experiences that make a trip memorable.

2. **A)** Remote, uncharted destinations should be actively promoted to tourists.
   B) Promoting remote destinations too heavily risks damaging the very isolation and indigenous cultures that make them special.

3. **A)** A pilgrimage loses its meaning once it becomes a tourist attraction.
   B) A pilgrimage can still hold personal or spiritual meaning for individual travellers, even if the site also welcomes tourists.

4. **A)** Governments should invest more in supporting nomadic and indigenous communities affected by tourism.
   B) Outside investment can create dependency and disrupt traditional ways of life more than it protects them.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Is it possible to have an authentic travel experience once a destination becomes popular with tourists?

2. Should travellers prioritise hospitality towards locals, or focus mainly on seeing as much as possible?

3. Does true wanderlust require discomfort, or can a comfortable trip still satisfy it?

4. Should uncharted or remote places be protected from tourism altogether?

10 Context Passage

The itinerary looked simple enough on paper: three days trekking to a remote village said to be almost entirely untouched by tourism. The guidebook described it as one of the few uncharted corners left on the well-worn backpacker route.

The reality was slower and stranger. What began as an excursion through dense forest turned into a genuine trek, with the group covering barely ten kilometres a day. By the second evening, exhaustion had replaced any lingering wanderlust, and the promised immersive experience felt more like an endurance test.

Then the village appeared. A family offered an overnight sojourn in their home, their hospitality immediate and unforced despite having nothing prepared in advance. Meals were shared, stories were exchanged through gestures more than words, and questions about indigenous farming methods led to a full afternoon in the fields.

By the time the group finally left, the picturesque scenery mattered far less than the welcome they had received. The itinerary had predicted a destination. It hadn't predicted how completely a single evening's hospitality would outweigh three days of walking to get there.

> **TRIVIA** — Some pilgrimage routes, including the Camino de Santiago in Spain, have been recognised by UNESCO as World Heritage Sites for their cultural importance.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Matching — match each word to its definition.

1. sojourn	a. moving from place to place rather than settling permanently
2. wanderlust	b. a short stay between parts of a longer journey
3. layover	c. a temporary stay in a place away from home
4. pilgrimage	d. a journey made to a place of religious or personal significance
5. nomadic	e. a strong desire to travel and explore new places

B. Gap-fill — complete with a word from this unit (correct form).

1. After months of planning, the explorers finally _____ on their journey across the desert.

2. The hotel staff were famous for their warm _____ towards every guest who arrived.

3. We had a six-hour _____ in Frankfurt before the connecting flight to Tokyo.

4. The scientists ventured into completely _____ territory, far from any marked trail.

5. Her _____ made it impossible for her to stay in one city for more than a few months.

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **embark**, **itinerary**, **immersive**, **indigenous**, **uncharted**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 14

Society & Relationships

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**alienate** *v.*	To make someone feel that they no longer belong to a group, or to cause someone to stop supporting you	Her sudden decision to move abroad alienated some of her closest relatives.
2	**bond** *n./v.*	A close connection or shared feeling that links people together	The two brothers share an unusually strong bond.
3	**camaraderie** *n.*	A feeling of trust and friendship among people who share experiences	Years of working together built real camaraderie among the team.
4	**conform** *v.*	To behave according to the standards or expectations of a group	Some teenagers feel pressure to conform to their classmates' habits.
5	**empathy** *n.*	The ability to understand and share the feelings of another person	Good listeners show empathy rather than jumping straight to advice.
6	**estrange** *v.*	To cause someone to no longer feel close or friendly with a person they were once close to	A long-running disagreement estranged the two cousins for over a decade.
7	**etiquette** *n.*	The accepted rules of polite behaviour in a particular group or situation	Local etiquette expects guests to remove their shoes before entering the house.
8	**kinship** *n.*	A close connection, especially between family members, or a feeling of understanding between people	The volunteers described a sense of kinship after working side by side for a week.
9	**mentor** *n./v.*	A more experienced person who advises and guides someone with less experience	Her mentor at the company taught her almost everything she knows.
10	**milestone** *n.*	An important event that marks a stage in someone's life or in the development of something	Graduating from school was a major milestone for the whole family.
11	**reconcile** *v.*	To restore a friendly relationship between people after a disagreement	It took months, but the sisters eventually reconciled.
12	**solidarity** *n.*	Unity and mutual support within a group, especially in difficult circumstances	The whole neighbourhood showed solidarity after the flood.
13	**taboo** *n./adj.*	A subject, word, or action that is avoided because it is considered socially unacceptable	In many families, discussing salaries openly is still something of a taboo.
14	**tolerance** *n.*	Willingness to accept behaviour, beliefs, or people that are different from your own	The teacher encouraged tolerance of different opinions during class debates.
15	**upbringing** *n.*	The way a child is cared for and taught how to behave while growing up	Her strict upbringing gave her a strong sense of discipline.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
alienate	isolate	Isolate is general for cutting someone off physically or socially; alienate specifically implies causing someone to feel unwelcome or unsupportive towards you
bond	connection	Connection is general for any link between people; bond implies a stronger, more emotional tie
empathy	sympathy	Sympathy is feeling sorry for someone's situation from the outside; empathy implies genuinely sharing or understanding their feelings
estrange	distance	Distance is general and can be physical or emotional; estrange specifically implies a serious breakdown in a once-close relationship
mentor	guide	Guide is general for anyone showing the way; mentor implies an ongoing, trusted relationship built on experience and advice
reconcile	make up	Make up is informal, for patching up any disagreement; reconcile is more formal, implying a genuine restoration of trust
tolerance	acceptance	Acceptance implies fully embracing something; tolerance implies allowing it even without full agreement

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
alienate	unite	Direct — to bring people together rather than pushing them apart
camaraderie	hostility	Direct — open unfriendliness or conflict between people, the opposite of shared trust
conform	rebel	Not exact — rebel implies actively resisting expectations, not just failing to meet them
empathy	indifference	Direct — a lack of concern for other people's feelings
reconcile	estrange	Direct — both words appear in this unit; reconciling repairs a relationship that estrangement broke
tolerance	intolerance	Direct — an unwillingness to accept different views or people

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
alienate	alienation	alienated	—
conform	conformity	conforming	—
empathise	empathy	empathetic	empathetically
reconcile	reconciliation	reconciled	—
tolerate	tolerance	tolerant	tolerantly

DID YOU KNOW? — “Taboo” comes from the Tongan/Polynesian word tapu, meaning “forbidden” or “sacred.” It entered English in 1777 through Captain James Cook's journal of his voyages in the Pacific.

5 Collocations

• build camaraderie	• develop empathy
• reach a milestone	• show solidarity
• a close bond	• estrange a relative
• reconcile with a sibling	• social etiquette
• conform to expectations	• mutual tolerance
• a sense of kinship	• a strict upbringing

FUN FACT — The word “mentor” comes from a character in Homer's Odyssey — Mentor was the trusted guide left in charge of Odysseus's household and son while Odysseus was away.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
fall out	to stop being friends with someone because of an argument	The two friends fell out over a small misunderstanding.
grow apart	to gradually stop being close to someone	Old classmates sometimes grow apart after leaving school.
look up to	to admire and respect someone	Younger students often look up to their older siblings.
make up	to become friendly again after an argument	They argued on Monday but made up by Wednesday.
open up	to start sharing personal feelings or information with someone	It took her a while to open up to her new colleagues.

7 Word Tennis

HOW TO PLAY

Two students face off. One states a sentence using a unit word on the unit's topic; the other must respond within 10 seconds with a new sentence using a different unit word that logically continues it. Repeat a word, pause for more than 10 seconds, or break the topic — you're out, and the next challenger steps in.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*This depends on a number of factors…*	This depends on a number of factors, since a strong bond with parents doesn't always mean the same values are passed down.
Asking for clarification	*I'm not sure I follow — could you clarify…?*	I'm not sure I follow — could you clarify whether 'closeness' means constant contact, or genuine trust?
Challenging a claim	*I have to disagree, because…*	I have to disagree, because plenty of people build real camaraderie with friends they rarely see in person.
Conceding a point	*You have a point there, though…*	You have a point there, though a mentor can only guide someone who is willing to listen.
Giving evidence	*This is backed up by…*	This is backed up by how quickly whole communities show solidarity during difficult times.
Opening a viewpoint	*I tend to think that…*	I tend to think that a strict upbringing teaches discipline more than it damages a child's confidence.
Quantifying / citing scale	*Only a small fraction of…*	Only a small fraction of arguments between close friends actually end in permanent estrangement.
Summarising a position	*Ultimately…*	Ultimately, tolerance of different opinions is what keeps a community's relationships stable.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Children should be raised to conform to family traditions rather than encouraged to challenge them.
   B) An upbringing that allows some questioning helps children develop their own sense of judgement.

2. **A)** Online friendships can build the same camaraderie as in-person relationships.
   B) A bond built mostly online often lacks the shared experience that real camaraderie depends on.

3. **A)** Reconciling with an estranged family member is always worth the effort.
   B) Some relationships cause more harm than good, and reconciliation isn't always the healthiest choice.

4. **A)** Schools should teach social etiquette as a formal subject.
   B) Etiquette is best learned at home and in daily life, not from a classroom syllabus.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Does a strict upbringing build stronger character, or does it damage a child's confidence?

2. Can genuine camaraderie exist between people who rarely meet in person?

3. Is it always worth trying to reconcile with someone you've become estranged from?

4. Should young people be encouraged to conform to family expectations, or to form their own values?

10 Context Passage

For most of her childhood, her upbringing followed a simple rule: family always comes first. Family gatherings were non-negotiable, and disagreements were expected to be settled quickly rather than left to fester.

That changed the year her older brother left for university in another city. Without daily contact, the bond the two had shared as children began to weaken. Neither of them meant for it to happen. Long working hours, unreliable phone signal, and simple distance did the rest. What had once felt unbreakable started to feel, quietly, like distance.

It was a family milestone — a cousin's graduation — that finally forced the two of them into the same room. Neither wanted to alienate the other any further, and neither wanted the whole family to notice the tension between them. In the end, one long conversation was enough to reconcile most of what time had worn down.

They never fully returned to how things had been. But the sense of kinship remained, quietly, underneath everything else — proof that some bonds, even strained ones, are harder to break than distance suggests.

> **TRIVIA** — “Milestone” comes from the Latin mille passus (“a thousand paces”) — the distance Roman roads were marked at with stone pillars.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Odd One Out — circle the word that doesn't belong, and be ready to explain why.

1. bond connection kinship alienate
2. tolerance acceptance empathy hostility
3. reconcile estrange make up resolve
4. mentor guide advisor stranger
5. conform obey comply rebel

B. Transformation — rewrite each sentence using the word in capitals in a different form, keeping the same meaning.

1. Some people always try to behave exactly like everyone else around them. (CONFORMITY)

_____

2. He deeply understood how his friend was feeling after the loss. (EMPATHETIC)

_____

3. The two cousins are close again after years of not speaking. (RECONCILIATION)

_____

4. Her constant criticism made her coworkers feel unwelcome and pushed away. (ALIENATED)

_____

5. The teacher accepted every student's different opinion without judgement. (TOLERANT)

_____

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **bond**, **empathy**, **reconcile**, **tolerance**, **upbringing**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 15

Psychology

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**compulsion** *n.*	A strong, irresistible urge to do something, often against one's conscious wishes	Despite trying to relax, he felt a compulsion to check his phone every few minutes.
2	**conditioning** *n.*	A process of learning in which a response becomes associated with a particular stimulus	Pavlov's dogs are the classic example of conditioning in psychology.
3	**empirical** *adj.*	Based on observation or experiment rather than on theory alone	The study offered strong empirical evidence for the theory.
4	**innate** *adj.*	Present in someone from birth rather than learned	Some researchers argue that a basic sense of fairness is innate.
5	**instinct** *n.*	A natural tendency to behave in a particular way without conscious thought	Her first instinct was to protect her younger brother.
6	**introspection** *n.*	The examination of one's own thoughts and feelings	The therapist encouraged regular introspection as part of the process.
7	**malleable** *adj.*	Easily influenced or shaped, especially by other people or ideas	Young children's personalities are often described as highly malleable.
8	**manifest** *v.*	To show something clearly through signs or actions	Stress can manifest itself in physical symptoms like headaches.
9	**motivation** *n.*	The reason or drive behind a person's behaviour or actions	Understanding a student's motivation helps teachers plan better lessons.
10	**perception** *n.*	The way something is understood or interpreted through the senses or the mind	Perception of the same event can differ sharply from person to person.
11	**reinforcement** *n.*	Something that strengthens a behaviour by rewarding it	Positive reinforcement, like praise, often works better than punishment.
12	**repress** *v.*	To prevent a thought, feeling, or memory from being consciously expressed	He tended to repress difficult emotions rather than talk about them.
13	**stimulus** *n.*	Something that causes a reaction or response	A loud noise is an obvious stimulus for a startle response.
14	**subconscious** *n./adj.*	Relating to the part of the mind that influences behaviour without full awareness	On some subconscious level, she already knew the answer.
15	**temperament** *n.*	A person's natural, innate pattern of emotional and behavioural tendencies	Even as a baby, he had a calm, easy-going temperament.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
innate	inborn	Inborn is a simpler, everyday word; innate is more formal and common in academic or scientific writing
instinct	intuition	Intuition is a felt sense about a specific situation; instinct implies a broader, often biological tendency shared across a species
malleable	adaptable	Adaptable implies a general capacity to adjust; malleable implies being easily shaped or influenced, sometimes by outside pressure
motivation	drive	Drive is more informal and forceful; motivation is the standard, neutral term for what pushes someone towards a goal
perception	impression	Impression is a quick, often first reaction; perception is the broader, ongoing way something is understood
repress	suppress	Suppress usually implies a conscious, deliberate effort; repress often implies an unconscious process
stimulus	trigger	Trigger is more informal, often for something that sets off a strong reaction; stimulus is the standard, neutral term

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
innate	learned	Direct — acquired through experience rather than present from birth
malleable	rigid	Direct — fixed and resistant to being shaped or changed
manifest	conceal	Direct — to keep something hidden rather than showing it
motivation	apathy	Not exact — apathy is a general lack of interest, not simply the absence of one drive
reinforcement	punishment	Not exact — these are opposite behavioural tools, not strict opposites in meaning: one strengthens a behaviour, the other weakens it
repress	express	Direct — to openly show a thought or feeling rather than holding it back

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
condition	conditioning	conditioned	—
motivate	motivation	motivated	—
perceive	perception	perceptive	perceptively
reinforce	reinforcement	reinforced	—
repress	repression	repressed	—

DID YOU KNOW? — “Introspection” comes from the Latin intro- (“within”) and specere (“to look”) — literally, “looking within.” It entered English in the 1670s.

5 Collocations

• a calm temperament	• positive reinforcement
• deep introspection	• repress a memory
• empirical evidence	• resist a compulsion
• gut instinct	• self-motivation
• an innate ability	• a stimulus response
• a malleable mind	• subconscious desire

FUN FACT — “Empirical” comes from the Greek empeirikos, meaning “experienced.” It was first used to describe doctors who based treatment on observation rather than theory alone.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
act out	to express feelings through behaviour rather than words	Young children sometimes act out when they can't express their frustration in words.
bottle up	to keep emotions inside without expressing them	He tends to bottle up his stress instead of talking about it.
bounce back	to recover quickly after a difficult experience	Resilient people tend to bounce back faster after setbacks.
dwell on	to think about something, especially something negative, for too long	Constantly dwelling on past mistakes can affect a person's confidence.
work through	to deal with a problem or difficult emotion by thinking or talking it through	The counsellor helped her work through her anxiety about exams.

7 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*There's no easy answer here, but…*	There's no easy answer here, but temperament and upbringing both seem to shape behaviour together, not separately.
Challenging a claim	*That's debatable, given that…*	That's debatable, given that plenty of people feel a strong compulsion to check their phone even when they aren't anxious at all.
Closing an argument	*This is why it matters that…*	This is why it matters that teachers understand what actually motivates a struggling student.
Drawing a comparison	*By comparison…*	By comparison, an innate talent still needs reinforcement and practice to fully develop.
Giving evidence	*Just look at…*	Just look at how consistently positive reinforcement outperforms punishment in classroom studies.
Hedging a claim	*One might claim that…*	One might claim that most decisions are driven by subconscious instinct rather than careful reasoning.
Opening a viewpoint	*As I see it…*	As I see it, introspection is a skill that can be trained like any other.
Quantifying / citing scale	*This affects a significant number of…*	This affects a significant number of students who repress their anxiety about exams instead of addressing it.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Personality is mostly innate, and upbringing only shapes it at the edges.
   B) Even strongly innate traits can be significantly reshaped by environment, especially early in life.

2. **A)** Positive reinforcement is always more effective than punishment in changing behaviour.
   B) In some situations, especially where safety is involved, clear consequences work faster than rewards.

3. **A)** People should be encouraged to repress unhelpful emotions rather than express them.
   B) Repressing emotions repeatedly can cause them to resurface later in more damaging ways.

4. **A)** Introspection is the most reliable way to understand your own motivations.
   B) People are often unaware of their own subconscious motives, so introspection alone can be misleading.

8 Debate Roulette

HOW TO PLAY

Number the Argument & Counter statements above 1–4. Randomly assign a number to a student — they must argue that position for 30 seconds, even if it isn't their real opinion. Optional: a second student instantly argues the counter.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Is temperament something we're born with, or something shaped almost entirely by upbringing?

2. Can instinct ever be trusted over careful, empirical reasoning?

3. Is it healthier to express difficult emotions or to manage them privately through introspection?

4. Does positive reinforcement work better than punishment in the classroom, in your experience?

10 Context Passage

A first-year psychology class was given a simple assignment: predict how a classmate would react to an unexpected pop quiz. Almost everyone got it wrong.

The mistake, their professor explained, wasn't a lack of intelligence. It was a basic misunderstanding of how much of behaviour is shaped by factors nobody can see directly. Temperament, past conditioning, and subconscious associations all combine long before a person consciously decides how to react. What looks like a simple, instinctive response is often the product of years of quiet reinforcement.

To prove the point, the professor ran a small experiment. Students who received a brief moment of encouragement before the quiz reported less compulsion to double-check their answers and performed better, even though the material was identical for everyone. Motivation, it turned out, wasn't fixed. It could be nudged.

The class left with a different lesson than expected. Predicting behaviour empirically, through careful observation, was far more reliable than guessing based on instinct alone. Introspection had its place, but only alongside real evidence — not instead of it.

> **TRIVIA** — Ivan Pavlov's experiments pairing a bell with food — producing salivation in dogs at the sound alone — became the foundation of classical conditioning theory in psychology.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Matching — match each word to its definition.

1. temperament	a. based on observation or experiment rather than theory alone
2. subconscious	b. a natural tendency to act without conscious thought
3. instinct	c. easily influenced or shaped
4. malleable	d. a person's natural pattern of emotional and behavioural tendencies
5. empirical	e. relating to the part of the mind that influences behaviour without full

B. Gap-fill — complete with a word from this unit (correct form).

1. Loud noises are a common _____ for a startle response in babies.

2. Teachers often use positive _____ , like praise, to encourage good behaviour.

3. He tends to _____ his frustration instead of talking about it.

4. Some researchers believe a basic sense of fairness is _____ rather than learned.

5. Her calm _____ made her a natural fit for working with young children.

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **motivation**, **perception**, **reinforcement**, **subconscious**, **temperament**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 16

Government & Public Life

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**accountability** *n.*	Being responsible for one's actions and able to explain them	Regular public reports increase accountability within any large organisation.
2	**amenity** *n.*	A facility or service that makes a place more pleasant or convenient	The new housing development includes parks and other public amenities.
3	**ballot** *n.*	A system of voting, often in secret, or the paper used to cast a vote	Members cast their ballot to elect a new committee chair.
4	**bureaucracy** *n.*	A system of administration run by officials following fixed rules and procedures	Setting up a small business can involve a surprising amount of bureaucracy.
5	**civic** *adj.*	Relating to a city, town, or its citizens	Voting is often described as a basic civic duty.
6	**constituent** *n.*	A person represented by an elected official, or a part that makes up a whole	The mayor met with constituents to hear their concerns about local traffic.
7	**electorate** *n.*	All the people entitled to vote in a particular election	The electorate will decide the outcome of Sunday's vote.
8	**infrastructure** *n.*	The basic physical systems, such as roads, power, and water supply, needed for a society to function	The city invested heavily in infrastructure before the population doubled.
9	**levy** *n./v.*	A sum of money, such as a tax, officially demanded and collected, or to officially demand it	A small levy on plastic bags helped reduce litter in the city.
10	**mandate** *n.*	Official authority given to someone to carry out a plan or policy	The committee was given a clear mandate to improve local road safety.
11	**municipal** *adj.*	Relating to a town or city's local government	The municipal library is open every day except Monday.
12	**petition** *n./v.*	A formal written request, often signed by many people, or to make such a request	Residents signed a petition asking for a new pedestrian crossing.
13	**referendum** *n.*	A vote in which people are asked to give their opinion on a particular issue	The town held a referendum on whether to build a new bridge.
14	**transparency** *n.*	Openness and honesty in the way an organisation or institution operates	Greater transparency in local spending helped rebuild public trust.
15	**welfare** *n.*	The general health, happiness, and wellbeing of a person or group, or organised support for people in need	The programme focuses on the welfare of elderly residents in the community.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
accountability	responsibility	Responsibility is broad, for any duty or obligation; accountability specifically implies having to explain or answer for the outcome
amenity	facility	Facility is a general word for any building or service provided for a purpose; amenity specifically implies something that adds comfort or convenience
bureaucracy	administration	Administration is neutral, for the general process of managing an organisation; bureaucracy often implies a more complex, rule-heavy system
civic	public	Public is general, for anything open to or provided for everyone; civic specifically relates to citizens and their responsibilities within a community
mandate	authorisation	Authorisation is general, for permission to do something; mandate implies authority granted through an election or formal process
petition	appeal	Appeal is a general request, often emotional; petition specifically implies a formal, often signed, written request
transparency	openness	Openness is a general personal or organisational quality; transparency specifically implies that decisions and processes can be seen and checked by others

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
accountability	impunity	Direct — freedom from consequences or having to answer for one's actions
civic	private	Not exact — private describes what belongs to an individual rather than the community
mandate	prohibition	Not exact — prohibition is a rule against doing something, not simply the absence of authority to act
municipal	national	Not exact — national describes the country-wide level, contrasted with the local, municipal level
transparency	secrecy	Direct — the deliberate concealment of information or decisions
welfare	neglect	Not exact — neglect is the failure to care for someone, not a precise opposite of general wellbeing

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
—	accountability	accountable	—
—	bureaucracy	bureaucratic	bureaucratically
—	municipality	municipal	—
—	mandate	mandatory	mandatorily
—	transparency	transparent	transparently

FUN FACT — “Referendum” comes from the Latin referre (“to bring back”) — literally, a question “brought back” to the people themselves for a decision.

5 Collocations

• basic amenities	• constituent concerns
• impose a levy	• public accountability
• cast a ballot	• crumbling infrastructure
• local constituents	• sign a petition
• civic duty	• government transparency
• municipal government	• social welfare

DID YOU KNOW? — “Bureaucracy” combines French bureau (“desk, office”) with the Greek suffix -kratia (“rule, power”) — literally, “rule of the office.” It was coined in 18th-century France.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
carry out	to perform or complete a plan, duty, or task	The council carried out repairs to the town hall roof.
draw up	to prepare a plan, document, or list	Officials drew up a new proposal for the park redesign.
hand over	to give control or responsibility to someone else	The outgoing committee handed over its records to the new members.
set up	to establish or create something, such as an organisation or system	The town set up a committee to review local transport.
vote in	to elect someone to a position through voting	Residents voted in a new head of the neighbourhood council.

7 Synonym Swap

HOW TO PLAY

Read a sentence containing a basic, everyday word. Students race to replace it with the best-fitting synonym from this unit's Synonym Sets table. Whoever answers first must also justify why it fits the register or context better than the basic word.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*This isn't a simple issue, because…*	This isn't a simple issue, because better infrastructure often means a higher levy for local residents.
Challenging a claim	*I'm not convinced that…*	I'm not convinced that transparency alone is enough to build public trust in an institution.
Conceding a point	*That's fair, but…*	That's fair, but bureaucracy exists partly to make sure public money is spent responsibly.
Giving evidence	*This is evident in…*	This is evident in how quickly a well-organised petition can bring a local issue to public attention.
Opening a viewpoint	*I'd argue that…*	I'd argue that civic participation, like voting, should be actively encouraged among young people.
Quantifying / citing scale	*The scale of this is significant because…*	The scale of this is significant because a single municipal decision can affect an entire community's daily amenities.
Softening disagreement	*I see your point, but consider…*	I see your point, but consider how constituents rely on accountability to know their concerns are heard.
Summarising a position	*Overall, the point stands that…*	Overall, the point stands that strong local infrastructure improves quality of life for the whole electorate.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Voting should be a mandatory civic duty for every eligible citizen.
   B) Making voting mandatory could lead to uninformed or careless choices at the ballot box.

2. **A)** Local municipal governments should have more control over public spending than national ones.
   B) National oversight helps ensure that infrastructure spending is fair and consistent across every region.

3. **A)** A petition with enough signatures should force local authorities to act on an issue.
   B) Not every popular petition reflects what's actually best for a community in the long run.

4. **A)** Transparency should always come before efficiency in how public institutions operate.
   B) Excessive transparency can slow down decision-making when quick action is genuinely needed.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Should voting be treated as a mandatory civic duty, or a purely personal choice?

2. How much transparency should the public expect from local institutions?

3. Is a petition an effective way for ordinary people to influence local decisions?

4. Should local municipal governments or national governments control public infrastructure spending?

10 Context Passage

When the bridge connecting two neighbourhoods finally cracked under years of heavy traffic, nobody was surprised. Residents had been raising concerns about the town's ageing infrastructure for years, mostly at meetings nobody outside the area ever heard about.

A local teacher started a petition instead. Within two weeks, it had more signatures than anyone expected, and the story reached the municipal council's next public session. Officials explained, patiently, that repairs required a new levy, and that any levy needed approval from a wider vote among constituents before it could go ahead.

Some residents grumbled about the delay. Others pointed out that this was exactly how accountability was supposed to work: no single official could simply decide to spend public money without the community weighing in. A referendum was scheduled for the following spring.

In the end, the electorate approved the new levy by a comfortable margin. The bridge was rebuilt within a year, and the amenity everyone had once taken for granted became, briefly, a small case study in how patient, transparent process could actually get something built.

> **TRIVIA** — “Amenity” comes from the Latin amoenus, meaning “pleasant” or “agreeable” — the same root that gives English the name Amy.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Odd One Out — circle the word that doesn't belong, and be ready to explain why.

1. accountability responsibility impunity answerability

2. civic public communal private

3. transparency openness honesty secrecy

4. petition appeal request refusal

5. mandate authorisation permission ban

B. Transformation — rewrite each sentence using the word in capitals in a different form, keeping the same meaning.

1. Officials must be able to explain and answer for their decisions. (ACCOUNTABILITY)

_____

2. The council's approval process involves an overwhelming number of official rules and procedures. (BUREAUCRATIC)

_____

3. Repairs to the town hall are handled by the local town government. (MUNICIPALITY)

_____

4. New workplace safety checks are now required by law. (MANDATORY)

_____

5. The committee now shares its spending records openly with the public. (TRANSPARENCY)

_____

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **accountability**, **civic**, **infrastructure**, **transparency**, **welfare**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 17

International Relations

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**accord** *n.*	A formal agreement between two or more countries or parties	The two governments signed an accord to cooperate on flood prevention.
2	**alliance** *n.*	A formal association between countries or groups formed for mutual benefit	The countries formed an alliance to coordinate their response to natural disasters.
3	**bilateral** *adj.*	Involving two countries or parties	The two neighbours signed a bilateral trade agreement.
4	**ceasefire** *n.*	An agreement to stop fighting, especially temporarily	Both sides agreed to a ceasefire after months of conflict.
5	**delegation** *n.*	A group of representatives sent to act or speak on behalf of a larger group	A delegation from the ministry travelled to the summit.
6	**diplomacy** *n.*	The management of relations between countries through negotiation rather than force	The crisis was eventually resolved through careful diplomacy.
7	**embassy** *n.*	The official group of representatives of one country in another, or the building where they work	She applied for a visa at the embassy.
8	**envoy** *n.*	A messenger or representative sent on an official or diplomatic mission	The envoy carried a message between the two governments.
9	**geopolitical** *adj.*	Relating to politics, especially international relations, as influenced by geography	Access to the river has long been a geopolitical concern for the region.
10	**humanitarian** *adj.*	Concerned with reducing suffering and improving people's welfare	The organisation coordinates humanitarian aid after natural disasters.
11	**multilateral** *adj.*	Involving more than two countries or parties	The agreement was signed at a multilateral summit involving a dozen nations.
12	**neutrality** *n.*	The state of not supporting either side in a conflict or disagreement	The country has maintained strict neutrality throughout the dispute.
13	**sanction** *n./v.*	An official penalty or restriction imposed to enforce compliance, or to formally approve something	The organisation imposed trade sanctions until the terms were met.
14	**sovereignty** *n.*	A country's power to govern itself without outside interference	Respecting each country's sovereignty is a basic principle of international law.
15	**summit** *n.*	A formal meeting between leaders of different countries or organisations	Leaders gathered for a summit to discuss regional cooperation.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
accord	agreement	Agreement is the general everyday word for any shared decision; accord is more formal, typically used for a written arrangement between countries
alliance	partnership	Partnership is general, for any cooperative relationship; alliance specifically implies a formal, often long-term, mutual-support arrangement
diplomacy	negotiation	Negotiation is the general process of discussing terms; diplomacy specifically implies the broader, ongoing management of relations between countries
envoy	representative	Representative is general for anyone acting on behalf of others; envoy specifically implies an official sent on a diplomatic mission
humanitarian	charitable	Charitable is general, for any generous or helping act; humanitarian specifically implies large-scale efforts to relieve suffering, often in crisis
neutrality	impartiality	Impartiality is general, for fairness in judgement; neutrality specifically implies not taking a side in a conflict or dispute at all
sovereignty	independence	Independence is general, for freedom from control; sovereignty specifically implies the formal, recognised authority to govern

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
alliance	rivalry	Direct — open competition or conflict between countries or groups, rather than cooperation
bilateral	multilateral	Direct — both words appear in this unit; bilateral involves two parties, multilateral involves several
diplomacy	hostility	Not exact — hostility is open unfriendliness, not simply the absence of negotiation
humanitarian	indifferent	Not exact — indifferent describes a lack of concern, not an opposing intent
neutrality	partisanship	Direct — openly favouring one side rather than remaining uninvolved
sovereignty	dependence	Not exact — dependence describes reliance on another power, not a precise legal opposite

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
—	diplomacy	diplomatic	diplomatically
—	geopolitics	geopolitical	geopolitically
—	humanitarianism	humanitarian	—
—	neutrality	neutral	neutrally
—	sovereignty	sovereign	—

DID YOU KNOW? — “Diplomacy” comes from the Greek diploma, meaning “folded double” — official travel documents in the ancient world were folded and stamped in two, and the word later came to mean any official state document, then international negotiation itself.

5 Collocations

• broker a ceasefire	• geopolitical tension
• multilateral cooperation	• send a delegation
• diplomatic envoy	• humanitarian aid
• national sovereignty	• sign a bilateral agreement
• forge an alliance	• impose sanctions
• reach an accord	• strict neutrality

FUN FACT — “Summit,” in the sense of a meeting between heads of state, was popularised by Winston Churchill in 1950 (“a parley at the summit”); the word itself traces back to Latin summum, “highest.”

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
back down	to withdraw from a position or demand, often after conflict	Neither country was willing to back down during the dispute.
break off	to end a relationship, negotiation, or agreement suddenly	Talks broke off after the two sides failed to agree on terms.
reach out	to make contact with someone, often to begin dialogue	The smaller nation reached out to its neighbours for support.
sign off on	to formally approve something	Both leaders signed off on the final agreement.
stand by	to support and remain loyal to someone or something, especially in difficulty	The alliance agreed to stand by its members in a crisis.

7 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Adding weight	*On top of that…*	On top of that, a strong alliance gives smaller countries more say in multilateral decisions.
Asking for clarification	*Could you explain what you mean by…?*	Could you explain what you mean by ‘national interest’ in this context?
Challenging a claim	*I'd push back on that, because…*	I'd push back on that, because sanctions often hurt ordinary people more than the officials they target.
Conceding a point	*Fair enough, however…*	Fair enough, however diplomacy usually takes longer to produce results than direct action.
Drawing a comparison	*Unlike…*	Unlike a bilateral agreement, a multilateral accord has to balance the interests of many countries at once.
Giving evidence	*You can see this in…*	You can see this in how quickly a ceasefire can collapse without a neutral party monitoring it.
Making a conditional concession	*That's true only if…*	That's true only if the humanitarian aid actually reaches the people who need it.
Opening a viewpoint	*From my point of view…*	From my point of view, sovereignty should never be treated as more important than basic human welfare.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Diplomacy should always be tried before any other response to international conflict.
   B) Sometimes waiting for diplomacy to work costs more than a faster, firmer response would.

2. **A)** Smaller countries benefit more from multilateral alliances than from bilateral deals.
   B) Bilateral deals can be negotiated faster and tailored more closely to a country's specific needs.

3. **A)** Sanctions are an effective way to change another country's behaviour without resorting to war.
   B) Sanctions often cause the most harm to ordinary citizens rather than the leaders they're meant to pressure.

4. **A)** A country's neutrality should be respected even during a major international crisis.
   B) True neutrality is difficult to maintain when a crisis directly threatens global stability.

8 Flip the Statement

HOW TO PLAY

Pick any Argument (A) from the Argument & Counter section above. The student must argue the Counter (B) position convincingly, on the spot, without reading the printed counter. This

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Should smaller nations prioritise multilateral alliances over bilateral agreements?

2. Are economic sanctions an effective tool, or do they mostly harm ordinary people?

3. Can a country remain truly neutral during a major international crisis?

4. Should national sovereignty ever be limited for humanitarian reasons?

10 Context Passage

For six months, two neighbouring states had exchanged accusations over a disputed stretch of border territory. Neither side had fired a shot, but neither had backed down either.

The breakthrough came not from either government directly, but from a small delegation of envoys representing a group of neutral countries. Their mandate was narrow: get both sides talking, even informally, without either country losing face in front of its own public.

The first meeting produced nothing but a fragile ceasefire and a promise to meet again. The second produced an accord neither side fully liked, but both could live with. It set up a demilitarised buffer zone, agreed shared access to a river running through the disputed land, and created a bilateral commission to review the border again in five years.

Critics on both sides called it a weak compromise. Diplomats called it exactly what diplomacy is supposed to produce: not a perfect outcome, just one that kept a small disagreement from becoming a much larger one.

> **TRIVIA** — The modern principle of state sovereignty is often traced to the Peace of Westphalia in 1648, which established that rulers should not interfere in the internal affairs of other states.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Matching — match each word to its definition.

1. envoy	a. a country's power to govern itself without outside interference
2. sovereignty	b. a messenger or representative sent on an official diplomatic mission
3. ceasefire	c. not supporting either side in a conflict or disagreement
4. sanction	d. an agreement to stop fighting, especially temporarily
5. neutrality	e. an official penalty or restriction imposed to enforce compliance

B. Gap-fill — complete with a word from this unit (correct form).

1. The two governments finally reached an _____ after weeks of talks.

2. The new trade agreement between the two neighbours was strictly _____ .

3. Leaders from a dozen countries gathered for the annual _____ .

4. The organisation sent _____ aid to the region after the flood.

5. A small group of _____ represented the country at the talks.

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **accord**, **diplomacy**, **humanitarian**, **neutrality**, **sovereignty**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 18

Business & Commerce

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**commodity** *n.*	A raw material or primary agricultural product that can be bought and sold	Coffee is one of the world's most widely traded commodities.
2	**consumer** *n.*	A person who buys goods or services for personal use	Consumers are becoming more selective about where they shop.
3	**currency** *n.*	The system of money used in a particular country	The exchange rate between the two currencies changes daily.
4	**deficit** *n.*	The amount by which spending exceeds income	The company reported a budget deficit for the third year running.
5	**demand** *n.*	The desire and ability of buyers to purchase a particular good or service	Demand for the product increased sharply after the advertising campaign.
6	**fiscal** *adj.*	Relating to government revenue, spending, and taxation	The government introduced new fiscal measures to reduce the deficit.
7	**inflation** *n.*	A general and sustained rise in prices over time	High inflation reduced the value of people's savings.
8	**investment** *n.*	Money committed to something, especially a business or project, in order to gain a future return	The firm made a major investment in new technology.
9	**monetary** *adj.*	Relating to money or a country's money supply	The central bank adjusted its monetary policy to control inflation.
10	**productivity** *n.*	The rate at which goods or services are produced in relation to the resources used	New equipment helped boost the factory's productivity.
11	**recession** *n.*	A period of temporary economic decline, usually marked by falling output and rising unemployment	The country entered a recession after several quarters of falling output.
12	**supply** *n.*	The amount of a good or service available for purchase	A shortage in supply pushed prices higher.
13	**surplus** *n.*	An amount left over after needs have been met; the opposite of a deficit	The country ran a trade surplus for the first time in a decade.
14	**tariff** *n.*	A tax imposed on goods imported into or exported out of a country	The new tariff made imported cars significantly more expensive.
15	**wage** *n.*	Payment received for work, usually calculated hourly, daily, or weekly	Workers demanded a higher minimum wage.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
consumer	buyer	Buyer is general for anyone making a purchase; consumer specifically implies someone using goods or services for personal, ongoing use
deficit	shortfall	Shortfall is general for any amount short of what's needed; deficit specifically implies the gap between spending and income in a budget
demand	need	Need is general, implying necessity; demand specifically implies willingness and ability to pay for something at a given price
inflation	price rise	Price rise is a general everyday phrase for costs going up; inflation is the precise economic term for a sustained, economy-wide increase
investment	expenditure	Expenditure is general for any money spent; investment specifically implies spending intended to generate a future return
recession	downturn	Downturn is a general, softer term for any decline; recession specifically implies a measurable, sustained period of economic decline
wage	pay	Pay is general and informal for any payment for work; wage specifically implies payment calculated by hours or days worked

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
deficit	surplus	Direct — both words appear in this unit; a deficit is a shortfall, a surplus is an excess
demand	supply	Not exact — these are paired economic forces rather than strict opposites, but function as opposites in basic market analysis
inflation	deflation	Direct — a general and sustained fall in prices, rather than a rise
investment	divestment	Direct — the act of selling off or reducing an investment, rather than committing to one
monetary	fiscal	Not exact — complementary policy tools rather than true opposites: monetary relates to money supply, fiscal to government spending and tax
recession	boom	Direct — a period of rapid economic growth, the opposite of economic decline

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
—	inflation	inflationary	—
invest	investment	—	—
—	productivity	productive	productively
—	recession	recessionary	—
consume	consumption	consumer	—

DID YOU KNOW? — “Tariff” comes from the Arabic ta’rif, meaning “notification” or “proclamation” — originally a published list of prices or duties.

5 Collocations

• boost productivity	• fiscal policy
• monetary policy	• rising inflation
• consumer spending	• foreign currency
• raise the minimum wage	• run a surplus
• economic recession	• impose a tariff
• reduce the deficit	• supply and demand

FUN FACT — “Recession” comes from the Latin recessus, “a going back, retreat” — the same root sense used for floodwaters “recessing” after a flood.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
cut back (on)	to reduce spending or use of something	Many households cut back on non-essential spending during the recession.
pay off	to be worth the effort or investment made, or to repay a debt fully	The investment in new equipment paid off within two years.
scale up	to increase the size or amount of something, especially production	The company scaled up production to meet rising demand.
set aside	to save or reserve money for a particular purpose	The firm set aside part of its budget for research.
write off	to accept that a debt or investment will not be repaid or recovered	The bank had to write off several bad loans.

7 Speed Interview

HOW TO PLAY

One student is the interviewee. Classmates take turns asking questions that must include a unit word. The interviewee must also answer using a unit word each time. Run for 2 minutes, then switch interviewee.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*It's more complicated than it seems, since…*	It's more complicated than it seems, since a tariff can protect local jobs but also raise prices for consumers.
Challenging a claim	*That doesn't quite hold up, since…*	That doesn't quite hold up, since higher wages don't always lead to lower productivity.
Conceding a point	*I'll admit that's true, but…*	I'll admit that's true, but a short recession can sometimes correct unsustainable growth.
Giving evidence	*A clear example of this is…*	A clear example of this is how quickly consumer demand recovers once inflation slows down.
Hedging a claim	*It's possible that…*	It's possible that a small budget deficit is actually healthy for long-term investment.
Opening a viewpoint	*My take on this is…*	My take on this is that fiscal policy usually works faster than monetary policy in a crisis.
Quantifying / citing scale	*The vast majority of…*	The vast majority of small businesses rely on stable currency values to plan their spending.
Summarising a position	*Taken together, this suggests…*	Taken together, this suggests that a strong economy depends on balancing supply and demand carefully.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Governments should always run a balanced budget rather than a deficit.
   B) A temporary deficit can help a government invest in growth during a recession.

2. **A)** Raising the minimum wage always benefits workers.
   B) A higher minimum wage can reduce productivity gains if businesses cut jobs to cover costs.

3. **A)** Tariffs are an effective way to protect local industries from foreign competition.
   B) Tariffs often raise prices for consumers and can trigger similar tariffs in return.

4. **A)** Central banks should prioritise controlling inflation over boosting employment.
   B) Focusing only on inflation can leave a country with high unemployment for too long.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Should governments prioritise controlling inflation or boosting employment?

2. Do tariffs protect local businesses, or do they mostly harm consumers?

3. Is a growing budget deficit always a bad sign for an economy?

4. Does raising the minimum wage help workers more than it hurts businesses?

10 Context Passage

When the small furniture company lost almost half its export orders overnight, the reason wasn't a lack of demand. It was currency.

A sudden shift in the exchange rate meant the company's prices, unchanged in its own currency, had become nearly twenty percent more expensive for buyers abroad. Orders that had taken months to secure disappeared within weeks.

The owner had two options: absorb the loss and protect market share, or raise prices and protect profit margins. She chose a middle path. Production costs were trimmed wherever possible, a modest tariff refund on imported materials was claimed, and remaining profits were reinvested directly into new machinery rather than paid out.

The productivity gains took over a year to show up in the numbers. When they did, the company could produce more at a lower cost per unit, enough to absorb future currency swings without repeating the same crisis. It hadn't solved the problem of a volatile currency. It had simply stopped depending on the currency staying still.

> **TRIVIA** — The Song dynasty in China issued the world's first government-backed paper currency around the 11th century, centuries before paper money appeared in Europe.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Odd One Out — circle the word that doesn't belong, and be ready to explain why.

1. deficit shortfall surplus shortage
2. inflation price rise deflation price increase
3. recession downturn decline boom
4. wage pay salary debt
5. demand need desire supply

B. Transformation — rewrite each sentence using the word in capitals in a different form, keeping the same meaning.

1. Prices across the whole economy kept rising steadily for over a year. (INFLATE)

_____

2. The factory produced far more per worker after the new machines arrived. (PRODUCTIVE)

_____

3. The company put a large amount of money into new technology. (INVEST)

_____

4. The economy went through a period typical of an economic downturn. (RECESSION)

_____

5. People in the city buy far more imported goods than people in rural areas. (CONSUME)

_____

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **currency**, **demand**, **inflation**, **investment**, **supply**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 19

Economics

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**aggregate** *adj./n.*	A total amount made up of smaller amounts combined together	Aggregate demand across the economy fell during the downturn.
2	**allocation** *n.*	The distribution of resources for a particular purpose	The budget allocation for research increased this year.
3	**austerity** *n.*	Reduced government spending, often introduced during economic difficulty	The government introduced austerity measures to reduce the deficit.
4	**depreciation** *n.*	A reduction in the value of an asset or currency over time	The company accounted for the depreciation of its equipment each year.
5	**elasticity** *n.*	The degree to which demand or supply changes in response to a change in price	The price elasticity of luxury goods is generally high.
6	**equilibrium** *n.*	The point at which supply and demand are balanced	The market eventually settled at a new equilibrium price.
7	**externality** *n.*	A cost or benefit of an economic activity that affects a third party not directly involved	Air pollution from the factory is a clear negative externality.
8	**leverage** *n.*	The use of borrowed money to increase the potential return of an investment	High leverage increased both the firm's potential profits and its risk.
9	**marginal** *adj.*	Relating to a small or additional change, especially the next unit produced or consumed	The marginal cost of producing one more unit was surprisingly low.
10	**oligopoly** *n.*	A market dominated by a small number of large sellers	The airline industry in many countries functions as an oligopoly.
11	**protectionism** *n.*	The practice of shielding domestic industries from foreign competition	Rising protectionism led to higher tariffs on imported steel.
12	**subsidy** *n.*	Financial assistance given, typically by a government, to support an industry or activity	Farmers received a subsidy to help cover rising costs.
13	**trade-off** *n.*	A balance between two desirable but conflicting outcomes	Every economic decision involves some kind of trade-off.
14	**utility** *n.*	The satisfaction or benefit a person gains from consuming a good or service	Economists measure utility to understand consumer choices.
15	**volatility** *n.*	The tendency of prices or markets to change quickly and unpredictably	High volatility made investors cautious about the stock.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
aggregate	total	Total is the general everyday word for any combined amount; aggregate is more formal, typically used in economic or statistical contexts
allocation	distribution	Distribution is general, for spreading anything among recipients; allocation specifically implies a deliberate assignment of a limited resource for a purpose
austerity	cutbacks	Cutbacks is informal and general for reduced spending of any kind; austerity specifically implies a sustained, often government-wide policy of reduced spending
depreciation	decline	Decline is general for any drop in value or condition; depreciation specifically implies a measurable, often gradual loss in the value of an asset
marginal	minor	Minor is general for anything small or unimportant; marginal specifically implies relating to one additional unit in an economic calculation
subsidy	grant	Grant is general for money given for any purpose; subsidy specifically implies financial support intended to lower the cost of an activity or product
volatility	instability	Instability is general, for any lack of steadiness; volatility specifically implies rapid, unpredictable price or value changes in a market

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
austerity	extravagance	Not exact — extravagance implies excessive, wasteful spending, not simply the absence of austerity
depreciation	appreciation	Direct — a rise in the value of an asset or currency over time
equilibrium	imbalance	Direct — a state in which supply and demand, or other forces, are not evenly matched
marginal	substantial	Not exact — substantial describes something large, not a precise opposite of one additional unit
protectionism	free trade	Direct — the removal of barriers to trade between countries, rather than shielding domestic industry
volatility	stability	Direct — a state of steady, predictable behaviour, the opposite of rapid unpredictable change

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
aggregate	aggregate	aggregate	—
allocate	allocation	—	—
depreciate	depreciation	—	—
—	protectionism	protectionist	—
—	volatility	volatile	—

FUN FACT — “Oligopoly” comes from the Greek oligos (“few”) and polein (“to sell”) — coined in the late 19th century, by analogy with “monopoly.”

5 Collocations

• aggregate demand	• economic equilibrium
• marginal cost	• price elasticity
• budget allocation	• government subsidy
• market volatility	• severe austerity
• currency depreciation	• inevitable trade-off
• negative externality	• trade protectionism

DID YOU KNOW? — “Aggregate” comes from the Latin aggregare (“to herd together”), from ad- (“towards”) and grex (“a flock”).

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
bail out	to rescue a business or economy from financial difficulty, usually with money	The government had to bail out the failing bank.
crack down (on)	to take strict action to stop something, such as unfair trade practices	Regulators cracked down on unfair pricing in the industry.
level off	to stop rising or falling and stay at a steady level	Prices finally levelled off after months of volatility.
prop up	to help something weak continue, often artificially	Subsidies were used to prop up the struggling industry.
squeeze out	to gradually force something or someone out of a market or position	Larger firms squeezed smaller competitors out of the market.

7 Vocabulary Chain

HOW TO PLAY

In a circle or line, the first student says one sentence using a unit word. The next student must use a different unit word in a new sentence that connects logically to the one before it. You're out if you repeat a word, hesitate more than 10 seconds, or break the connection. Last student standing wins.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*This depends on a number of factors…*	This depends on a number of factors, since the effect of a subsidy varies enormously between industries.
Challenging a claim	*I have to disagree, because…*	I have to disagree, because high market volatility doesn't always signal a genuine economic problem.
Drawing a comparison	*Similarly…*	Similarly, austerity and protectionism both aim to protect an economy, but through opposite methods.
Giving evidence	*This is backed up by…*	This is backed up by how quickly prices adjust once a market reaches equilibrium.
Hedging a claim	*Arguably…*	Arguably, elasticity matters more than price alone when predicting consumer behaviour.
Making a conditional concession	*Under certain conditions, that's fair, but…*	Under certain conditions, that's fair, but only if the externality is actually measured accurately.
Opening a viewpoint	*I tend to think that…*	I tend to think that short-term trade-offs are worth it for long-term productivity gains.
Quantifying / citing scale	*Only a small fraction of…*	Only a small fraction of firms in an oligopoly actually compete on price.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Governments should subsidise struggling industries to protect jobs.
   B) Subsidies can prop up inefficient businesses that would otherwise adapt or fail.

2. **A)** A market left to reach its own equilibrium is always more efficient than one shaped by policy.
   B) Markets can settle at an equilibrium that still leaves real externalities unaddressed.

3. **A)** Protectionism is necessary to shield young industries from established foreign competitors.
   B) Protected industries often become less competitive over time, not more.

4. **A)** Companies should take on high leverage to grow as quickly as possible.
   B) High leverage leaves a business dangerously exposed during periods of volatility.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Should governments intervene in a market, or let supply and demand reach their own equilibrium?

2. Do subsidies help an economy grow, or do they mostly delay necessary change?

3. Is a highly leveraged business taking a smart risk or an unnecessary one?

4. Can protectionism ever benefit an economy in the long run?

10 Context Passage

A small manufacturer of ceramic tiles had always operated on thin margins. For years, a government subsidy on raw materials had kept costs manageable, and the firm had never seriously questioned its reliance on it.

Then the subsidy was cut. Almost overnight, the firm's marginal cost per tile rose enough to erase most of its profit. The owner faced a straightforward trade-off: raise prices and risk losing customers to competitors, or absorb the cost and risk the business itself.

An economist friend suggested a third option: study the market's price elasticity first. If demand for the tiles was relatively inelastic, a modest price increase would barely affect sales. If it was highly elastic, any increase could be disastrous.

The data, once gathered, was clear. Customers cared more about design and durability than price. A careful, incremental increase preserved both revenue and customer loyalty. The firm survived not because the subsidy came back, but because it finally understood something about its own market it should have known years earlier.

> **TRIVIA** — “Equilibrium” was borrowed directly from physics; 19th-century economist Léon Walras modeled markets on mechanical equilibrium, and the term has stuck in economics ever since.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Matching — match each word to its definition.

1. equilibrium	a. a market dominated by a small number of large sellers
2. externality	b. the point at which supply and demand are balanced
3. leverage	c. a balance between two desirable but conflicting outcomes
4. oligopoly	d. the use of borrowed money to increase potential investment return
5. trade-off	e. a cost or benefit of an activity that affects an uninvolved third party

B. Gap-fill — complete with a word from this unit (correct form).

1. The company took on significant debt, using _____ to expand quickly.

2. Pollution from the factory is a clear negative _____ affecting nearby residents.

3. After weeks of price changes, the market finally reached a new _____ .

4. A handful of large firms controlled the entire market, forming an _____ .

5. Choosing higher wages over more jobs is a classic economic _____ .

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **allocation**, **equilibrium**, **marginal**, **subsidy**, **utility**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 20

Science & Discovery

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**anomaly** *n.*	Something that deviates from what is normal or expected	The scientists noticed an anomaly in the data that didn't fit their model.
2	**catalyst** *n.*	Something that causes or speeds up change, or a substance that speeds up a chemical reaction without being changed itself	The discovery acted as a catalyst for further research in the field.
3	**causation** *n.*	The action of causing something; the relationship between cause and effect	Correlation does not always prove causation.
4	**correlation** *n.*	A relationship between two variables in which they tend to change together	Researchers found a strong correlation between the two measurements.
5	**discern** *v.*	To perceive or recognise something, especially something not immediately obvious	It was difficult to discern any clear pattern in the early results.
6	**hypothesis** *n.*	A proposed explanation for something, made as a starting point for further investigation	The team designed an experiment to test their hypothesis.
7	**inconclusive** *adj.*	Not leading to a definite result or decision	The initial tests were inconclusive, so further trials were planned.
8	**methodology** *n.*	A system of methods used in a particular field of study	The report described the study's methodology in detail.
9	**paradigm** *n.*	A typical example or pattern of something; a model or framework of thought	The discovery eventually led to a new scientific paradigm.
10	**phenomenon** *n.*	A fact, occurrence, or situation that is observed to exist	The eclipse was a rare astronomical phenomenon.
11	**plausible** *adj.*	Seeming reasonable or probable	The team proposed a plausible explanation for the unexpected results.
12	**replicate** *v.*	To repeat an experiment or study to check its results	Other laboratories were unable to replicate the original findings.
13	**sceptical** *adj.*	Having doubts about a claim, especially one that isn't fully proven	Many scientists remained sceptical until further evidence appeared.
14	**speculate** *v.*	To form a theory or guess about something without firm evidence	Researchers speculated that the change was linked to temperature.
15	**variable** *n.*	A factor or quantity that can change in an experiment	The researchers controlled every variable except one.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
anomaly	irregularity	Irregularity is general for anything not following a normal pattern; anomaly specifically implies something unexpected within an established system or theory
catalyst	trigger	Trigger is general for anything that sets off an event; catalyst specifically implies something that accelerates a process already underway
discern	detect	Detect is general for noticing the presence of something; discern specifically implies perceiving something subtle or requiring careful attention
phenomenon	occurrence	Occurrence is general for any event that happens; phenomenon specifically implies something notable enough to be observed and studied
plausible	credible	Credible is general, for anything believable; plausible specifically implies an explanation that seems reasonable given the facts, without confirming it's true
sceptical	doubtful	Doubtful is general for any uncertainty; sceptical specifically implies a habitual, questioning attitude towards claims until evidence is provided
speculate	theorise	Theorise is more formal and structured, implying a developed explanation; speculate implies a more tentative guess without firm evidence

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
anomaly	norm	Direct — the usual, expected pattern, rather than a deviation from it
catalyst	inhibitor	Direct — in chemistry, a substance that slows a reaction down rather than speeding it up
inconclusive	conclusive	Direct — proving something clearly, and ending any doubt
plausible	implausible	Direct — not seeming reasonable or believable
sceptical	credulous	Direct — too ready to believe things without sufficient evidence
speculate	confirm	Not exact — confirm implies establishing something as true, not simply the opposite act of guessing

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
—	anomaly	anomalous	anomalously
discern	discernment	discernible	discernibly
—	hypothesis	hypothetical	hypothetically
replicate	replication	—	—
speculate	speculation	speculative	speculatively

DID YOU KNOW? — “Hypothesis” comes from the Greek hypo- (“under”) and thesis (“a placing”) — literally, “a placing under,” the foundation laid beneath an argument.

5 Collocations

• act as a catalyst	• a controlled variable
• paradigm shift	• a rigorous methodology
• barely discern	• direct causation
• a plausible explanation	• a strong correlation
• a clear anomaly	• a natural phenomenon
• remain inconclusive	• test a hypothesis

FUN FACT — The historian and philosopher Thomas Kuhn popularised the term “paradigm shift” in his 1962 book The Structure of Scientific Revolutions, describing how anomalies can eventually overturn an accepted framework.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
back up	to support a claim or theory with evidence	The results backed up the team's original hypothesis.
carry out	to perform an experiment or piece of research	Researchers carried out a series of controlled trials.
narrow down	to reduce a range of possibilities to a smaller number	The team narrowed down the possible causes to just two.
rule out	to eliminate a possibility from consideration	The scientists ruled out contamination as an explanation.
set out	to begin a piece of research with a clear aim	The study set out to test a single, specific hypothesis.

7 60-Second Challenge

HOW TO PLAY

Challenge 1: 60 seconds to argue a position using at least 4 unit words. Challenge 2: 60 seconds to argue the opposite, using at least 4 different unit words. No hesitating, no repeating a sentence structure. Stall more than ten seconds and you're out.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*There's no easy answer here, but…*	There's no easy answer here, but a single anomaly rarely overturns an entire paradigm on its own.
Challenging a claim	*That's debatable, given that…*	That's debatable, given that a strong correlation still isn't enough to prove causation.
Closing an argument	*This is why it matters that…*	This is why it matters that a hypothesis is always tested before it's treated as fact.
Drawing a comparison	*By comparison…*	By comparison, a plausible explanation isn't the same as a proven one.
Giving evidence	*Just look at…*	Just look at how often results turn out to be inconclusive until an experiment is replicated.
Hedging a claim	*One might claim that…*	One might claim that scientists should stay sceptical of any single study's methodology.
Opening a viewpoint	*As I see it…*	As I see it, a good catalyst for scientific progress is simply asking better questions.
Quantifying / citing scale	*This affects a significant number of…*	This affects a significant number of studies that rely on a single uncontrolled variable.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** A theory should be accepted once enough evidence appears to support it.
   B) Even strong evidence can later be overturned by a single unexplained anomaly.

2. **A)** Scientists should always remain sceptical, even of their own findings.
   B) Excessive scepticism can slow down genuine progress and discourage new ideas.

3. **A)** A result that cannot be replicated should not be trusted at all.
   B) Some genuine phenomena are simply difficult to reproduce under different conditions.

4. **A)** Correlation is usually a strong enough sign of causation to act on.
   B) Acting on correlation alone can lead to completely wrong conclusions.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. How much evidence is enough before a hypothesis should be accepted as fact?

2. Is healthy scepticism more valuable to science than open-mindedness?

3. Should a study that can't be replicated ever be trusted?

4. Why do people so often confuse correlation with causation?

10 Context Passage

For three years, a research team had tracked a small but consistent anomaly in their data: a pattern that didn't fit any existing model. Most colleagues dismissed it as a measurement error. The team wasn't so sure.

Their hypothesis was simple but risky: what if the anomaly wasn't a mistake, but evidence of something the current paradigm simply couldn't explain? Testing it meant redesigning the entire experiment, controlling for a variable nobody had previously considered.

The first results were inconclusive. The second attempt, using a slightly different methodology, produced a correlation too strong to dismiss as coincidence. Still, correlation wasn't proof of causation, and the team knew it.

It took another laboratory, on the other side of the world, to replicate the finding independently before anyone took it seriously. Only then did sceptical colleagues start proposing plausible explanations of their own. The original anomaly hadn't just been confirmed. It had become the catalyst for an entirely new line of research.

> **TRIVIA** — “Sceptical” comes from the Greek skeptikos (“thoughtful, inquiring”), the name given to the followers of the philosopher Pyrrho, who held that certainty about most things was impossible.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Odd One Out — circle the word that doesn't belong, and be ready to explain why.

1. anomaly irregularity norm deviation
2. plausible credible believable implausible
3. sceptical doubtful questioning credulous
4. discern detect perceive ignore
5. hypothesis theory guess certainty

B. Transformation — rewrite each sentence using the word in capitals in a different form, keeping the same meaning.

1. The reading behaved in a way that was highly unusual and unexpected. (ANOMALY)

_____

2. No clear pattern could be made out in the early results. (DISCERN)

_____

3. The scientists' explanation for the cause had little firm proof behind it. (SPECULATE)

_____

4. Getting the same results again in a different lab confirmed the finding. (REPLICATE)

_____

5. Imagine, just as a theoretical exercise, that the outcome had been completely different. (HYPOTHESIS)

_____

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **correlation**, **hypothesis**, **phenomenon**, **replicate**, **variable**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 21

Food & Lifestyle

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**artisanal** *adj.*	Made in a traditional or skilled way, usually in small quantities	The bakery specialises in artisanal bread made by hand.
2	**connoisseur** *n.*	A person with expert knowledge and appreciation of food, drink, or art	She's a real connoisseur of regional cuisine.
3	**culinary** *adj.*	Relating to cooking or the kitchen	He studied at a culinary school in Paris.
4	**cuisine** *n.*	A style of cooking characteristic of a particular country or region	The restaurant specialises in traditional regional cuisine.
5	**ferment** *v.*	To undergo or cause a chemical change through the action of yeast or bacteria	The dough is left to ferment overnight.
6	**indulge** *v.*	To allow yourself to enjoy something, especially food, often more than necessary	It's fine to indulge occasionally, as long as your diet stays balanced overall.
7	**nutritious** *adj.*	Containing substances the body needs to be healthy	A nutritious breakfast helps you concentrate through the morning.
8	**organic** *adj.*	Produced without artificial chemicals	Organic vegetables are grown without synthetic pesticides.
9	**palate** *n.*	A person's ability to taste and appreciate food, or their sense of taste	Years of cooking gave her a genuinely sophisticated palate.
10	**portion** *n.*	An amount of food served to one person	The restaurant is known for its generous portions.
11	**processed** *adj.*	(of food) treated or prepared through industrial or chemical methods	Highly processed foods often contain more salt and sugar than people realise.
12	**savour** *v.*	To enjoy food or an experience slowly and fully	She savoured every bite of the meal.
13	**staple** *n.*	A main or basic food eaten regularly	Rice is a staple in many parts of the world.
14	**sustenance** *n.*	Food and drink regarded as a source of nourishment	The travellers carried enough sustenance for a week.
15	**wholesome** *adj.*	Good for one's health; promoting physical wellbeing	The school cafeteria now offers more wholesome meal options.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
connoisseur	expert	Expert is general for anyone highly skilled in any field; connoisseur specifically implies refined taste and appreciation, especially in food, drink, or art
indulge	treat oneself	Treat oneself is informal and everyday; indulge is more formal and can imply enjoying something to excess
nutritious	healthy	Healthy is general, describing anything good for the body; nutritious specifically implies containing the substances the body needs
organic	natural	Natural is general, for anything not artificially altered; organic specifically implies produced without synthetic chemicals, under a formal standard
palate	taste	Taste is the general, everyday word; palate specifically implies a trained or refined ability to distinguish flavours
savour	relish	Relish is slightly more informal; savour implies deliberately slowing down to enjoy something fully
wholesome	nourishing	Nourishing is general, for anything that provides nutrition; wholesome specifically implies being generally good for health and wellbeing

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
indulge	abstain	Direct — to deliberately avoid or hold back from something
nutritious	empty	Not exact — ‘empty’ (as in empty calories) implies food that provides energy but little nutritional value
organic	synthetic	Direct — produced artificially using chemical processes, rather than naturally
processed	raw	Direct — food in its natural, unaltered state
staple	rarity	Not exact — a rarity is something uncommon, not a precise opposite of a regularly eaten food
wholesome	unhealthy	Direct — harmful or damaging to physical health

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
ferment	fermentation	fermented	—
indulge	indulgence	indulgent	indulgently
—	nutrition	nutritious	nutritiously
process	processing	processed	—
—	sustenance	—	—

DID YOU KNOW? — “Cuisine” comes from the French word for “kitchen,” ultimately from the Latin coquere (“to cook”).

5 Collocations

• artisanal bread	• diverse cuisine
• highly processed	• organic produce
• connoisseur of wine	• ferment naturally
• indulge occasionally	• refined palate
• culinary tradition	• generous portion
• nutritious diet	• wholesome meal

FUN FACT — “Connoisseur” comes from the French connaître, meaning “to know” — a connoisseur is, literally, someone who knows.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
dish up	to serve food, especially onto plates	She dished up the meal as soon as the guests arrived.
eat out	to have a meal at a restaurant rather than at home	They eat out at least once a week.
fill up	to eat until you feel satisfied or full	He filled up on bread before the main course even arrived.
snack on	to eat small amounts of food between meals	She likes to snack on fruit in the afternoon.
whip up	to prepare food quickly	He whipped up a quick meal after work.

7 Word Auction

HOW TO PLAY

Split the class into 2–3 teams, each starting with 20 points. Read a unit word aloud; teams privately bid points to claim it. The highest bidder must use the word correctly in a sentence within 10 seconds. Correct, and they keep the word; wrong, and the points are lost anyway — the word returns to auction. The team with the most correctly-used words wins, not the team with the most points left.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*This isn't a simple issue, because…*	This isn't a simple issue, because a refined palate doesn't automatically mean a healthier diet.
Challenging a claim	*I'm not convinced that…*	I'm not convinced that organic food is always significantly more nutritious than conventionally grown food.
Conceding a point	*That's fair, but…*	That's fair, but an occasional indulgence rarely undoes months of wholesome eating.
Giving evidence	*This is evident in…*	This is evident in how quickly processed snacks have replaced traditional staples in many diets.
Opening a viewpoint	*I'd argue that…*	I'd argue that a nutritious diet matters more for long-term health than any single indulgence.
Quantifying / citing scale	*The scale of this is significant because…*	The scale of this is significant because processed food now makes up a large portion of the average diet.
Softening disagreement	*I see your point, but consider…*	I see your point, but consider how artisanal production can't realistically feed an entire population.
Summarising a position	*Overall, the point stands that…*	Overall, the point stands that balance matters more than strict rules about what to eat.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Organic food is always worth the extra cost.
   B) The nutritional difference between organic and conventional food is often smaller than people assume.

2. **A)** Fermented and traditional foods should be part of every diet.
   B) Not every fermented food suits every diet, and some people should avoid them for health reasons.

3. **A)** Restaurants should be required to offer smaller portions as standard.
   B) Smaller default portions could just lead people to order more dishes overall.

4. **A)** A wholesome diet leaves no room for indulgence.
   B) Occasional indulgence can make a healthy diet easier to sustain long-term.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Is organic food worth the extra cost, or is it mostly marketing?

2. Should traditional, artisanal food production be protected even if it's less efficient?

3. Do larger portion sizes actually make us eat more, or just waste more?

4. Can indulgence and a wholesome diet coexist, or are they always in conflict?

10 Context Passage

The bakery had survived on the same recipe for three generations: a dense, slow-fermented bread made the same way her grandmother had made it, using nothing but flour, water, salt, and time.

When a large supermarket chain opened nearby, offering cheap, heavily processed bread at half the price, most people assumed the bakery would close within a year. It didn't.

Instead, something unexpected happened. Customers who had never thought twice about their bread started asking questions. Why did this loaf taste different? What made the crust so distinct? The answer, mostly, was patience: a slow fermentation process that supermarket bread simply skipped in the name of speed and shelf life.

The bakery never advertised itself as artisanal. It didn't need to. Word spread among people who had developed, almost without noticing, a genuine palate for the difference between wholesome, carefully made food and food built purely for convenience. The supermarket bread stayed on the shelves. The bakery's queue got longer.

> **TRIVIA** — “Fermentation” comes from the Latin fervere, meaning “to boil or seethe” — a reference to the bubbling that yeast and bacteria produce.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Matching — match each word to its definition.

1. staple	a. food and drink regarded as a source of nourishment
2. sustenance	b. a main or basic food eaten regularly
3. connoisseur	c. good for one's health; promoting physical wellbeing
4. palate	d. a person's ability to taste and appreciate food
5. wholesome	e. a person with expert knowledge and appreciation of food, drink, or art

B. Gap-fill — complete with a word from this unit (correct form).

1. The dough needs several hours to _____ before baking.

2. It's fine to _____ occasionally, as long as your overall diet is balanced.

3. The soup was rich, _____ , and full of vegetables.

4. She took her time to _____ the last bite of dessert.

5. The vegetables at the market were grown _____ , without any chemical pesticides.

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **cuisine**, **nutritious**, **organic**, **portion**, **wholesome**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

UNIT 22

Change & Progress

1 Core Vocabulary

#	Word	Definition	Example
1	**deviate** *v.*	To depart from an established course, plan, or norm	The plane had to deviate from its usual flight path because of the storm.
2	**evolve** *v.*	To develop gradually over time	The company's strategy evolved significantly over the past decade.
3	**gradual** *adj.*	Happening slowly over a long period of time	There has been a gradual improvement in test scores over the last two years.
4	**incremental** *adj.*	Increasing gradually, in small steps	The team preferred incremental improvements over one large, risky change.
5	**irreversible** *adj.*	Impossible to change back to a previous state	Some environmental damage is effectively irreversible.
6	**momentous** *adj.*	Of great importance, especially because of future consequences	Choosing a university was a momentous decision for her.
7	**momentum** *n.*	The force or speed that keeps a process developing once it has started	The campaign gained momentum after the first successful event.
8	**overhaul** *n./v.*	A thorough examination and reform of a system, or to carry one out	The school announced a complete overhaul of its grading system.
9	**pioneer** *n./v.*	A person who is among the first to develop or explore something new, or to be that person	She was a pioneer in the field of renewable energy.
10	**radical** *adj.*	Relating to fundamental, far-reaching change	The committee proposed a radical restructuring of the timetable.
11	**reform** *n./v.*	A change made to a system or practice in order to improve it	The reform simplified the entire application process.
12	**stagnant** *adj.*	Not developing or progressing; showing no activity or change	Wages had remained stagnant for almost five years.
13	**transform** *v.*	To change markedly in form, nature, or appearance	New technology has transformed the way people communicate.
14	**transition** *n.*	The process of changing from one state or stage to another	The transition to the new system took almost a year.
15	**upheaval** *n.*	A sudden, violent, or extensive change or disruption	The industry went through a major upheaval after the new regulations were introduced.

2 Synonym Sets

Word	Synonym	Nuance / Register Note
evolve	develop	Develop is general for any kind of growth or progress; evolve specifically implies gradual change over an extended period, often shaped by outside pressures
gradual	steady	Steady is general, implying consistency without necessarily implying slowness; gradual specifically emphasises the slow pace of the change itself
momentous	significant	Significant is general for anything noteworthy; momentous specifically implies an event important enough to affect the future
pioneer	innovator	Innovator is general for anyone who introduces new ideas; pioneer specifically implies being among the very first to do so
radical	drastic	Drastic is general, often implying a severe or extreme measure; radical specifically implies a change that reaches to the fundamental roots of a system
transform	reshape	Reshape is general, for any significant alteration; transform specifically implies a complete change in form or character
upheaval	disruption	Disruption is general for any interruption to normal function; upheaval specifically implies a larger, more forceful, and often sudden change

3 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Note
gradual	abrupt	Direct — happening suddenly, without warning or a period of transition
irreversible	reversible	Direct — capable of being changed back to a previous state
momentum	stagnation	Not exact — stagnation describes a general lack of progress, not simply the absence of forward motion in one process
radical	moderate	Not exact — moderate implies avoiding extremes generally, not a precise opposite of fundamental change
stagnant	dynamic	Direct — constantly changing and full of energy or progress
transform	preserve	Not exact — preserve implies actively keeping something the same, not simply the absence of change

4 Word Formation

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
deviate	deviation	—	—
evolve	evolution	evolutionary	—
—	momentum	momentous	—
reform	reform	reformist	—
transform	transformation	transformative	—

DID YOU KNOW? — “Radical” comes from the Latin radix, meaning “root” — a radical change is, literally, one that reaches down to the roots of something.

5 Collocations

• build momentum	• a gradual shift
• a momentous occasion	• social upheaval
• deviate from a plan	• incremental progress
• pioneer a method	• a stagnant economy
• a drastic overhaul	• irreversible damage
• radical reform	• a transitional period

FUN FACT — “Pioneer” originally meant a foot soldier sent ahead of an army to dig trenches and clear the way — from the Old French peonier. The modern sense of “someone who goes first” only developed around 1600.

6 Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example
bring about	to cause something to happen	The new policy brought about significant change in the department.
carry through	to complete a plan or reform despite difficulty	It took real determination to carry the reform through.
give way to	to be replaced by something else	Old traditions gradually gave way to new customs.
move on	to progress to a new stage or topic	It was time for the company to move on from its old business model.
phase out	to gradually stop using or providing something	The factory plans to phase out the old machinery over the next year.

7 Definition Sprint

HOW TO PLAY

Read a definition aloud without saying the word itself. The first student to correctly call out the matching unit word scores a point. First student to 5 points wins.

8 Debate Toolkit

A. Functional Language for Debating

Function	Phrase	Topic Example
Acknowledging complexity	*There are several sides to this…*	There are several sides to this, since radical reform can fix a broken system but also create new problems overnight.
Adding weight	*On top of that…*	On top of that, gradual change tends to face far less resistance than a sudden overhaul.
Asking for clarification	*Could you explain what you mean by…?*	Could you explain what you mean by ‘progress’ — faster change, or simply better outcomes?
Challenging a claim	*I'd push back on that, because…*	I'd push back on that, because not every tradition that resists change is actually holding people back.
Conceding a point	*Fair enough, however…*	Fair enough, however momentum, once lost, can be extremely hard to rebuild.
Drawing a comparison	*Unlike…*	Unlike incremental change, a radical overhaul rarely gives people time to adapt.
Giving evidence	*You can see this in…*	You can see this in how quickly stagnant industries lose ground to newer competitors.
Opening a viewpoint	*From my point of view…*	From my point of view, real progress is almost always gradual, not sudden.

B. Argument & Counter

Pick a position, then argue against it using the language above.

1. **A)** Gradual, incremental change is always safer than radical reform.
   B) Sometimes a slow, incremental approach isn't enough to fix a genuinely broken system in time.

2. **A)** Pioneers who push for change too early usually fail.
   B) Without early pioneers willing to take the risk, meaningful change would never begin at all.

3. **A)** An organisation that feels stagnant should be completely overhauled.
   B) A full overhaul can destroy exactly the parts of an organisation that were still working well.

4. **A)** Some changes are so momentous that they should never be treated as irreversible.
   B) Certain decisions are irreversible by nature, no matter how much people might want to undo them later.

9 Discussion Prompts

1. Is gradual, incremental change always safer than radical reform?

2. What makes someone a pioneer rather than just early to an idea that was going to happen anyway?

3. Should a stagnant organisation be reformed gradually or overhauled completely?

4. Can any change truly be called irreversible?

10 Context Passage

The factory had run the same way for almost forty years, and for most of that time, nobody questioned it. Output was steady. Nothing improved, but nothing collapsed either. Workers called it reliable. An outside consultant called it stagnant.

When new ownership took over, the pressure for radical change was immediate. Overhaul everything, replace every outdated machine, rewrite every process within a year. The plan was ambitious, momentous even, and almost entirely unrealistic.

What actually worked was slower and far less dramatic. A single production line was updated first, as a trial. Small, incremental adjustments followed, one at a time, each tested before the next began. Momentum built gradually instead of arriving all at once.

Three years later, the factory looked almost unrecognisable. The transition had been gradual enough that most workers barely noticed the moment things had changed, only that they had. No single decision had felt radical. Together, they amounted to exactly that kind of transformation anyway.

> **TRIVIA** — “Momentum” comes from the Latin movimentum, related to movere (“to move”) — originally a term from physics, long before it described anything from campaigns to careers.

11 Quick Practice

Two exercises, five minutes each.

A. Odd One Out — circle the word that doesn't belong, and be ready to explain why.

1. gradual incremental steady abrupt
2. radical drastic extreme moderate
3. stagnant dynamic thriving evolving
4. momentous significant important trivial
5. transform reshape convert preserve

B. Transformation — rewrite each sentence using the word in capitals in a different form, keeping the same meaning.

1. The bus took a different route from its usual one because of the roadworks. (DEVIATE)

_____

2. The way people shop has slowly changed a great deal over the last twenty years. (EVOLVE)

_____

3. The decision to leave was hugely important for her future. (MOMENTUM)

_____

4. New technology has completely changed the way people communicate. (TRANSFORM)

_____

5. The new leader strongly supported changing and improving the old system. (REFORM)

_____

NON-NEGOTIABLES

By the end of this unit, these five should be automatic — no hesitation, no translating in your head: **gradual**, **momentum**, **radical**, **transform**, **transition**.

If any of these still feel unfamiliar, go back through the unit before moving on.

APPENDIX

Word Index

Every core vocabulary word and word-formation noun used in this book, in alphabetical order.

Word	Definition
accomplice *n.*	A person who helps another commit a crime
accord *n.*	A formal agreement between two or more countries or parties
accountability *n.*	Being responsible for one's actions and able to explain them
acquisition *n.*	The act of buying another company, or the company bought
acquit *v.*	To formally declare someone not guilty of a crime
adapt *v.*	To change or adjust in order to deal with new conditions
adaptation *n.*	The process of changing to suit new conditions.
aesthetic *adj.*	Relating to beauty or the appreciation of beauty
aggregate *adj./n.*	A total amount made up of smaller amounts combined together
ailment *n.*	An illness, especially a minor one
algorithm *n.*	A set of step-by-step instructions for solving a problem or completing a task, especially by a computer
alienate *v.*	To make someone feel that they no longer belong to a group, or to cause someone to stop supporting you
alienation *n.*	The state of feeling isolated or estranged from others.
allegation *n.*	A claim or assertion that someone has done something wrong, made without proof.
allege *v.*	To claim that someone has done something illegal or wrong, without yet proving it
alliance *n.*	A formal association between countries or groups formed for mutual benefit
allocation *n.*	The distribution of resources for a particular purpose
amend *v.*	To make small changes to a law or legal document
amendment *n.*	A minor change or addition made to a law or document.
amenity *n.*	A facility or service that makes a place more pleasant or convenient
anomaly *n.*	Something that deviates from what is normal or expected
anonymous *adj.*	Not named or identified
appeal *v.*	To ask a higher court to reconsider a legal decision
applicant *n.*	A person who formally applies for a job
aptitude *n.*	A natural ability or skill to do something well
arbitration *n.*	A way of settling a dispute outside court, using an independent person to decide
artisanal *adj.*	Made in a traditional or skilled way, usually in small quantities
assessment *n.*	The act of judging or evaluating someone's ability, progress, or performance
asset *n.*	Something valuable that a company owns and can use to generate income

Word	Definition
asymmetrical *adj.*	Not identical or balanced on both sides
asymmetry *n.*	A lack of balance or equality between parts.
austerity *n.*	Reduced government spending, often introduced during economic difficulty
authentic *adj.*	Genuine; not a copy or imitation
authenticate *v.*	To prove that someone is who they claim to be, especially using a password or other electronic method
authentication *n.*	The process of proving that something, such as a user or piece of data, is genuine.
authenticity *n.*	The quality of being genuine or real.
automate *v.*	To make a process work by machine or computer instead of by people
automation *n.*	The use of machines or systems to perform tasks without human control.
avant-garde *adj.*	New and experimental in style, especially in art
ballot *n.*	A system of voting, often in secret, or the paper used to cast a vote
bandwidth *n.*	The amount of data that can be sent between computers or over a network in a given time
bankrupt *adj.*	Legally unable to pay what you owe
bankruptcy *n.*	The legal state of being unable to pay debts owed.
bias *n.*	An unfair tendency to favour one side over another
bilateral *adj.*	Involving two countries or parties
binding *adj.*	Legally required to be obeyed
biodiversity *n.*	The variety of plant and animal life in a habitat or the world
blueprint *n.*	A detailed technical plan or drawing
bond *n./v.*	A close connection or shared feeling that links people together
breach *n.*	A failure in a security system that allows unauthorised access to data or a network
breakthrough *n.*	An important discovery or achievement that helps solve a problem or improve a situation
broadcast *v.*	To transmit a programme on television or radio
bug *n.*	An error in a computer program that causes it to work incorrectly
bureaucracy *n.*	A system of administration run by officials following fixed rules and procedures
burnout *n.*	Extreme tiredness or mental exhaustion caused by working too hard for too long
camaraderie *n.*	A feeling of trust and friendship among people who share experiences
canon *n.*	The body of works widely accepted as the most important in a particular field
catalyst *n.*	Something that causes or speeds up change, or a substance that speeds up a chemical reaction without being changed itself
causation *n.*	The action of causing something; the relationship between cause and effect
ceasefire *n.*	An agreement to stop fighting, especially temporarily
censorship *n.*	The suppression of information or media considered objectionable
chronic *adj.*	Describes an illness or condition that lasts for a long time

Word	Definition
civic *adj.*	Relating to a city, town, or its citizens
clause *n.*	A particular section of a legal document
cognitive *adj.*	Relating to the mental processes involved in thinking, understanding, and learning
commodity *n.*	A raw material or primary agricultural product that can be bought and sold
commute *v.*	To travel regularly between home and work
compatibility *n.*	The ability of two or more things to exist or work together without conflict.
compatible *adj.*	Able to work with a particular type of computer, device, or system without problems
composition *n.*	The way parts are arranged to form a whole
comprehension *n.*	The ability to understand something completely
compulsion *n.*	A strong, irresistible urge to do something, often against one's conscious wishes
conditioning *n.*	A process of learning in which a response becomes associated with a particular stimulus
configuration *n.*	The particular arrangement or set-up of a system or its parts.
configure *v.*	To set up a device or system so that it works in a particular way
conform *v.*	To behave according to the standards or expectations of a group
conformity *n.*	Behaviour in accordance with socially accepted standards or norms.
conglomerate *n.*	A large corporation made up of several smaller, often unrelated companies
connoisseur *n.*	A person with expert knowledge and appreciation of food, drink, or art
conservation *n.*	The protection of natural resources, wildlife, or environment from damage
constituent *n.*	A person represented by an elected official, or a part that makes up a whole
consumer *n.*	A person who buys goods or services for personal use
consumption *n.*	The action of using up a resource or buying and using goods and services.
contaminate *v.*	To make something impure or harmful by adding a polluting substance
contamination *n.*	The state of being made impure or harmful by a polluting substance.
contemporary *adj.*	Belonging to the present time
convict *v.*	To formally declare someone guilty of a crime in a court of law
conviction *n.*	The act of finding someone guilty of a crime in a court of law; a firmly held belief.
correlation *n.*	A relationship between two variables in which they tend to change together
correspondent *n.*	A journalist who reports news from a particular place or on a particular subject
coverage *n.*	The reporting of a news event by the media
credentials *n.*	The qualifications and experience that make someone suitable for a job
credibility *n.*	The quality of being trusted or believed.
credible *adj.*	Able to be believed or trusted
critique *n.*	A detailed analysis and assessment of something
cuisine *n.*	A style of cooking characteristic of a particular country or region

Word	Definition
culinary *adj.*	Relating to cooking or the kitchen
culprit *n.*	A person who has committed a crime or done something wrong
curator *n.*	A person who selects and manages items for a museum or exhibition
currency *n.*	The system of money used in a particular country
curriculum *n.*	The subjects and courses that make up a programme of study
custody *n.*	The state of being detained by the police, usually before a trial
customisation *n.*	The process of modifying something to suit a particular individual or task.
customise *v.*	To make or change something according to a user's needs
cutting-edge *adj.*	The most advanced stage of development in a particular field
database *n.*	A large amount of information stored on a computer so that it can be easily searched or changed
defendant *n.*	The person being sued or accused in a court case
deficiency *n.*	A lack of something necessary, especially a vitamin or nutrient
deficit *n.*	The amount by which spending exceeds income
degradation *n.*	The process of land or environmental quality being made worse
delegate *v.*	To give part of your job or a task to someone else to do
delegation *n.*	A group of representatives sent to act or speak on behalf of a larger group
demand *n.*	The desire and ability of buyers to purchase a particular good or service
deplete *v.*	To gradually reduce something until little or none is left
depletion *n.*	The reduction of something until little or none is left.
deploy *v.*	To put a system, program, or update into active use
deployment *n.*	The act of putting something, such as troops or software, into effective action.
depreciation *n.*	A reduction in the value of an asset or currency over time
deter *v.*	To discourage someone from doing something by making them afraid of the consequences
deterrence *n.*	The act of discouraging an action through fear of consequences.
deviate *v.*	To depart from an established course, plan, or norm
deviation *n.*	A departure from an established course, standard, or expectation.
diagnose *v.*	To identify an illness by examining its signs and symptoms
diagnosis *n.*	The identification of the nature of an illness or problem through examination.
diligence *n.*	Careful and persistent effort or work.
diligent *adj.*	Showing steady, careful effort in one's work
diplomacy *n.*	The management of relations between countries through negotiation rather than force
discern *v.*	To perceive or recognise something, especially something not immediately obvious
discernment *n.*	The ability to judge well or perceive things clearly.

Word	Definition
dismiss *v.*	To officially remove someone from their job
dismissal *n.*	The act of officially removing someone from a job.
disrupt *v.*	To change an established industry or process fundamentally, often through new technology
disruption *n.*	Disturbance or interruption to a normal process or activity.
disseminate *v.*	To spread information widely
dissemination *n.*	The act of spreading information widely.
dividend *n.*	A portion of a company's profit paid to shareholders
eclectic *adj.*	Deriving ideas or style from a wide range of sources
ecosystem *n.*	A community of living things together with the environment they interact with
editorial *n.*	An article expressing the opinion of a publication's editors
elasticity *n.*	The degree to which demand or supply changes in response to a change in price
electorate *n.*	All the people entitled to vote in a particular election
embark *v.*	To begin a journey, especially by ship or plane, or to begin a significant undertaking
embarkation *n.*	The act of boarding a ship, aircraft, or vehicle at the start of a journey.
embassy *n.*	The official group of representatives of one country in another, or the building where they work
emission *n.*	A substance, especially gas, released into the air
empathy *n.*	The ability to understand and share the feelings of another person
empirical *adj.*	Based on observation or experiment rather than on theory alone
encrypt *v.*	To protect information by putting it into a code that only authorised people can read
encryption *n.*	The process of converting information into a code to prevent unauthorised access.
engage *v.*	To attract and hold someone's attention or interest
engagement *n.*	The state of being involved with or committed to something.
entrepreneur *n.*	A person who starts and runs their own business, especially one involving financial risk
entrepreneurship *n.*	The activity of setting up and running a business, taking on financial risk to do so.
envoy *n.*	A messenger or representative sent on an official or diplomatic mission
equilibrium *n.*	The point at which supply and demand are balanced
ergonomic *adj.*	Designed to be comfortable and efficient to use
estrange *v.*	To cause someone to no longer feel close or friendly with a person they were once close to
etiquette *n.*	The accepted rules of polite behaviour in a particular group or situation
evolution *n.*	The gradual development of something over time.
evolve *v.*	To develop gradually over time
excursion *n.*	A short journey or trip, usually taken for pleasure
exhaustion *n.*	A state of extreme physical or mental tiredness
exhibition *n.*	A public display of works of art or items of interest

Word	Definition
externality *n.*	A cost or benefit of an economic activity that affects a third party not directly involved
felony *n.*	A serious crime, usually punishable by a year or more in prison
ferment *v.*	To undergo or cause a chemical change through the action of yeast or bacteria
fermentation *n.*	The chemical breakdown of a substance by bacteria, yeasts, or other micro-organisms.
firewall *n.*	A program or device that prevents unauthorised access to a computer or network
fiscal *adj.*	Relating to government revenue, spending, and taxation
forensic *adj.*	Relating to the scientific methods used to investigate crime
franchise *n.*	The right to sell a company's products or services under its name in a particular area
functional *adj.*	Designed to be practical and useful rather than attractive
functionality *n.*	The range of operations or purposes that something, especially a product, can perform.
geopolitical *adj.*	Relating to politics, especially international relations, as influenced by geography
geopolitics *n.*	The study of how geography and politics influence relations between nations.
glitch *n.*	A small, usually temporary problem or fault, especially in a computer or system
gradient *n.*	A gradual blending from one colour or tone to another
gradual *adj.*	Happening slowly over a long period of time
grasp *v.*	To understand something, especially something difficult
habitat *n.*	The natural home or environment of an animal or plant
headline *n.*	The title of a news story, printed in large type
heritage *n.*	Traditions, buildings, and achievements passed down through generations
holistic *adj.*	Treating the whole person, not just the specific illness or symptom
hospitality *n.*	Friendly and generous treatment of guests or visitors
humanitarian *adj.*	Concerned with reducing suffering and improving people's welfare
humanitarianism *n.*	The belief in or practice of promoting human welfare.
hypothesis *n.*	A proposed explanation for something, made as a starting point for further investigation
immersion *n.*	Deep mental or physical involvement in an activity or environment.
immersive *adj.*	Providing deep involvement or absorption in an experience or environment
immune *adj.*	Protected against a particular disease
incarcerate *v.*	To put someone in prison
incarceration *n.*	The state of being imprisoned.
incentive *n.*	Something that encourages a person to work harder or behave in a particular way
inconclusive *adj.*	Not leading to a definite result or decision
incremental *adj.*	Increasing gradually, in small steps
indigenous *adj.*	Originating naturally in a particular place rather than having been brought there from elsewhere

Word	Definition
indulge *v.*	To allow yourself to enjoy something, especially food, often more than necessary
indulgence *n.*	The act of allowing oneself a pleasure, often to excess.
inflation *n.*	A general and sustained rise in prices over time
infrastructure *n.*	The basic physical systems, such as roads, power, and water supply, needed for a society to function
injunction *n.*	An official court order to do or stop doing something
innate *adj.*	Present in someone from birth rather than learned
innovate *v.*	To introduce new ideas, methods, or products
innovation *n.*	A new idea, method, or invention.
instinct *n.*	A natural tendency to behave in a particular way without conscious thought
integrate *v.*	To combine two or more things so that they work together as one
interface *n.*	The point where a user interacts with a computer, or where two systems connect
interrogate *v.*	To question someone closely and often forcefully, especially a suspect
interrogation *n.*	The formal and systematic questioning of a person, especially a suspect.
introspection *n.*	The examination of one's own thoughts and feelings
investment *n.*	Money committed to something, especially a business or project, in order to gain a future return
irreversible *adj.*	Impossible to change back to a previous state
iteration *n.*	A new version of a design produced through repeated refinement
itinerary *n.*	A detailed plan or route for a journey
jurisdiction *n.*	The official power to make legal decisions
kinship *n.*	A close connection, especially between family members, or a feeling of understanding between people
layover *n.*	A short stay in one place during a longer journey, especially between connecting flights
legislation *n.*	A law or set of laws
leverage *n.*	The use of borrowed money to increase the potential return of an investment
levy *n./v.*	A sum of money, such as a tax, officially demanded and collected, or to officially demand it
liability *n.*	A debt or financial obligation a company owes
liquidate *v.*	To close a business and sell its assets in order to pay off debts
liquidation *n.*	The process of closing a business and dividing its assets among creditors.
literacy *n.*	The ability to read and write
litigation *n.*	The process of taking a dispute through the courts
lucrative *adj.*	Producing a lot of money; profitable
malleable *adj.*	Easily influenced or shaped, especially by other people or ideas
malnutrition *n.*	Poor health caused by not eating enough, or not eating the right kinds of food

Word	Definition
malware *n.*	Software specifically designed to damage a computer system or gain unauthorised access to it
mandate *n.*	Official authority given to someone to carry out a plan or policy
manifest *v.*	To show something clearly through signs or actions
margin *n.*	The difference between what something costs to produce and the price it sells for
marginal *adj.*	Relating to a small or additional change, especially the next unit produced or consumed
masterpiece *n.*	A work of outstanding skill or artistry
mentor *n./v.*	A more experienced person who advises and guides someone with less experience
merger *n.*	The joining of two companies to form one
methodology *n.*	A system of methods used in a particular field of study
milestone *n.*	An important event that marks a stage in someone's life or in the development of something
minimalist *adj.*	Using the smallest range of materials, colours, and detail possible
misinformation *n.*	False information spread regardless of intent to deceive
mitigate *v.*	To make something less severe, harmful, or serious
mockup *n.*	A static, detailed visual model showing how a finished design will look
momentous *adj.*	Of great importance, especially because of future consequences
momentum *n.*	The force or speed that keeps a process developing once it has started
monetary *adj.*	Relating to money or a country's money supply
monopoly *n.*	Complete control of a market by a single company, leaving no real competition
motif *n.*	A recurring image, idea, or theme in a work of art
motivation *n.*	The reason or drive behind a person's behaviour or actions
multilateral *adj.*	Involving more than two countries or parties
municipal *adj.*	Relating to a town or city's local government
municipality *n.*	A city, town, or district with its own local government.
negotiate *v.*	To discuss something formally in order to reach an agreement
negotiation *n.*	Discussion aimed at reaching an agreement.
nepotism *n.*	Unfairly giving jobs or advantages to relatives or friends
neutrality *n.*	The state of not supporting either side in a conflict or disagreement
nomad *n.*	A person who moves from place to place rather than settling permanently.
nomadic *adj.*	Moving from place to place rather than settling permanently in one location
nutrition *n.*	The process of providing or obtaining the food necessary for health and growth.
nutritious *adj.*	Containing substances the body needs to be healthy
obsolescence *n.*	The state of being no longer used or useful, typically due to being replaced by something newer.
obsolete *adj.*	No longer used because something newer has replaced it

Word	Definition
offender *n.*	A person who has committed a crime
oligopoly *n.*	A market dominated by a small number of large sellers
organic *adj.*	Produced without artificial chemicals
outage *n.*	A period during which a system or service is unavailable
outlet *n.*	An organisation that publishes or broadcasts news
outsource *v.*	To pay another company to do work rather than using your own employees
overhaul *n./v.*	A thorough examination and reform of a system, or to carry one out
overhead *n.*	The regular ongoing costs of running a business, such as rent and utilities
palate *n.*	A person's ability to taste and appreciate food, or their sense of taste
palette *n.*	The range of colours used in a design
paradigm *n.*	A typical example or pattern of something; a model or framework of thought
parole *n.*	The early release of a prisoner on condition of good behaviour
patron *n.*	A person who financially supports an artist, writer, or institution
perception *n.*	The way something is understood or interpreted through the senses or the mind
petition *n./v.*	A formal written request, often signed by many people, or to make such a request
phenomenon *n.*	A fact, occurrence, or situation that is observed to exist
picturesque *adj.*	Visually attractive, especially in a way that resembles a painting
pilgrimage *n.*	A journey made to a place of religious or personal significance
pioneer *n./v.*	A person who is among the first to develop or explore something new, or to be that person
plaintiff *n.*	The person who brings a case against someone else in court
plausible *adj.*	Seeming reasonable or probable
polluter *n.*	A person, company, or thing that pollutes.
pollution *n.*	Harmful substances released into the air, water, or soil
portion *n.*	An amount of food served to one person
precedent *n.*	An earlier legal case used as a guide for later decisions
prescribe *v.*	To officially recommend a medicine or treatment
prescription *n.*	An instruction, usually written by a doctor, for the preparation and use of a medicine.
prevalence *n.*	The fact or condition of being widespread or common.
prevalent *adj.*	Existing very commonly in a particular place or at a particular time
probation *n.*	A trial period at the start of a job during which performance is closely watched
processed *adj.*	(of food) treated or prepared through industrial or chemical methods
processing *n.*	A series of actions taken to prepare, treat, or transform something.
productivity *n.*	The rate at which goods or services are produced in relation to the resources used
proficiency *n.*	A high degree of skill or competence in something.

Word	Definition
proficient *adj.*	Skilled and experienced at doing something
propaganda *n.*	Biased or misleading information spread to promote a particular cause
protectionism *n.*	The practice of shielding domestic industries from foreign competition
protocol *n.*	A set of technical rules that control how data is exchanged between computers or devices
prototype *n.*	An early, original model of something, built to test an idea before it is produced in full
provocation *n.*	An action or speech that deliberately makes someone angry or causes a reaction.
provocative *adj.*	Intended to cause strong reaction or debate
radical *adj.*	Relating to fundamental, far-reaching change
ratification *n.*	The formal approval of an agreement, treaty, or law, making it officially valid.
ratify *v.*	To make an agreement officially valid through formal approval
recession *n.*	A period of temporary economic decline, usually marked by falling output and rising unemployment
reconcile *v.*	To restore a friendly relationship between people after a disagreement
reconciliation *n.*	The restoration of friendly relations after a disagreement.
redundant *adj.*	No longer needed because something else performs the same function
referendum *n.*	A vote in which people are asked to give their opinion on a particular issue
refine *v.*	To improve something by making small changes
refinement *n.*	The improvement of something by making small changes.
reform *n./v.*	A change made to a system or practice in order to improve it
rehabilitate *v.*	To help someone return to a normal, healthy life after an illness or injury
rehabilitation *n.*	The process of restoring someone to health or normal life through training and treatment.
reinforcement *n.*	Something that strengthens a behaviour by rewarding it
remedy *n.*	Something that treats or cures an illness or problem
remote *adj.*	Far away in distance; difficult to reach
renewable *adj.*	An energy source that naturally replaces itself and won't run out
replicate *v.*	To repeat an experiment or study to check its results
replication *n.*	The act of copying or reproducing something exactly.
repress *v.*	To prevent a thought, feeling, or memory from being consciously expressed
repression *n.*	The action of restraining or suppressing thoughts, feelings, or desires.
resign *v.*	To formally announce that you are leaving your job
resignation *n.*	The act of formally giving up a job or position.
resilience *n.*	The ability to recover quickly from difficulty, damage, or change.
resilient *adj.*	Able to recover quickly after difficulty, damage, or change
retain *v.*	To keep something in the mind; to remember

Word	Definition
retention *n.*	The continued possession, use, or control of something; the ability to keep information in the memory.
revenue *n.*	The total income a business generates, before costs are subtracted
revolution *n.*	A dramatic and wide-reaching change; a forcible overthrow of a government or system.
revolutionise *v.*	To change something so completely and fundamentally that it becomes something new
rigorous *adj.*	Thorough, strict, and demanding in method or standard
rote *adj.*	Learned or done by mechanical repetition rather than through understanding
sanction *n./v.*	An official penalty or restriction imposed to enforce compliance, or to formally approve something
savour *v.*	To enjoy food or an experience slowly and fully
scalable *adj.*	Able to grow or be made larger without losing effectiveness
scarcity *n.*	A situation where there is not enough of something
seamless *adj.*	Smooth and continuous, with no awkward gaps, interruptions, or problems
sedentary *adj.*	Involving sitting down a lot and getting little physical exercise
sensationalism *n.*	The use of shocking or exaggerated language or content to provoke public interest.
sensationalise *v.*	To present information in an exaggerated or shocking way to attract attention
silhouette *n.*	The outline or shape of something seen against a background
sceptical *adj.*	Having doubts about a claim, especially one that isn't fully proven
sojourn *n.*	A temporary stay in a place that is not one's permanent home
solidarity *n.*	Unity and mutual support within a group, especially in difficult circumstances
sovereignty *n.*	A country's power to govern itself without outside interference
speculate *v.*	To form a theory or guess about something without firm evidence
speculation *n.*	The forming of a theory without firm evidence; the buying of assets in hope of profit from price changes.
stagnant *adj.*	Not developing or progressing; showing no activity or change
stakeholder *n.*	A person or group with an interest in a company's success, such as an employee, investor, or customer
stamina *n.*	The physical or mental strength to keep doing something difficult over a long time
staple *n.*	A main or basic food eaten regularly
statute *n.*	A written law formally passed by a governing body
stimulus *n.*	Something that causes a reaction or response
subconscious *n./adj.*	Relating to the part of the mind that influences behaviour without full awareness
subsidiary *n.*	A company that is owned or controlled by a larger company
subsidy *n.*	Financial assistance given, typically by a government, to support an industry or activity
summit *n.*	A formal meeting between leaders of different countries or organisations
supply *n.*	The amount of a good or service available for purchase

Word	Definition
surplus *n.*	An amount left over after needs have been met; the opposite of a deficit
sustainability *n.*	The quality of being able to continue at the same level without depleting resources or causing lasting damage.
sustainable *adj.*	Able to continue at the same level long-term without running out of resources or causing lasting damage
sustenance *n.*	Food and drink regarded as a source of nourishment
syllabus *n.*	A document listing the topics, texts, and assessments covered in a course
symbolism *n.*	The use of symbols to represent ideas or qualities
symptom *n.*	A sign in the body that shows the presence of an illness
tabloid *n.*	A newspaper with small pages that focuses on sensational stories
taboo *n./adj.*	A subject, word, or action that is avoided because it is considered socially unacceptable
tariff *n.*	A tax imposed on goods imported into or exported out of a country
temperament *n.*	A person's natural, innate pattern of emotional and behavioural tendencies
testimony *n.*	A formal statement, especially one given in court, about what someone knows or has witnessed
tolerance *n.*	Willingness to accept behaviour, beliefs, or people that are different from your own
trade-off *n.*	A balance between two desirable but conflicting outcomes
transform *v.*	To change markedly in form, nature, or appearance
transformation *n.*	A complete change in form, appearance, or nature.
transition *n.*	The process of changing from one state or stage to another
transparency *n.*	Openness and honesty in the way an organisation or institution operates
trek *n./v.*	A long, difficult journey, especially one made on foot
tribunal *n.*	A special court or committee set up to deal with particular kinds of disputes
uncharted *adj.*	Not recorded on a map; unfamiliar or unexplored
underachieve *v.*	To perform below what is expected of one's ability
unprecedented *adj.*	Never having happened or existed before
upbringing *n.*	The way a child is cared for and taught how to behave while growing up
upheaval *n.*	A sudden, violent, or extensive change or disruption
usability *n.*	The degree to which something is easy to use
utility *n.*	The satisfaction or benefit a person gains from consuming a good or service
vacancy *n.*	A job that is available and not yet filled
vandalism *n.*	The deliberate destruction of property
variable *n.*	A factor or quantity that can change in an experiment
volatility *n.*	The tendency of prices or markets to change quickly and unpredictably
vulnerability *n.*	A weakness in a system that could be exploited by an attacker

Word	Definition
wage *n.*	Payment received for work, usually calculated hourly, daily, or weekly
wanderlust *n.*	A strong desire to travel and explore new places
welfare *n.*	The general health, happiness, and wellbeing of a person or group, or organised support for people in need
wholesome *adj.*	Good for one's health; promoting physical wellbeing
wireframe *n.*	A basic visual guide showing the structure of a design, without colour or styling

APPENDIX

Basic - Academic Word Swap Sheet

Alphabetical by Academic word. Use these upgrades to raise the register of your spoken and written English.

Basic	Academic
agreement	accord
responsibility	accountability
purchase	acquisition
clear	acquit
change	adapt
illness	ailment
push away	alienate
claim	allege
partnership	alliance
share	allocation
change	amend
facility	amenity
oddity	anomaly
unnamed	anonymous
talent	aptitude
handmade	artisanal
test	assessment
valuable item	asset
uneven	asymmetrical
cutbacks	austerity
real	authentic
computerise	automate
experimental	avant-garde
vote	ballot
broke	bankrupt
unfairness	bias
two-way	bilateral
required	binding
variety of life	biodiversity
plan	blueprint
break-in	breach

Basic	Academic
big discovery	breakthrough
show	broadcast
red tape	bureaucracy
extreme tiredness	burnout
friendship	camaraderie
trigger	catalyst
cause and effect	causation
truce	ceasefire
banning	censorship
long-term	chronic
section	clause
thinking	cognitive
product	commodity
travel to work	commute
matching	compatible
structure	composition
understanding	comprehension
urge	compulsion
set up	configure
fit in	conform
big company	conglomerate
expert	connoisseur
protection	conservation
buyer	consumer
pollute	contaminate
modern	contemporary
find guilty	convict
link	correlation
reporter	correspondent
reporting	coverage
qualifications	credentials
believable	credible
review	critique
cooking style	cuisine

Basic	Academic
cooking-related	culinary
guilty person	culprit
museum manager	curator
money	currency
course	curriculum
detention	custody
adjust	customise
advanced	cutting-edge
accused person	defendant
lack	deficiency
shortfall	deficit
damage	degradation
hand over	delegate
group of representatives	delegation
use up	deplete
roll out	deploy
loss of value	depreciation
discourage	deter
stray from	deviate
identify	diagnose
hard-working	diligent
tact	diplomacy
notice	discern
fire	dismiss
shake up	disrupt
spread	disseminate
profit share	dividend
varied	eclectic
opinion piece	editorial
voters	electorate
start	embark
release	emission
caring	empathy
evidence-based	empirical

Basic	Academic
scramble	encrypt
involve	engage
business owner	entrepreneur
representative	envoy
balance	equilibrium
comfortable to use	ergonomic
grow apart from	estrange
manners	etiquette
develop	evolve
trip	excursion
extreme tiredness	exhaustion
display	exhibition
serious crime	felony
brew	ferment
financial	fiscal
crime-scene	forensic
licensed branch	franchise
practical	functional
small problem	glitch
slow	gradual
understand	grasp
home	habitat
title	headline
tradition	heritage
whole-person	holistic
welcoming service	hospitality
caring (about people)	humanitarian
theory	hypothesis
fully involving	immersive
protected	immune
jail	incarcerate
reward	incentive
unclear	inconclusive
step-by-step	incremental

Basic	Academic
native	indigenous
treat yourself	indulge
rising prices	inflation
basic systems	infrastructure
court order	injunction
natural	innate
invent	innovate
gut feeling	instinct
combine	integrate
question	interrogate
self-reflection	introspection
funding	investment
permanent	irreversible
version	iteration
travel plan	itinerary
authority	jurisdiction
family bond	kinship
stopover	layover
laws	legislation
debt	liability
sell off	liquidate
reading ability	literacy
lawsuit	litigation
profitable	lucrative
flexible	malleable
poor diet	malnutrition
official permission	mandate
show	manifest
profit gap	margin
minor	marginal
great work	masterpiece
guide	mentor
joining	merger
method	methodology

Basic	Academic
key event	milestone
simple	minimalist
false info	misinformation
lessen	mitigate
model	mockup
very important	momentous
drive	momentum
financial	monetary
total control	monopoly
theme	motif
drive	motivation
many-country	multilateral
local	municipal
bargain	negotiate
favouritism	nepotism
not taking sides	neutrality
wandering	nomadic
healthy	nutritious
outdated	obsolete
criminal	offender
natural	organic
blackout	outage
news source	outlet
hire out	outsource
fix-up	overhaul
running costs	overhead
sense of taste	palate
colour range	palette
model	paradigm
early release	parole
sponsor	patron
view	perception
signed request	petition
occurrence	phenomenon

Basic	Academic
pretty	picturesque
religious trip	pilgrimage
person suing	plaintiff
believable	plausible
dirt (in the environment)	pollution
serving	portion
earlier example	precedent
recommend	prescribe
common	prevalent
trial period	probation
factory-made	processed
efficiency	productivity
skilled	proficient
biased info	propaganda
rules	protocol
first model	prototype
controversial	provocative
extreme	radical
approve	ratify
downturn	recession
make up	reconcile
unneeded	redundant
public vote	referendum
polish	refine
improvement	reform
help recover	rehabilitate
reward	reinforcement
cure	remedy
far away	remote
never runs out	renewable
copy	replicate
hold back	repress
quit	resign
tough	resilient

Basic	Academic
keep	retain
income	revenue
totally change	revolutionise
strict	rigorous
by heart	rote
penalty	sanction
enjoy	savour
expandable	scalable
shortage	scarcity
smooth	seamless
inactive	sedentary
exaggerate	sensationalise
outline	silhouette
doubtful	sceptical
short stay	sojourn
unity	solidarity
self-rule	sovereignty
guess	speculate
stuck	stagnant
interested party	stakeholder
staying power	stamina
basic food	staple
law	statute
trigger	stimulus
unaware mind	subconscious
owned branch	subsidiary
government help	subsidy
top-level meeting	summit
extra	surplus
eco-friendly	sustainable
nourishment	sustenance
course outline	syllabus
use of symbols	symbolism
sign	symptom

Basic	Academic
gossip paper	tabloid
forbidden	taboo
import tax	tariff
personality	temperament
statement	testimony
acceptance	tolerance
change completely	transform
changeover	transition
openness	transparency
long hike	trek
special court	tribunal
unknown	uncharted
do worse than expected	underachieve
never happened before	unprecedented
raising (a child)	upbringing
big shake-up	upheaval
ease of use	usability
usefulness	utility
open job	vacancy
damaging property	vandalism
factor	variable
unpredictability	volatility
weakness	vulnerability
urge to travel	wanderlust
wellbeing	welfare
healthy	wholesome

APPENDIX

Commonly Confused Words

Word pairs that are frequently mixed up, even by confident speakers.

Word 1	Word 2	Difference
accept	except	to receive or agree to something / excluding
advice	advise	advice is the noun (a piece of advice) / advise is the verb (to advise someone)
affect	effect	affect is usually the verb (to influence) / effect is usually the noun (a result)
amount	number	use amount with uncountable nouns (the amount of time) / number with countable nouns (the number of students)
borrow	lend	borrow = to take and use temporarily / lend = to give to someone temporarily
bring	take	bring = towards the speaker's location / take = away from the speaker's location
classic	classical	classic = the best example of its kind / classical relates to ancient Greece and Rome, or classical music
complement	compliment	complement = to go well with something / compliment = a polite expression of praise
continual	continuous	continual = happening repeatedly with breaks / continuous = happening without stopping
council	counsel	council = a group that makes decisions / counsel = advice, or to give advice
desert	dessert	desert = a dry, sandy area (or to abandon) / dessert = a sweet course after a meal
discreet	discrete	discreet = careful not to attract attention / discrete = separate and distinct
disinterested	uninterested	disinterested = impartial, unbiased / uninterested = bored, not interested
economic	economical	economic relates to the economy / economical means cost-effective, not wasteful
farther	further	farther refers to physical distance / further refers to extent or degree (figurative)
fewer	less	use fewer with countable nouns (fewer people) / less with uncountable nouns (less time)
historic	historical	historic = important in history / historical = relating to history in general
imply	infer	a speaker implies (suggests indirectly) / a listener infers (concludes from evidence)
its	it's	its = possessive (its colour) / it's = contraction of it is or it has
lay	lie	lay = to put something down (takes an object) / lie = to recline (no object)
loose	lose	loose = not tight / lose = to misplace or fail to win
moral	morale	moral = a lesson about right and wrong / morale = a group's level of confidence or spirit
personal	personnel	personal = private, individual / personnel = the people who work for an organisation
practice	practise	in British English, practice is the noun / practise is the verb
principal	principle	principal = the head of a school, or most important / principle = a fundamental rule or belief
stationary	stationery	stationary = not moving / stationery = paper and writing materials
than	then	than is used for comparisons / then refers to time or sequence

APPENDIX

Prefix & Suffix Reference

Common word-building patterns found across this book's Word Formation tables.

Affix	Meaning	Examples from this book
un-	not / opposite of	unprecedented, unnamed
re-	again / back	reconcile, reform, replicate, retain
dis-	not / reversal	discern, dismiss, disrupt, disseminate
mis-	wrongly / badly	misinformation, misinformed
pre-	before	prescribe, prevalent, precedent
de-	removal / reversal	deficiency, degrade, deplete, deviate
inter-	between / among	interrogate, interface, intersection
-tion / -sion	forms a noun showing an action, state, or process	acquisition, adaptation, allocation, comprehension, recession
-ity	forms a noun showing a quality or state	accountability, authenticity, credibility
-ment	forms a noun showing a result or process	amendment, assessment, deployment
-ence / -ance	forms a noun showing a state or quality	diligence, prevalence, tolerance
-al / -ical	forms an adjective meaning ‘relating to’	critical, geopolitical, hypothetical
-ive	forms an adjective meaning ‘tending to’	disruptive, innovative, legislative
-ous	forms an adjective meaning ‘full of / having the quality of’	anomalous, momentous, nutritious
-able / -ible	forms an adjective meaning ‘able to be’	adaptable, credible, negotiable
-ic	forms an adjective meaning ‘relating to’	authentic, bureaucratic, diplomatic
-ist	forms a noun for a person who holds a belief or does an action	protectionist, reformist
-ism	forms a noun for a belief, system, or practice	humanitarianism, protectionism, symbolism
-ify	forms a verb meaning ‘to make’	ratify
-ly	forms an adverb from an adjective	allegedly, anomalously, authentically

APPENDIX

Academic Linking Words for Writing

Cohesive devices for essays and extended writing, grouped by function.

Function	Linking Words
Addition	in addition, additionally, furthermore, moreover, as well as this
Contrast	however, nevertheless, nonetheless, on the other hand, in contrast, conversely, whereas, although
Cause and Effect	consequently, therefore, thus, as a result, this results in, this leads to
Sequence / Time	subsequently, meanwhile, thereafter, following this, at the same time
Emphasis	notably, significantly, in particular, above all, indeed
Exemplification	for instance, for example, namely, to illustrate this, such as
Conclusion / Summary	in conclusion, to summarise, overall, ultimately, taken together

APPENDIX

Master Debate Phrasebank

All functional language from the Debate Toolkit sections, in one place.

Function	Phrase Variants
Opening a viewpoint	I'd argue that… / From my point of view… / My take on this is… / I tend to think that… / As I see it…
Conceding a point	That's fair, but… / Fair enough, however… / I'll admit that's true, but… / You have a point there, though… / Granted, that's true, but…
Challenging a claim	I'm not convinced that… / I'd push back on that, because… / That doesn't quite hold up, since… / I have to disagree, because… / That's debatable, given that…
Giving evidence	This is evident in… / You can see this in… / A clear example of this is… / This is backed up by… / Just look at…
Adding weight	What's more… / On top of that… / Not only that, but… / Beyond this… / To make matters more serious…
Softening disagreement	I see your point, but consider… / I understand that, though… / That's a fair concern, but think about… / I hear you, but on the other hand… / I get where you're coming from, but…
Hedging a claim	It could be argued that… / Some would say that… / It's possible that… / Arguably… / One might claim that…
Summarising a position	Overall, the point stands that… / In short… / Taken together, this suggests… / Ultimately… / Bringing this together…
Asking for clarification	What exactly do you mean by…? / Could you explain what you mean by…? / When you say X, do you mean…? / I'm not sure I follow — could you clarify…? / Are you suggesting that…?
Making a conditional concession	I'd agree, provided that… / That's true only if… / I could accept that, as long as… / Under certain conditions, that's fair, but… / That works, but only when…
Quantifying / citing scale	The scale of this is significant because… / A large proportion of… / The vast majority of… / Only a small fraction of… / This affects a significant number of…
Drawing a comparison	Compared to… / Unlike… / In contrast to… / Similarly… / By comparison…
Acknowledging complexity	This isn't a simple issue, because… / There are several sides to this… / It's more complicated than it seems, since… / This depends on a number of factors… / There's no easy answer here, but…
Closing an argument / calling to action	Which is why… / This is exactly why… / That's precisely the reason… / Which brings me to… / This is why it matters that…

APPENDIX

Sources

All definitions, synonym and antonym notes, word-formation patterns, collocations, and etymology facts in this book were checked against the following reference sources during production.

- Merriam-Webster Dictionary (merriam-webster.com)
- Cambridge Dictionary (dictionary.cambridge.org)
- Oxford Learner's Dictionaries (oxfordlearnersdictionaries.com)
- Collins Dictionary (collinsdictionary.com)
- Online Etymology Dictionary — Etymonline (etymonline.com)
- Vocabulary.com